

MATTHEW DECODED

*The Book of Matthew Broken Down
Sentence by Sentence in Today's Language*

Decoded Faith Empire Series

By Brittany Johnson

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What This Book Is

This is an educational and interpretive guide that takes every sentence of the King James Version of the Bible and translates it into modern, plain English. The goal is clarity — not doctrine.

Each passage is presented in three parts:

- The original King James Version text
- A modern-language translation designed for today's reader
- Contextual clarification where necessary (historical, cultural, or linguistic)

This book does not claim religious authority. It does not promote a specific belief system, denomination, or spiritual practice. It exists to make an ancient text understandable in contemporary terms.

What This Book Is Not

This book is not:

- A replacement for the Bible

- An official Bible translation
- A religious instruction manual
- A sermon, devotional, or theological argument

It does not attempt to tell readers what is morally correct, spiritually required, or divinely mandated. Interpretation is presented as explanation — not command.

Important Disclaimer

This work is intended for educational purposes only. It is not a substitute for religious instruction, personal spiritual guidance, or professional counseling. The interpretations and explanations provided are based on historical context, linguistic analysis, and commonly accepted scholarly understandings of the King James Version and its source material.

Readers are encouraged to question, research, reflect, and form their own conclusions.

The author makes no claim of divine inspiration, religious authority, or doctrinal accuracy.

Why This Book Was Written

I personally wanted a better understanding of the Bible. This is the interpretation I needed to better understand and decided to share it with others. I am not affiliated with any religious organization.

Knowledge does not weaken spirituality — it clarifies it.

How to Use This Book

Read it slowly.

Read it honestly.

Read it without pressure.

You are not required to agree with anything in these pages. Your only responsibility is to understand what is being said — and to decide for yourself what it means.

That is where real clarity begins.

This book is part of a series in which you are able to fully grasp an understanding.

Foundational Framework

How This Book Is Structured

This book was designed to be used, not rushed.

The Bible is often presented as a single continuous narrative, but it is not one book, written by one author, for one audience. It is a collection of texts written across centuries, shaped by culture, language, power, and human perspective. When those layers are ignored, meaning is lost. When they are acknowledged, clarity becomes possible.

This book exists to restore that clarity.

A Three-Part Structure

Every section of this book follows the same intentional format so the reader always knows where they are and what they are reading. Each passage is presented in three parts:

First: The Original King James Version Text

This is the sentence as it appears in the King James Version of the Bible. The wording has not been altered. The King James Version is used because it is public domain and remains one of the most widely referenced translations in the English-speaking world.

Second: The Decoded Translation

Immediately following the original text, you will find a modern-language translation written in plain English. This translation focuses on meaning rather than tradition. The goal is not to preserve poetic style, but to make the sentence understandable to a modern reader encountering it without religious framing.

Third: Contextual Clarification (When Necessary)

Some passages require additional explanation due to historical setting, cultural norms, or linguistic differences. When context is essential for understanding, brief clarifications are provided. These notes are informational, not instructional. They exist to explain why a sentence was written the way it was, not how it should be applied.

Why Translation Alone Is Not Enough

Many modern translations simplify language, but simplification without context often creates new confusion. Words like sin, law, fear, covenant, and kingdom carried specific meanings in their original historical settings. When those meanings are assumed to be modern, entire passages are misread.

This book addresses that gap by pairing translation with explanation when needed. The intent is to prevent readers from projecting modern assumptions onto ancient text.

Understanding improves accuracy. Accuracy improves interpretation. Interpretation remains the reader's choice.

How Meaning Gets Lost Over Time

Language does not stand still. Words shift. Meanings evolve. Cultural references disappear. What once felt obvious to its original audience can become confusing — or misleading — centuries later. This is not a flaw of ancient texts. It is a reality of time.

The Bible was written in historical moments vastly different from the modern world. Its language reflected the politics, social structures, power systems, and assumptions of those eras. When modern readers approach the text without acknowledging that distance, meaning is often lost — or replaced with assumptions that were never present in the original context.

The Purpose of Decoding

Decoding is not about stripping meaning away. It is about restoring it.

This book does not simplify the Bible by removing complexity. It clarifies complexity by placing it back into context. Ancient texts become clearer when they are allowed to be ancient.

Meaning is not lost because the text is flawed. Meaning is lost when time is ignored.

Understanding The Gospel According to Matthew Before Reading It

Book Overview: Matthew

The Gospel According to Matthew is one of the four canonical gospels in the New Testament and serves as a vital account of the life, teachings, death, and resurrection of Jesus Christ. It presents Jesus as the

promised Messiah and King, fulfilling Old Testament prophecies and establishing a new covenant between God and humanity. Matthew's Gospel is distinctive for its emphasis on Jesus' role as a teacher and lawgiver, often highlighting his sermons, parables, and moral instructions. This gospel bridges the Jewish traditions with the emerging Christian faith, making it particularly relevant for both Jewish and Gentile audiences. Matthew begins with a detailed genealogy tracing Jesus' lineage back to Abraham, underscoring his rightful place in Jewish history. Throughout the narrative, Matthew carefully weaves references to Hebrew Scriptures to demonstrate how Jesus fulfills ancient prophecies. The gospel includes well-known passages such as the Sermon on the Mount, the Great Commission, and the Beatitudes, which have shaped Christian ethics and spirituality for centuries. By focusing on Jesus' teachings and miracles, Matthew invites readers to understand the nature of God's kingdom and the call to discipleship. The Gospel of Matthew also highlights the tension between Jesus and the religious authorities of his time, portraying the challenges he faced in proclaiming his message. It culminates in the passion narrative, detailing Jesus' crucifixion and resurrection, which form the cornerstone of Christian belief. Overall, Matthew's account offers a comprehensive and accessible presentation of Jesus' life and mission, making it a foundational text for Christian education and faith formation.

Purpose of the Book

The primary purpose of the Gospel according to Matthew is to present Jesus Christ as the fulfillment of Old Testament prophecy and the promised Messiah who inaugurates the Kingdom of Heaven. Matthew aims to confirm the identity of Jesus for a Jewish audience familiar with the Hebrew Scriptures, demonstrating that Jesus is the long-awaited King and Savior. By doing so, the gospel encourages faith in Jesus as the rightful heir to David's throne and the bringer of salvation. Additionally, Matthew's Gospel serves an instructional purpose, providing moral and spiritual guidance through Jesus' teachings. It offers a framework for Christian living, emphasizing righteousness, humility, and compassion. The gospel's detailed accounts of Jesus' sermons and parables are intended to shape the beliefs and behaviors of early Christian communities and continue to influence believers today. Finally, Matthew seeks to unify diverse followers of Jesus by addressing both Jewish and Gentile audiences. It underscores the universal scope of Jesus' mission and the inclusive nature of God's kingdom, inviting all people to become disciples. This dual focus on identity and instruction makes Matthew a vital resource for understanding the Christian faith and its ethical demands.

Authorship and Compilation

Traditionally, the Gospel of Matthew has been attributed to Matthew the Apostle, also known as Levi, a former tax collector who became one of Jesus' twelve disciples. Early church fathers such as Papias and Irenaeus supported this attribution, suggesting that Matthew wrote his account based on his firsthand experiences and eyewitness testimony. However, modern scholarship often debates the exact authorship, noting that the gospel likely underwent compilation and editing over time. Scholars generally agree that the Gospel of Matthew was composed sometime between 70 and 90 AD, after the destruction of the Jerusalem Temple. It appears to draw upon the Gospel of Mark and a hypothetical collection of Jesus' sayings known as Q, indicating that the author was well-versed in existing Christian traditions. The gospel reflects a community grappling with its identity in the aftermath of the Temple's fall and the increasing separation between Judaism and the emerging Christian movement. Despite questions about direct authorship, the gospel's careful composition and theological depth suggest it was written by a knowledgeable and devout follower of Jesus, likely a Jewish Christian familiar with both Hebrew Scriptures and Greco-Roman literary conventions. This background allowed the author to craft a narrative that bridges Jewish heritage with the new Christian faith, addressing the needs and concerns of early believers.

Structure of Matthew

The Gospel of Matthew is organized thematically and narratively, combining biographical details of Jesus' life with extensive blocks of teaching. It opens with a genealogy and birth narrative, establishing Jesus' identity and divine mission. Following this introduction, the gospel alternates between accounts of Jesus' actions—such as miracles and interactions with various groups—and his teachings, which are often presented in large, structured discourses. This alternating pattern helps to emphasize the dual nature of Jesus as both a powerful miracle worker and a wise teacher. The gospel culminates in the passion narrative, detailing Jesus' arrest, trial, crucifixion, and resurrection, which serve as the climax of the story. The final chapter concludes with the Great Commission, sending the disciples out to spread Jesus' message to all nations.

- The Birth and Early Life of Jesus (Chapters 1-2)
- Jesus' Ministry and Teachings (Chapters 3-25)
- The Passion, Death, and Resurrection of Jesus (Chapters 26-28)

Literary Style and Language

Matthew's Gospel is written in a formal, structured style that reflects both Jewish literary traditions and Greco-Roman influences. The author employs a clear narrative voice that balances storytelling with theological reflection. The text frequently uses parallelism, repetition, and chiasmus to emphasize key points and aid memorization, which was important in an oral culture. The language of Matthew is rich with Old Testament allusions and quotations, linking Jesus' life and mission to the Hebrew Scriptures. The gospel also uses parables extensively as a teaching technique, inviting readers to engage with deeper spiritual truths through metaphor and story. This combination of narrative, teaching, and prophecy creates a layered and compelling literary work that communicates complex theological ideas in an accessible way.

Why Matthew Is Often Misunderstood

One common misconception about the Gospel of Matthew is that it is solely a Jewish text and therefore not relevant to non-Jewish readers. While Matthew does emphasize Jesus' fulfillment of Jewish prophecy, the gospel also clearly extends its message to Gentiles, especially in its conclusion with the Great Commission. This broader scope is sometimes overlooked, leading to a narrow interpretation of the gospel's audience and purpose. Another reason Matthew is often misunderstood is due to its complex use of Old Testament references and symbolic language. Readers unfamiliar with Jewish customs, laws, and prophetic writings may find some passages difficult to interpret. Additionally, the gospel's portrayal of conflict between Jesus and religious leaders has sometimes been misused to justify negative attitudes toward Judaism, a misunderstanding that modern scholarship and interfaith dialogue seek to correct.

Historical and Cultural Context

The Gospel of Matthew was written during a time of significant upheaval and transition for the early Christian community. The destruction of the Jerusalem Temple in 70 AD by the Romans marked a turning point, deeply affecting Jewish society and religious practice. Matthew's community was likely composed of Jewish Christians who were navigating their identity in the aftermath of this event, facing both internal challenges and external pressures from the broader Jewish and Roman worlds. Culturally, the gospel reflects a world where Jewish traditions were being reinterpreted in light of Jesus' life and teachings. The author addresses issues such as the observance of the law, the role of the Messiah, and the inclusion of Gentiles, all of which were hotly debated topics within early Christianity. The gospel's emphasis on Jesus as a new lawgiver and fulfillment of prophecy speaks directly to these concerns. Politically, the Roman Empire's dominance shaped the environment in which Matthew's community lived. References to kingship, authority, and the kingdom of heaven can be seen as responses to Roman imperial power, offering a vision

of divine rule that contrasted with earthly empires. Understanding this context helps readers appreciate the gospel's message of hope, justice, and transformation amid a challenging historical landscape.

Matthew Chapter 1 — Genealogy and Birth of Jesus Christ

THE BOOK OF MATTHEW

MATTHEW — CHAPTER 1

Matthew 1:1

King James Version: The book of the generation of Jesus Christ, the son of David, the son of Abraham.

Decoded (Modern Language): This is the record of the ancestry of Jesus Christ, who is a descendant of David and Abraham.

Matthew 1:2

King James Version: Abraham begat Isaac; and Isaac begat Jacob; and Jacob begat Judas and his brethren;

Decoded (Modern Language): Abraham fathered Isaac; Isaac fathered Jacob; and Jacob fathered Judah and his brothers.

Matthew 1:3

King James Version: And Judas begat Phares and Zara of Thamar; and Phares begat Esrom; and Esrom begat Aram;

Decoded (Modern Language): Judah fathered Perez and Zerah by Tamar; Perez fathered Hezron; and Hezron fathered Ram.

Matthew 1:4

King James Version: And Aram begat Aminadab; and Aminadab begat Naasson; and Naasson begat Salmon;

Decoded (Modern Language): Ram fathered Amminadab; Amminadab fathered Nahshon; and Nahshon fathered Salmon.

Matthew 1:5

King James Version: And Salmon begat Booz of Rachab; and Booz begat Obed of Ruth; and Obed begat Jesse;

Decoded (Modern Language): Salmon fathered Boaz by Rahab; Boaz fathered Obed by Ruth; and Obed fathered Jesse.

Matthew 1:6

King James Version: And Jesse begat David the king; and David the king begat Solomon of her that had been the wife of Urias;

Decoded (Modern Language): Jesse fathered King David; and King David fathered Solomon by the wife of Uriah.

Matthew 1:7

King James Version: And Solomon begat Roboam; and Roboam begat Abia; and Abia begat Asa;

Decoded (Modern Language): Solomon fathered Rehoboam; Rehoboam fathered Abijah; and Abijah fathered Asa.

Matthew 1:8

King James Version: And Asa begat Josaphat; and Josaphat begat Joram; and Joram begat Ozias;

Decoded (Modern Language): Asa fathered Jehoshaphat; Jehoshaphat fathered Jehoram; and Jehoram fathered Uzziah.

Matthew 1:9

King James Version: And Ozias begat Joatham; and Joatham begat Achaz; and Achaz begat Ezekias;

Decoded (Modern Language): Uzziah fathered Jotham; Jotham fathered Ahaz; and Ahaz fathered Hezekiah.

Matthew 1:10

King James Version: And Ezekias begat Manasses; and Manasses begat Amon; and Amon begat Josias;

Decoded (Modern Language): Hezekiah fathered Manasseh; Manasseh fathered Amon; and Amon fathered Josiah.

Matthew 1:11

King James Version: And Josias begat Jechonias and his brethren, about the time they were carried away to Babylon:

Decoded (Modern Language): Josiah fathered Jeconiah and his brothers at the time they were taken to Babylon.

Matthew 1:12

King James Version: And after they were brought to Babylon, Jechonias begat Salathiel; and Salathiel begat Zorobabel;

Decoded (Modern Language): After they were taken to Babylon, Jeconiah fathered Shealtiel; and Shealtiel fathered Zerubbabel.

Matthew 1:13

King James Version: And Zorobabel begat Abiud; and Abiud begat Eliakim; and Eliakim begat Azor;

Decoded (Modern Language): Zerubbabel fathered Abiud; Abiud fathered Eliakim; and Eliakim fathered Azor.

Matthew 1:14

King James Version: And Azor begat Sadoc; and Sadoc begat Achim; and Achim begat Eliud;

Decoded (Modern Language): Azor fathered Zadok; Zadok fathered Achim; and Achim fathered Eliud.

Matthew 1:15

King James Version: And Eliud begat Eleazar; and Eleazar begat Matthan; and Matthan begat Jacob;

Decoded (Modern Language): Eliud fathered Eleazar; Eleazar fathered Matthan; and Matthan fathered Jacob.

Matthew 1:16

King James Version: And Jacob begat Joseph the husband of Mary, of whom was born Jesus, who is called Christ.

Decoded (Modern Language): Jacob fathered Joseph, the husband of Mary, from whom Jesus was born, who is called Christ.

Matthew 1:17

King James Version: So all the generations from Abraham to David are fourteen generations; and from David until the carrying away into Babylon are fourteen generations; and from the carrying away into Babylon unto Christ are fourteen generations.

Decoded (Modern Language): So there are fourteen generations from Abraham to David, fourteen from David to the exile in Babylon, and fourteen from the exile to Christ.

Matthew 1:18

King James Version: Now the birth of Jesus Christ was on this wise: When as his mother Mary was espoused to Joseph, before they came together, she was found with child of the Holy Ghost.

Decoded (Modern Language): This is how Jesus Christ was born: His mother Mary was engaged to Joseph, but before they lived together, she was found to be pregnant through the Holy Spirit.

Matthew 1:19

King James Version: Then Joseph her husband, being a just man, and not willing to make her a publick example, was minded to put her away privily.

Decoded (Modern Language): Joseph, her husband, was a good man and did not want to disgrace her publicly, so he planned to quietly end their engagement.

Matthew 1:20

King James Version: But while he thought on these things, behold, the angel of the Lord appeared unto him in a dream, saying, Joseph, thou son of David, fear not to take unto thee Mary thy wife: for that which is conceived in her is of the Holy Ghost.

Decoded (Modern Language): While he was thinking about this, an angel of the Lord appeared to him in a dream and said, 'Joseph, son of David, don't be afraid to take Mary as your wife, because the child she is carrying was conceived by the Holy Spirit.'

Matthew 1:21

King James Version: And she shall bring forth a son, and thou shalt call his name JESUS: for he shall save his people from their sins.

Decoded (Modern Language): She will have a son, and you are to name him Jesus, because he will save his people from their sins.

Matthew 1:22

King James Version: Now all this was done, that it might be fulfilled which was spoken of the Lord by the prophet, saying,

Decoded (Modern Language): All this happened to fulfill what the Lord had said through the prophet:

Matthew 1:23

King James Version: Behold, a virgin shall be with child, and shall bring forth a son, and they shall call his name Emmanuel, which being interpreted is, God with us.

Decoded (Modern Language): 'A virgin will become pregnant and give birth to a son, and they will call him Emmanuel,' which means, 'God with us.'

Matthew 1:24

King James Version: Then Joseph being raised from sleep did as the angel of the Lord had bidden him, and took unto him his wife:

Decoded (Modern Language): When Joseph woke up, he did as the angel of the Lord had told him and took Mary as his wife.

Matthew 1:25

King James Version: And knew her not till she had brought forth her firstborn son: and he called his name JESUS.

Decoded (Modern Language): But he did not have sexual relations with her until she gave birth to her first son, and he named him Jesus.

MATTHEW — CHAPTER 2

Matthew 2:1

King James Version: Now when Jesus was born in Bethlehem of Judaea in the days of Herod the king, behold, there came wise men from the east to Jerusalem,

Decoded (Modern Language): When Jesus was born in Bethlehem in the region of Judah during King Herod's rule, some wise men came from the east to Jerusalem.

Matthew 2:2

King James Version: Saying, Where is he that is born King of the Jews? for we have seen his star in the east, and are come to worship him.

Decoded (Modern Language): They asked, 'Where is the one born King of the Jews? We saw his star in the east and have come to worship him.'

Matthew 2:3

King James Version: When Herod the king had heard these things, he was troubled, and all Jerusalem with him.

Decoded (Modern Language): When King Herod heard this, he was disturbed, and so was everyone in Jerusalem.

Matthew 2:4

King James Version: And when he had gathered all the chief priests and scribes of the people together, he demanded of them where Christ should be born.

Decoded (Modern Language): He gathered all the chief priests and teachers of the law and asked them where the Messiah was to be born.

Matthew 2:5

King James Version: And they said unto him, In Bethlehem of Judaea: for thus it is written by the prophet,

Decoded (Modern Language): They told him, 'In Bethlehem of Judah, because this is what the prophet wrote.'

Matthew 2:6

King James Version: And thou Bethlehem, in the land of Juda, art not the least among the princes of Juda: for out of thee shall come a Governor, that shall rule my people Israel.

Decoded (Modern Language): 'Bethlehem in Judah, you are not least among the leaders of Judah, because a ruler will come from you to lead my people Israel.'

Matthew 2:7

King James Version: Then Herod, when he had privily called the wise men, enquired of them diligently what time the star appeared.

Decoded (Modern Language): Then Herod secretly called the wise men and asked them carefully when the star had appeared.

Matthew 2:8

King James Version: And he sent them to Bethlehem, and said, Go and search diligently for the young child; and when ye have found him, bring me word again, that I may come and worship him also.

Decoded (Modern Language): He sent them to Bethlehem and said, 'Go and search carefully for the child. When you find him, let me know so I can go and worship him too.'

Matthew 2:9

King James Version: When they had heard the king, they departed; and, lo, the star, which they saw in the east, went before them, till it came and stood over where the young child was.

Decoded (Modern Language): After hearing the king, they left, and the star they had seen in the east went ahead of them until it stopped over the place where the child was.

Matthew 2:10

King James Version: When they saw the star, they rejoiced with exceeding great joy.

Decoded (Modern Language): When they saw the star, they were filled with great joy.

Matthew 2:11

King James Version: And when they were come into the house, they saw the young child with Mary his mother, and fell down, and worshipped him: and when they had opened their treasures, they presented unto him gifts; gold, and frankincense, and myrrh.

Decoded (Modern Language): They went into the house, saw the child with his mother Mary, bowed down, and worshiped him. Then they opened their treasures and gave him gifts of gold, frankincense, and myrrh.

Matthew 2:12

King James Version: And being warned of God in a dream that they should not return to Herod, they departed into their own country another way.

Decoded (Modern Language): Being warned by God in a dream not to return to Herod, they went back to their country by another route.

Matthew 2:13

King James Version: And when they were departed, behold, the angel of the Lord appeareth to Joseph in a dream, saying, Arise, and take the young child and his mother, and flee into Egypt, and be thou there until I bring thee word: for Herod will seek the young child to destroy him.

Decoded (Modern Language): After they left, an angel of the Lord appeared to Joseph in a dream and said, 'Get up, take the child and his mother, and escape to Egypt. Stay there until I tell you to return, because Herod will try to kill the child.'

Matthew 2:14

King James Version: When he arose, he took the young child and his mother by night, and departed into Egypt:

Decoded (Modern Language): Joseph got up, took the child and his mother during the night, and left for Egypt.

Matthew 2:15

King James Version: And was there until the death of Herod: that it might be fulfilled which was spoken of the Lord by the prophet, saying, Out of Egypt have I called my son.

Decoded (Modern Language): They stayed in Egypt until Herod died. This fulfilled what the Lord had spoken through the prophet: 'Out of Egypt I called my son.'

Matthew 2:16

King James Version: Then Herod, when he saw that he was mocked of the wise men, was exceeding wroth, and sent forth, and slew all the children that were in Bethlehem, and in all the coasts thereof, from two years old and under, according to the time which he had diligently enquired of the wise men.

Decoded (Modern Language): When Herod realized the wise men had tricked him, he was very angry. He ordered the killing of all boys in Bethlehem and nearby who were two years old and under, based on the time he had learned from the wise men.

Matthew 2:17

King James Version: Then was fulfilled that which was spoken by Jeremy the prophet, saying,

Decoded (Modern Language): This fulfilled what the prophet Jeremiah had said.

Matthew 2:18

King James Version: In Rama was there a voice heard, lamentation, and weeping, and great mourning, Rachel weeping for her children, and would not be comforted, because they are not.

Decoded (Modern Language): A loud cry was heard in Ramah—mourning and weeping. Rachel was crying for her children and would not be comforted because they were gone.

Matthew 2:19

King James Version: But when Herod was dead, behold, an angel of the Lord appeareth in a dream to Joseph in Egypt,

Decoded (Modern Language): After Herod died, an angel of the Lord appeared to Joseph in a dream in Egypt.

Matthew 2:20

King James Version: Saying, Arise, and take the young child and his mother, and go into the land of Israel: for they are dead which sought the young child's life.

Decoded (Modern Language): The angel said, 'Get up, take the child and his mother, and go back to Israel, because those who wanted to kill the child are dead.'

Matthew 2:21

King James Version: And he arose, and took the young child and his mother, and came into the land of Israel.

Decoded (Modern Language): Joseph got up, took the child and his mother, and returned to Israel.

Matthew 2:22

King James Version: But when he heard that Archelaus did reign in Judaea in the room of his father Herod, he was afraid to go thither: notwithstanding, being warned of God in a dream, he turned aside into the parts of Galilee:

Decoded (Modern Language): But when he heard that Herod's son Archelaus was ruling in Judah, he was afraid to go there. After being warned in a dream, he went to live in the region of Galilee.

Matthew 2:23

King James Version: And he came and dwelt in a city called Nazareth: that it might be fulfilled which was spoken by the prophets, He shall be called a Nazarene.

Decoded (Modern Language): He settled in a town called Nazareth, fulfilling what the prophets said: 'He will be called a Nazarene.'

MATTHEW — CHAPTER 3**Matthew 3:1**

King James Version: In those days came John the Baptist, preaching in the wilderness of Judaea,

Decoded (Modern Language): At that time, John the Baptist came preaching in the wilderness of Judea,

Matthew 3:2

King James Version: And saying, Repent ye: for the kingdom of heaven is at hand.

Decoded (Modern Language): and said, 'Change your hearts and lives, because the kingdom of heaven is near.'

Matthew 3:3

King James Version: For this is he that was spoken of by the prophet Esaias, saying, The voice of one crying in the wilderness, Prepare ye the way of the Lord, make his paths straight.

Decoded (Modern Language): This is the one the prophet Isaiah spoke about when he said, 'A voice cries out in the wilderness, Prepare the way for the Lord; make his paths straight.'

Matthew 3:4

King James Version: And the same John had his raiment of camel's hair, and a leathern girdle about his loins; and his meat was locusts and wild honey.

Decoded (Modern Language): John wore clothes made of camel's hair and a leather belt around his waist. He ate locusts and wild honey.

Matthew 3:5

King James Version: Then went out to him Jerusalem, and all Judaea, and all the region round about Jordan,

Decoded (Modern Language): People from Jerusalem, all of Judea, and the whole area around the Jordan River went out to see him.

Matthew 3:6

King James Version: And were baptized of him in Jordan, confessing their sins.

Decoded (Modern Language): They were baptized by him in the Jordan River, confessing their sins.

Matthew 3:7

King James Version: But when he saw many of the Pharisees and Sadducees come to his baptism, he said unto them, O generation of vipers, who hath warned you to flee from the wrath to come?

Decoded (Modern Language): But when John saw many Pharisees and Sadducees coming to be baptized, he said to them, 'You snakes! Who warned you to run away from the coming judgment?'

Matthew 3:8

King James Version: Bring forth therefore fruits meet for repentance:

Decoded (Modern Language): Show by your actions that you have truly changed your hearts.

Matthew 3:9

King James Version: And think not to say within yourselves, We have Abraham to our father: for I say unto you, that God is able of these stones to raise up children unto Abraham.

Decoded (Modern Language): Don't think you can say to yourselves, 'We have Abraham as our father.' I tell you, God can raise up children for Abraham from these stones.

Matthew 3:10

King James Version: And now also the axe is laid unto the root of the trees: therefore every tree which bringeth not forth good fruit is hewn down, and cast into the fire.

Decoded (Modern Language): The axe is already ready to cut down the trees at their roots. Every tree that does not produce good fruit will be cut down and thrown into the fire.

Matthew 3:11

King James Version: I indeed baptize you with water unto repentance: but he that cometh after me is mightier than I, whose shoes I am not worthy to bear: he shall baptize you with the Holy Ghost, and with fire:

Decoded (Modern Language): I baptize you with water to show that you have changed, but the one coming after me is more powerful than I am. I'm not even worthy to carry his sandals. He will baptize you with the Holy Spirit and with fire.

Matthew 3:12

King James Version: Whose fan is in his hand, and he will thoroughly purge his floor, and gather his wheat into the garner; but he will burn up the chaff with unquenchable fire.

Decoded (Modern Language): He has a fan in his hand to clean his threshing floor. He will gather the wheat into his barn, but he will burn the chaff with a fire that never goes out.

Matthew 3:13

King James Version: Then cometh Jesus from Galilee to Jordan unto John, to be baptized of him.

Decoded (Modern Language): Then Jesus came from Galilee to the Jordan River to be baptized by John.

Matthew 3:14

King James Version: But John forbad him, saying, I have need to be baptized of thee, and comest thou to me?

Decoded (Modern Language): But John tried to stop him, saying, 'I need to be baptized by you, and you come to me?'

Matthew 3:15

King James Version: And Jesus answering said unto him, Suffer it to be so now: for thus it becometh us to fulfil all righteousness. Then he suffered him.

Decoded (Modern Language): Jesus answered, 'Let it be this way for now. It is right for us to do all that God requires.' So John agreed.

Matthew 3:16

King James Version: And Jesus, when he was baptized, went up straightway out of the water: and, lo, the heavens were opened unto him, and he saw the Spirit of God descending like a dove, and lighting upon him:

Decoded (Modern Language): After Jesus was baptized, he came up immediately from the water. Then the heavens opened, and he saw the Spirit of God coming down like a dove and resting on him.

Matthew 3:17

King James Version: And lo a voice from heaven, saying, This is my beloved Son, in whom I am well pleased.

Decoded (Modern Language): A voice from heaven said, 'This is my beloved Son, and I am pleased with him.'

MATTHEW — CHAPTER 4

Matthew 4:1

King James Version: Then was Jesus led up of the Spirit into the wilderness to be tempted of the devil.

Decoded (Modern Language): Then the Spirit led Jesus into the wilderness to be tempted by the devil.

Matthew 4:2

King James Version: And when he had fasted forty days and forty nights, he was afterward an hungred.

Decoded (Modern Language): After fasting for forty days and forty nights, he was very hungry.

Matthew 4:3

King James Version: And when the tempter came to him, he said, If thou be the Son of God, command that these stones be made bread.

Decoded (Modern Language): The tempter came to him and said, 'If you are the Son of God, tell these stones to become bread.'

Matthew 4:4

King James Version: But he answered and said, It is written, Man shall not live by bread alone, but by every word that proceedeth out of the mouth of God.

Decoded (Modern Language): But Jesus answered, 'It is written, People do not live by bread alone, but by every word that comes from the mouth of God.'

Matthew 4:5

King James Version: Then the devil taketh him up into the holy city, and setteth him on a pinnacle of the temple,

Decoded (Modern Language): Then the devil took him to the holy city and placed him on the highest point of the temple.

Matthew 4:6

King James Version: And saith unto him, If thou be the Son of God, cast thyself down: for it is written, He shall give his angels charge concerning thee: and in their hands they shall bear thee up, lest at any time thou dash thy foot against a stone.

Decoded (Modern Language): He said to him, 'If you are the Son of God, throw yourself down. It is written, He will command his angels to protect you, and they will catch you so you won't hurt your foot on a stone.'

Matthew 4:7

King James Version: Jesus said unto him, It is written again, Thou shalt not tempt the Lord thy God.

Decoded (Modern Language): Jesus said to him, 'It is also written, You must not test the Lord your God.'

Matthew 4:8

King James Version: Again, the devil taketh him up into an exceeding high mountain, and sheweth him all the kingdoms of the world, and the glory of them;

Decoded (Modern Language): Then the devil took him to a very high mountain and showed him all the kingdoms of the world and their glory.

Matthew 4:9

King James Version: And saith unto him, All these things will I give thee, if thou wilt fall down and worship me.

Decoded (Modern Language): He said to him, 'I will give you all these things if you will bow down and worship me.'

Matthew 4:10

King James Version: Then saith Jesus unto him, Get thee hence, Satan: for it is written, Thou shalt worship the Lord thy God, and him only shalt thou serve.

Decoded (Modern Language): Jesus said to him, 'Go away, Satan! It is written, You must worship the Lord your God and serve only him.'

Matthew 4:11

King James Version: Then the devil leaveth him, and, behold, angels came and ministered unto him.

Decoded (Modern Language): Then the devil left him, and angels came and took care of him.

Matthew 4:12

King James Version: Now when Jesus had heard that John was cast into prison, he departed into Galilee;

Decoded (Modern Language): When Jesus heard that John had been put in prison, he went to Galilee.

Matthew 4:13

King James Version: And leaving Nazareth, he came and dwelt in Capernaum, which is upon the sea coast, in the borders of Zabulon and Nephthalim:

Decoded (Modern Language): Leaving Nazareth, he went and lived in Capernaum by the sea, in the area of Zebulun and Naphtali.

Matthew 4:14

King James Version: That it might be fulfilled which was spoken by Esaias the prophet, saying,

Decoded (Modern Language): This was to fulfill what the prophet Isaiah had said.

Matthew 4:15

King James Version: The land of Zabulon, and the land of Nephthalim, by the way of the sea, beyond Jordan, Galilee of the Gentiles;

Decoded (Modern Language): 'Land of Zebulun and land of Naphtali, by the road along the sea, across the Jordan, Galilee of the Gentiles.'

Matthew 4:16

King James Version: The people which sat in darkness saw great light; and to them which sat in the region and shadow of death light is sprung up.

Decoded (Modern Language): 'The people living in darkness have seen a great light; on those living in the land of death's shadow a light has dawned.'

Matthew 4:17

King James Version: From that time Jesus began to preach, and to say, Repent: for the kingdom of heaven is at hand.

Decoded (Modern Language): From that time Jesus began to preach, 'Turn from your sins, because the kingdom of heaven is near.'

Matthew 4:18

King James Version: And Jesus, walking by the sea of Galilee, saw two brethren, Simon called Peter, and Andrew his brother, casting a net into the sea: for they were fishers.

Decoded (Modern Language): Jesus was walking by the Sea of Galilee when he saw two brothers, Simon called Peter and his brother Andrew, throwing a net into the sea, because they were fishermen.

Matthew 4:19

King James Version: And he saith unto them, Follow me, and I will make you fishers of men.

Decoded (Modern Language): He said to them, 'Follow me, and I will make you fishers of people.'

Matthew 4:20

King James Version: And they straightway left their nets, and followed him.

Decoded (Modern Language): At once they left their nets and followed him.

Matthew 4:21

King James Version: And going on from thence, he saw other two brethren, James the son of Zebedee, and John his brother, in a ship with Zebedee their father, mending their nets; and he called them.

Decoded (Modern Language): Going on from there, he saw two other brothers, James son of Zebedee and his brother John, in a boat with their father Zebedee, fixing their nets. Jesus called them.

Matthew 4:22

King James Version: And they immediately left the ship and their father, and followed him.

Decoded (Modern Language): They immediately left the boat and their father and followed him.

Matthew 4:23

King James Version: And Jesus went about all Galilee, teaching in their synagogues, and preaching the gospel of the kingdom, and healing all manner of sickness and all manner of disease among the people.

Decoded (Modern Language): Jesus went throughout all of Galilee, teaching in their synagogues, preaching the good news about the kingdom, and healing every kind of sickness and disease among the people.

Matthew 4:24

King James Version: And his fame went throughout all Syria: and they brought unto him all sick people that were taken with divers diseases and torments, and those which were possessed with devils, and those which were lunatick, and those that had the palsy; and he healed them.

Decoded (Modern Language): His fame spread throughout all Syria, and people brought to him all who were sick with different diseases and pains, those possessed by demons, those who were mentally ill, and those paralyzed, and he healed them.

Matthew 4:25

King James Version: And there followed him great multitudes of people from Galilee, and from Decapolis, and from Jerusalem, and from Judaea, and from beyond Jordan.

Decoded (Modern Language): Large crowds followed him from Galilee, the Ten Towns, Jerusalem, Judea, and from across the Jordan.

MATTHEW — CHAPTER 5

Matthew 5:1

King James Version: And seeing the multitudes, he went up into a mountain: and when he was set, his disciples came unto him:

Decoded (Modern Language): When Jesus saw the crowds, he went up on a mountain. After he sat down, his followers came to him.

Matthew 5:2

King James Version: And he opened his mouth, and taught them, saying,

Decoded (Modern Language): He began to teach them, saying,

Matthew 5:3

King James Version: Blessed are the poor in spirit: for their's is the kingdom of heaven.

Decoded (Modern Language): Happy are those who know they need God, because the kingdom of heaven belongs to them.

Matthew 5:4

King James Version: Blessed are they that mourn: for they shall be comforted.

Decoded (Modern Language): Happy are those who are sad, because they will be comforted.

Matthew 5:5

King James Version: Blessed are the meek: for they shall inherit the earth.

Decoded (Modern Language): Happy are those who are gentle, because they will inherit the earth.

Matthew 5:6

King James Version: Blessed are they which do hunger and thirst after righteousness: for they shall be filled.

Decoded (Modern Language): Happy are those who want to live right, because they will be satisfied.

Matthew 5:7

King James Version: Blessed are the merciful: for they shall obtain mercy.

Decoded (Modern Language): Happy are those who show mercy, because they will be shown mercy.

Matthew 5:8

King James Version: Blessed are the pure in heart: for they shall see God.

Decoded (Modern Language): Happy are those who have pure hearts, because they will see God.

Matthew 5:9

King James Version: Blessed are the peacemakers: for they shall be called the children of God.

Decoded (Modern Language): Happy are those who make peace, because they will be called God's children.

Matthew 5:10

King James Version: Blessed are they which are persecuted for righteousness' sake: for their's is the kingdom of heaven.

Decoded (Modern Language): Happy are those who are treated badly because they do what is right, because the kingdom of heaven belongs to them.

Matthew 5:11

King James Version: Blessed are ye, when men shall revile you, and persecute you, and shall say all manner of evil against you falsely, for my sake.

Decoded (Modern Language): Happy are you when people insult you, treat you badly, and say all kinds of false things about you because of me.

Matthew 5:12

King James Version: Rejoice, and be exceeding glad: for great is your reward in heaven: for so persecuted they the prophets which were before you.

Decoded (Modern Language): Be happy and full of joy, because you will have a great reward in heaven. This is how the prophets before you were treated.

Matthew 5:13

King James Version: Ye are the salt of the earth: but if the salt have lost his savour, wherewith shall it be salted? it is thenceforth good for nothing, but to be cast out, and to be trodden under foot of men.

Decoded (Modern Language): You are like salt for the earth. But if salt loses its flavor, how can it be made salty again? It is no longer good for anything except to be thrown out and trampled on.

Matthew 5:14

King James Version: Ye are the light of the world. A city that is set on an hill cannot be hid.

Decoded (Modern Language): You are like light for the world. A city built on a hill cannot be hidden.

Matthew 5:15

King James Version: Neither do men light a candle, and put it under a bushel, but on a candlestick; and it giveth light unto all that are in the house.

Decoded (Modern Language): People don't light a lamp and put it under a basket. Instead, they put it on a stand so it gives light to everyone in the house.

Matthew 5:16

King James Version: Let your light so shine before men, that they may see your good works, and glorify your Father which is in heaven.

Decoded (Modern Language): Let your light shine before people, so they can see your good deeds and praise your Father in heaven.

Matthew 5:17

King James Version: Think not that I am come to destroy the law, or the prophets: I am not come to destroy, but to fulfil.

Decoded (Modern Language): Don't think I came to destroy the law or the prophets. I did not come to destroy but to complete them.

Matthew 5:18

King James Version: For verily I say unto you, Till heaven and earth pass, one jot or one tittle shall in no wise pass from the law, till all be fulfilled.

Decoded (Modern Language): I tell you the truth, until heaven and earth disappear, not even the smallest letter or stroke of a pen will disappear from the law until everything is accomplished.

Matthew 5:19

King James Version: Whosoever therefore shall break one of these least commandments, and shall teach men so, he shall be called the least in the kingdom of heaven: but whosoever shall do and teach them, the same shall be called great in the kingdom of heaven.

Decoded (Modern Language): So anyone who breaks even the least of these commandments and teaches others to do the same will be called least in the kingdom of heaven. But anyone who obeys and teaches these commands will be called great in the kingdom of heaven.

Matthew 5:20

King James Version: For I say unto you, That except your righteousness shall exceed the righteousness of the scribes and Pharisees, ye shall in no case enter into the kingdom of heaven.

Decoded (Modern Language): I tell you, your righteousness must be greater than that of the teachers of the law and Pharisees, or you will never enter the kingdom of heaven.

Matthew 5:21

King James Version: Ye have heard that it was said by them of old time, Thou shalt not kill; and whosoever shall kill shall be in danger of the judgment:

Decoded (Modern Language): You have heard that it was said, 'You must not murder,' and anyone who murders will be judged.

Matthew 5:22

King James Version: But I say unto you, That whosoever is angry with his brother without a cause shall be in danger of the judgment: and whosoever shall say to his brother, Raca, shall be in danger of the council: but whosoever shall say, Thou fool, shall be in danger of hell fire.

Decoded (Modern Language): But I say to you, anyone who is angry with a brother or sister will be judged. Anyone who says to them, 'You fool!' will be judged by the court. And anyone who says, 'You idiot!' will be in danger of hell fire.

Matthew 5:23

King James Version: Therefore if thou bring thy gift to the altar, and there rememberest that thy brother hath ought against thee;

Decoded (Modern Language): So if you are bringing your gift to the altar and remember that your brother or sister has something against you,

Matthew 5:24

King James Version: Leave there thy gift before the altar, and go thy way; first be reconciled to thy brother, and then come and offer thy gift.

Decoded (Modern Language): leave your gift there in front of the altar. First go and be reconciled to them; then come and offer your gift.

Matthew 5:25

King James Version: Agree with thine adversary quickly, whiles thou art in the way with him; lest at any time the adversary deliver thee to the judge, and the judge deliver thee to the officer, and thou be cast into prison.

Decoded (Modern Language): Agree quickly with your opponent while you are on the way to court, or your opponent may hand you over to the judge, and the judge may hand you over to the officer, and you may be thrown into prison.

Matthew 5:26

King James Version: Verily I say unto thee, Thou shalt by no means come out thence, till thou hast paid the uttermost farthing.

Decoded (Modern Language): I tell you the truth, you will not get out until you have paid the last penny.

Matthew 5:27

King James Version: Ye have heard that it was said by them of old time, Thou shalt not commit adultery:

Decoded (Modern Language): You have heard that it was said, 'You must not commit adultery.'

Matthew 5:28

King James Version: But I say unto you, That whosoever looketh on a woman to lust after her hath committed adultery with her already in his heart.

Decoded (Modern Language): But I say to you, anyone who looks at a woman with lust has already committed adultery with her in his heart.

Matthew 5:29

King James Version: And if thy right eye offend thee, pluck it out, and cast it from thee: for it is profitable for thee that one of thy members should perish, and not that thy whole body should be cast into hell.

Decoded (Modern Language): If your right eye causes you to sin, tear it out and throw it away. It is better to lose one part of your body than for your whole body to be thrown into hell.

Matthew 5:30

King James Version: And if thy right hand offend thee, cut it off, and cast it from thee: for it is profitable for thee that one of thy members should perish, and not that thy whole body should be cast into hell.

Decoded (Modern Language): If your right hand causes you to sin, cut it off and throw it away. It is better to lose one part of your body than for your whole body to be thrown into hell.

Matthew 5:31

King James Version: It hath been said, Whosoever shall put away his wife, let him give her a writing of divorcement:

Decoded (Modern Language): It has been said, Whoever divorces his wife must give her a written certificate of divorce.

Matthew 5:32

King James Version: But I say unto you, That whosoever shall put away his wife, saving for the cause of fornication, causeth her to commit adultery: and whosoever shall marry her that is divorced committeth adultery.

Decoded (Modern Language): But I tell you, anyone who divorces his wife except for sexual immorality causes her to commit adultery, and anyone who marries a divorced woman commits adultery.

Matthew 5:33

King James Version: Again, ye have heard that it hath been said by them of old time, Thou shalt not forswear thyself, but shalt perform unto the Lord thine oaths:

Decoded (Modern Language): You have also heard that it was said to those long ago, Do not break your oath, but keep the promises you make to the Lord.

Matthew 5:34

King James Version: But I say unto you, Swear not at all; neither by heaven; for it is God's throne:

Decoded (Modern Language): But I tell you, do not swear at all, neither by heaven, because it is God's throne.

Matthew 5:35

King James Version: Nor by the earth; for it is his footstool: neither by Jerusalem; for it is the city of the great King.

Decoded (Modern Language): Nor by the earth, because it is his footstool, nor by Jerusalem, because it is the city of the great King.

Matthew 5:36

King James Version: Neither shalt thou swear by thy head, because thou canst not make one hair white or black.

Decoded (Modern Language): Do not swear by your head, because you cannot make even one hair white or black.

Matthew 5:37

King James Version: But let your communication be, Yea, yea; Nay, nay: for whatsoever is more than these cometh of evil.

Decoded (Modern Language): Just let your 'Yes' mean yes, and your 'No' mean no. Anything more than this comes from evil.

Matthew 5:38

King James Version: Ye have heard that it hath been said, An eye for an eye, and a tooth for a tooth:

Decoded (Modern Language): You have heard that it was said, Eye for eye, and tooth for tooth.

Matthew 5:39

King James Version: But I say unto you, That ye resist not evil: but whosoever shall smite thee on thy right cheek, turn to him the other also.

Decoded (Modern Language): But I tell you, do not resist an evil person. If someone strikes you on your right cheek, turn to them the other also.

Matthew 5:40

King James Version: And if any man will sue thee at the law, and take away thy coat, let him have thy cloke also.

Decoded (Modern Language): If anyone wants to sue you and take your shirt, let them have your coat as well.

Matthew 5:41

King James Version: And whosoever shall compel thee to go a mile, go with him twain.

Decoded (Modern Language): If someone forces you to go one mile, go with them two miles.

Matthew 5:42

King James Version: Give to him that asketh thee, and from him that would borrow of thee turn not thou away.

Decoded (Modern Language): Give to anyone who asks you, and do not turn away from anyone who wants to borrow from you.

Matthew 5:43

King James Version: Ye have heard that it hath been said, Thou shalt love thy neighbour, and hate thine enemy.

Decoded (Modern Language): You have heard that it was said, Love your neighbor and hate your enemy.

Matthew 5:44

King James Version: But I say unto you, Love your enemies, bless them that curse you, do good to them that hate you, and pray for them which despitefully use you, and persecute you;

Decoded (Modern Language): But I tell you, love your enemies, bless those who curse you, do good to those who hate you, and pray for those who mistreat and persecute you.

Matthew 5:45

King James Version: That ye may be the children of your Father which is in heaven: for he maketh his sun to rise on the evil and on the good, and sendeth rain on the just and on the unjust.

Decoded (Modern Language): Then you will be children of your Father in heaven. He causes the sun to rise on the evil and the good, and sends rain on the righteous and the unrighteous.

Matthew 5:46

King James Version: For if ye love them which love you, what reward have ye? do not even the publicans the same?

Decoded (Modern Language): If you love only those who love you, what reward will you get? Even tax collectors do that.

Matthew 5:47

King James Version: And if ye salute your brethren only, what do ye more than others? do not even the publicans so?

Decoded (Modern Language): And if you greet only your own people, what are you doing more than others? Even pagans do that.

Matthew 5:48

King James Version: Be ye therefore perfect, even as your Father which is in heaven is perfect.

Decoded (Modern Language): Be perfect, therefore, as your heavenly Father is perfect.

MATTHEW — CHAPTER 6

Matthew 6:1

King James Version: Take heed that ye do not your alms before men, to be seen of them: otherwise ye have no reward of your Father which is in heaven.

Decoded (Modern Language): Be careful not to do your good deeds in front of others just to be seen by them, or else you will not have any reward from your Father in heaven.

Matthew 6:2

King James Version: Therefore when thou doest thine alms, do not sound a trumpet before thee, as the hypocrites do in the synagogues and in the streets, that they may have glory of men. Verily I say unto you, They have their reward.

Decoded (Modern Language): So when you give to the poor, don't announce it with trumpets like the hypocrites do in the synagogues and on the streets to get praise from others. Truly I tell you, they already have their reward.

Matthew 6:3

King James Version: But when thou doest alms, let not thy left hand know what thy right hand doeth:

Decoded (Modern Language): But when you give to the poor, don't let your left hand know what your right hand is doing,

Matthew 6:4

King James Version: That thine alms may be in secret: and thy Father which seeth in secret himself shall reward thee openly.

Decoded (Modern Language): so that your giving may be in secret. Then your Father, who sees what is done in secret, will reward you openly.

Matthew 6:5

King James Version: And when thou prayest, thou shalt not be as the hypocrites are: for they love to pray standing in the synagogues and in the corners of the streets, that they may be seen of men. Verily I say unto you, They have their reward.

Decoded (Modern Language): And when you pray, don't be like the hypocrites who love to pray standing in the synagogues and on street corners to be seen by others. Truly I tell you, they have their reward.

Matthew 6:6

King James Version: But thou, when thou prayest, enter into thy closet, and when thou hast shut thy door, pray to thy Father which is in secret; and thy Father which seeth in secret shall reward thee openly.

Decoded (Modern Language): But when you pray, go into your room, close the door, and pray to your Father who is unseen. Then your Father, who sees what is done in secret, will reward you openly.

Matthew 6:7

King James Version: But when ye pray, use not vain repetitions, as the heathen do: for they think that they shall be heard for their much speaking.

Decoded (Modern Language): When you pray, don't use meaningless repetition like the pagans do, because they think they will be heard for their many words.

Matthew 6:8

King James Version: Be not ye therefore like unto them: for your Father knoweth what things ye have need of, before ye ask him.

Decoded (Modern Language): Don't be like them, because your Father knows what you need before you ask him.

Matthew 6:9

King James Version: After this manner therefore pray ye: Our Father which art in heaven, Hallowed be thy name.

Decoded (Modern Language): So pray like this: Our Father in heaven, may your name be honored.

Matthew 6:10

King James Version: Thy kingdom come. Thy will be done in earth, as it is in heaven.

Decoded (Modern Language): May your kingdom come. May your will be done on earth as it is in heaven.

Matthew 6:11

King James Version: Give us this day our daily bread.

Decoded (Modern Language): Give us today the food we need.

Matthew 6:12

King James Version: And forgive us our debts, as we forgive our debtors.

Decoded (Modern Language): And forgive us our debts, as we forgive those who owe us.

Matthew 6:13

King James Version: And lead us not into temptation, but deliver us from evil: For thine is the kingdom, and the power, and the glory, for ever. Amen.

Decoded (Modern Language): And don't lead us into temptation, but deliver us from evil. For the kingdom, the power, and the glory belong to you forever. Amen.

Matthew 6:14

King James Version: For if ye forgive men their trespasses, your heavenly Father will also forgive you:

Decoded (Modern Language): If you forgive others when they sin against you, your heavenly Father will also forgive you.

Matthew 6:15

King James Version: But if ye forgive not men their trespasses, neither will your Father forgive your trespasses.

Decoded (Modern Language): But if you don't forgive others, your Father will not forgive your sins.

Matthew 6:16

King James Version: Moreover when ye fast, be not, as the hypocrites, of a sad countenance: for they disfigure their faces, that they may appear unto men to fast. Verily I say unto you, They have their reward.

Decoded (Modern Language): When you fast, don't look sad like the hypocrites do, because they make their faces look gloomy to show others they are fasting. Truly I tell you, they have their reward.

Matthew 6:17

King James Version: But thou, when thou fastest, anoint thine head, and wash thy face;

Decoded (Modern Language): But when you fast, put oil on your head and wash your face,

Matthew 6:18

King James Version: That thou appear not unto men to fast, but unto thy Father which is in secret: and thy Father, which seeth in secret, shall reward thee openly.

Decoded (Modern Language): so that it won't be obvious to others that you are fasting, but only to your Father, who is unseen. And your Father, who sees what is done in secret, will reward you openly.

Matthew 6:19

King James Version: Lay not up for yourselves treasures upon earth, where moth and rust doth corrupt, and where thieves break through and steal:

Decoded (Modern Language): Don't store up treasures for yourselves on earth, where moths and rust destroy, and where thieves break in and steal.

Matthew 6:20

King James Version: But lay up for yourselves treasures in heaven, where neither moth nor rust doth corrupt, and where thieves do not break through nor steal:

Decoded (Modern Language): But store up treasures for yourselves in heaven, where moths and rust do not destroy, and where thieves do not break in or steal.

Matthew 6:21

King James Version: For where your treasure is, there will your heart be also.

Decoded (Modern Language): For where your treasure is, there your heart will be also.

Matthew 6:22

King James Version: The light of the body is the eye: if therefore thine eye be single, thy whole body shall be full of light.

Decoded (Modern Language): The eye is the lamp of the body. If your eye is healthy, your whole body will be full of light.

Matthew 6:23

King James Version: But if thine eye be evil, thy whole body shall be full of darkness. If therefore the light that is in thee be darkness, how great is that darkness!

Decoded (Modern Language): But if your eye is unhealthy, your whole body will be full of darkness. If the light you think you have is actually darkness, how deep that darkness is!

Matthew 6:24

King James Version: No man can serve two masters: for either he will hate the one, and love the other; or else he will hold to the one, and despise the other. Ye cannot serve God and mammon.

Decoded (Modern Language): No one can serve two masters. Either you will hate one and love the other, or you will be devoted to one and despise the other. You cannot serve both God and money.

Matthew 6:25

King James Version: Therefore I say unto you, Take no thought for your life, what ye shall eat, or what ye shall drink; nor yet for your body, what ye shall put on. Is not the life more than meat, and the body than raiment?

Decoded (Modern Language): So I tell you, don't worry about your life, what you will eat or drink, or about your body, what you will wear. Isn't life more than food, and the body more than clothes?

Matthew 6:26

King James Version: Behold the fowls of the air: for they sow not, neither do they reap, nor gather into barns; yet your heavenly Father feedeth them. Are ye not much better than they?

Decoded (Modern Language): Look at the birds of the air; they don't plant or harvest or store food in barns, yet your heavenly Father feeds them. Aren't you much more valuable than they are?

Matthew 6:27

King James Version: Which of you by taking thought can add one cubit unto his stature?

Decoded (Modern Language): Can any of you add even a single hour to your life by worrying?

Matthew 6:28

King James Version: And why take ye thought for raiment? Consider the lilies of the field, how they grow; they toil not, neither do they spin:

Decoded (Modern Language): And why do you worry about clothes? Look at the lilies of the field and how they grow. They don't work or make their clothing.

Matthew 6:29

King James Version: And yet I say unto you, That even Solomon in all his glory was not arrayed like one of these.

Decoded (Modern Language): Yet I tell you that not even Solomon in all his glory was dressed like one of these.

Matthew 6:30

King James Version: Wherefore, if God so clothe the grass of the field, which to day is, and to morrow is cast into the oven, shall he not much more clothe you, O ye of little faith?

Decoded (Modern Language): If God clothes the grass of the field, which is here today and gone tomorrow, won't he much more clothe you—you people of little faith?

Matthew 6:31

King James Version: Therefore take no thought, saying, What shall we eat? or, What shall we drink? or, Wherewithal shall we be clothed?

Decoded (Modern Language): So don't worry and say, 'What will we eat?' or 'What will we drink?' or 'What will we wear?'

Matthew 6:32

King James Version: (For after all these things do the Gentiles seek:) for your heavenly Father knoweth that ye have need of all these things.

Decoded (Modern Language): These things dominate the thoughts of unbelievers, but your heavenly Father already knows that you need all of them.

Matthew 6:33

King James Version: But seek ye first the kingdom of God, and his righteousness; and all these things shall be added unto you.

Decoded (Modern Language): But first look for God's kingdom and his righteousness, and all these things will be given to you as well.

Matthew 6:34

King James Version: Take therefore no thought for the morrow: for the morrow shall take thought for the things of itself. Sufficient unto the day is the evil thereof.

Decoded (Modern Language): So do not worry about tomorrow, because tomorrow will worry about itself. Each day has enough trouble of its own.

MATTHEW — CHAPTER 7

Matthew 7:1

King James Version: Judge not, that ye be not judged.

Decoded (Modern Language): Don't judge others, so that you will not be judged.

Matthew 7:2

King James Version: For with what judgment ye judge, ye shall be judged: and with what measure ye mete, it shall be measured to you again.

Decoded (Modern Language): Because the way you judge others is how you will be judged, and the measure you use will be measured to you.

Matthew 7:3

King James Version: And why beholdest thou the mote that is in thy brother's eye, but considerest not the beam that is in thine own eye?

Decoded (Modern Language): Why do you look at the small speck in your brother's eye but don't notice the big beam in your own eye?

Matthew 7:4

King James Version: Or how wilt thou say to thy brother, Let me pull out the mote out of thine eye; and, behold, a beam is in thine own eye?

Decoded (Modern Language): How can you say to your brother, 'Let me take the speck out of your eye,' when there is a big beam in your own eye?

Matthew 7:5

King James Version: Thou hypocrite, first cast out the beam out of thine own eye; and then shalt thou see clearly to cast out the mote out of thy brother's eye.

Decoded (Modern Language): You hypocrite, first take the beam out of your own eye, then you will see clearly to take the speck out of your brother's eye.

Matthew 7:6

King James Version: Give not that which is holy unto the dogs, neither cast ye your pearls before swine, lest they trample them under their feet, and turn again and rend you.

Decoded (Modern Language): Don't give what is holy to dogs, and don't throw your pearls before pigs, or they will trample them under their feet and turn and attack you.

Matthew 7:7

King James Version: Ask, and it shall be given you; seek, and ye shall find; knock, and it shall be opened unto you:

Decoded (Modern Language): Ask, and it will be given to you; seek, and you will find; knock, and the door will be opened to you.

Matthew 7:8

King James Version: For every one that asketh receiveth; and he that seeketh findeth; and to him that knocketh it shall be opened.

Decoded (Modern Language): Everyone who asks receives; the one who seeks finds; and to the one who knocks, the door will be opened.

Matthew 7:9

King James Version: Or what man is there of you, whom if his son ask bread, will he give him a stone?

Decoded (Modern Language): Which of you, if your son asks for bread, will give him a stone?

Matthew 7:10

King James Version: Or if he ask a fish, will he give him a serpent?

Decoded (Modern Language): Or if he asks for a fish, will give him a snake?

Matthew 7:11

King James Version: If ye then, being evil, know how to give good gifts unto your children, how much more shall your Father which is in heaven give good things to them that ask him?

Decoded (Modern Language): If you, though you are evil, know how to give good gifts to your children, how much more will your Father in heaven give good things to those who ask him?

Matthew 7:12

King James Version: Therefore all things whatsoever ye would that men should do to you, do ye even so to them: for this is the law and the prophets.

Decoded (Modern Language): So in everything, do to others what you want them to do to you, because this sums up the law and the prophets.

Matthew 7:13

King James Version: Enter ye in at the strait gate: for wide is the gate, and broad is the way, that leadeth to destruction, and many there be which go in thereat:

Decoded (Modern Language): Enter through the narrow gate, because the gate is wide and the road is broad that leads to destruction, and many enter through it.

Matthew 7:14

King James Version: Because strait is the gate, and narrow is the way, which leadeth unto life, and few there be that find it.

Decoded (Modern Language): But the gate is narrow and the road is hard that leads to life, and only a few find it.

Matthew 7:15

King James Version: Beware of false prophets, which come to you in sheep's clothing, but inwardly they are ravening wolves.

Decoded (Modern Language): Watch out for false prophets who come to you dressed as sheep, but inside they are dangerous wolves.

Matthew 7:16

King James Version: Ye shall know them by their fruits. Do men gather grapes of thorns, or figs of thistles?

Decoded (Modern Language): You will recognize them by their actions. Do people pick grapes from thorn bushes, or figs from thistles?

Matthew 7:17

King James Version: Even so every good tree bringeth forth good fruit; but a corrupt tree bringeth forth evil fruit.

Decoded (Modern Language): In the same way, every good tree produces good fruit, but a bad tree produces bad fruit.

Matthew 7:18

King James Version: A good tree cannot bring forth evil fruit, neither can a corrupt tree bring forth good fruit.

Decoded (Modern Language): A good tree cannot produce bad fruit, and a bad tree cannot produce good fruit.

Matthew 7:19

King James Version: Every tree that bringeth not forth good fruit is hewn down, and cast into the fire.

Decoded (Modern Language): Every tree that does not produce good fruit is cut down and thrown into the fire.

Matthew 7:20

King James Version: Wherefore by their fruits ye shall know them.

Decoded (Modern Language): So you will recognize them by their actions.

Matthew 7:21

King James Version: Not every one that saith unto me, Lord, Lord, shall enter into the kingdom of heaven; but he that doeth the will of my Father which is in heaven.

Decoded (Modern Language): Not everyone who says to me, 'Lord, Lord,' will enter the kingdom of heaven, but only those who do the will of my Father in heaven.

Matthew 7:22

King James Version: Many will say to me in that day, Lord, Lord, have we not prophesied in thy name? and in thy name have cast out devils? and in thy name done many wonderful works?

Decoded (Modern Language): Many will say to me on that day, 'Lord, Lord, didn't we prophesy in your name, cast out demons in your name, and do many miracles in your name?'

Matthew 7:23

King James Version: And then will I profess unto them, I never knew you: depart from me, ye that work iniquity.

Decoded (Modern Language): Then I will tell them plainly, 'I never knew you. Go away from me, you who break God's laws.'

Matthew 7:24

King James Version: Therefore whosoever heareth these sayings of mine, and doeth them, I will liken him unto a wise man, which built his house upon a rock:

Decoded (Modern Language): So everyone who hears my words and puts them into practice is like a wise man who built his house on solid rock.

Matthew 7:25

King James Version: And the rain descended, and the floods came, and the winds blew, and beat upon that house; and it fell not: for it was founded upon a rock.

Decoded (Modern Language): The rain came down, the floods rose, and the winds blew and beat against that house, but it did not fall because it was built on rock.

Matthew 7:26

King James Version: And every one that heareth these sayings of mine, and doeth them not, shall be likened unto a foolish man, which built his house upon the sand:

Decoded (Modern Language): But everyone who hears my words and does not put them into practice is like a foolish man who built his house on sand.

Matthew 7:27

King James Version: And the rain descended, and the floods came, and the winds blew, and beat upon that house; and it fell: and great was the fall of it.

Decoded (Modern Language): The rain came down, the floods rose, and the winds blew and beat against that house, and it fell with a great crash.

Matthew 7:28

King James Version: And it came to pass, when Jesus had ended these sayings, the people were astonished at his doctrine:

Decoded (Modern Language): When Jesus finished saying these things, the people were amazed at his teaching.

Matthew 7:29

King James Version: For he taught them as one having authority, and not as the scribes.

Decoded (Modern Language): He taught them with authority, not like the teachers of the law.

MATTHEW — CHAPTER 8**Matthew 8:1**

King James Version: When he was come down from the mountain, great multitudes followed him.

Decoded (Modern Language): When Jesus came down from the mountain, large crowds followed him.

Matthew 8:2

King James Version: And, behold, there came a leper and worshipped him, saying, Lord, if thou wilt, thou canst make me clean.

Decoded (Modern Language): A man with leprosy came to him, bowed down, and said, 'Lord, if you want to, you can make me clean.'

Matthew 8:3

King James Version: And Jesus put forth his hand, and touched him, saying, I will; be thou clean. And immediately his leprosy was cleansed.

Decoded (Modern Language): Jesus reached out his hand, touched him, and said, 'I want to. Be clean.' Immediately, the leprosy disappeared.

Matthew 8:4

King James Version: And Jesus saith unto him, See thou tell no man; but go thy way, shew thyself to the priest, and offer the gift that Moses commanded, for a testimony unto them.

Decoded (Modern Language): Jesus told him, 'Don't tell anyone. But go show yourself to the priest and offer the gift Moses commanded as proof to them.'

Matthew 8:5

King James Version: And when Jesus was entered into Capernaum, there came unto him a centurion, beseeching him,

Decoded (Modern Language): When Jesus entered Capernaum, a Roman officer came to him and asked for help.

Matthew 8:6

King James Version: And saying, Lord, my servant lieth at home sick of the palsy, grievously tormented.

Decoded (Modern Language): He said, 'Lord, my servant is lying at home paralyzed and suffering terribly.'

Matthew 8:7

King James Version: And Jesus saith unto him, I will come and heal him.

Decoded (Modern Language): Jesus said, 'I will come and heal him.'

Matthew 8:8

King James Version: The centurion answered and said, Lord, I am not worthy that thou shouldest come under my roof: but speak the word only, and my servant shall be healed.

Decoded (Modern Language): The officer replied, 'Lord, I'm not worthy to have you come under my roof. Just say the word, and my servant will be healed.'

Matthew 8:9

King James Version: For I am a man under authority, having soldiers under me: and I say to this man, Go, and he goeth; and to another, Come, and he cometh; and to my servant, Do this, and he doeth it.

Decoded (Modern Language): He explained, 'I am under authority, with soldiers under me. I tell one to go, and he goes; another to come, and he comes; and my servant to do something, and he does it.'

Matthew 8:10

King James Version: When Jesus heard it, he marvelled, and said to them that followed, Verily I say unto you, I have not found so great faith, no, not in Israel.

Decoded (Modern Language): When Jesus heard this, he was amazed and said to those following him, 'I tell you the truth, I have not found such great faith anywhere in Israel.'

Matthew 8:11

King James Version: And I say unto you, That many shall come from the east and west, and shall sit down with Abraham, and Isaac, and Jacob, in the kingdom of heaven.

Decoded (Modern Language): He said, 'Many will come from east and west and sit with Abraham, Isaac, and Jacob in the kingdom of heaven.'

Matthew 8:12

King James Version: But the children of the kingdom shall be cast out into outer darkness: there shall be weeping and gnashing of teeth.

Decoded (Modern Language): But the people who belong to the kingdom will be thrown outside, into the darkness, where there will be weeping and grinding of teeth.

Matthew 8:13

King James Version: And Jesus said unto the centurion, Go thy way; and as thou hast believed, so be it done unto thee. And his servant was healed in the selfsame hour.

Decoded (Modern Language): Jesus said to the officer, 'Go. Because you believed, it will happen.' And the servant was healed at that moment.

Matthew 8:14

King James Version: And when Jesus was come into Peter's house, he saw his wife's mother laid, and sick of a fever.

Decoded (Modern Language): When Jesus came to Peter's house, he saw Peter's mother-in-law sick with a fever.

Matthew 8:15

King James Version: And he touched her hand, and the fever left her: and she arose, and ministered unto them.

Decoded (Modern Language): He touched her hand, the fever left her, and she got up and served them.

Matthew 8:16

King James Version: When the even was come, they brought unto him many that were possessed with devils: and he cast out the spirits with his word, and healed all that were sick:

Decoded (Modern Language): In the evening, many people brought to Jesus those who were demon-possessed, and he drove out the spirits with a word and healed all the sick.

Matthew 8:17

King James Version: That it might be fulfilled which was spoken by Esaias the prophet, saying, Himself took our infirmities, and bare our sicknesses.

Decoded (Modern Language): This fulfilled what the prophet Isaiah said: 'He took our weaknesses and carried our diseases.'

Matthew 8:18

King James Version: Now when Jesus saw great multitudes about him, he gave commandment to depart unto the other side.

Decoded (Modern Language): When Jesus saw the large crowds around him, he told his disciples to go to the other side of the lake.

Matthew 8:19

King James Version: And a certain scribe came, and said unto him, Master, I will follow thee whithersoever thou goest.

Decoded (Modern Language): A teacher of the law came to him and said, 'Teacher, I will follow you wherever you go.'

Matthew 8:20

King James Version: And Jesus saith unto him, The foxes have holes, and the birds of the air have nests; but the Son of man hath not where to lay his head.

Decoded (Modern Language): Jesus said, 'Foxes have dens, and birds have nests, but the Son of Man has no place to rest his head.'

Matthew 8:21

King James Version: And another of his disciples said unto him, Lord, suffer me first to go and bury my father.

Decoded (Modern Language): Another disciple said, 'Lord, first let me go and bury my father.'

Matthew 8:22

King James Version: But Jesus said unto him, Follow me; and let the dead bury their dead.

Decoded (Modern Language): Jesus said, 'Follow me, and let the dead bury their own dead.'

Matthew 8:23

King James Version: And when he was entered into a ship, his disciples followed him.

Decoded (Modern Language): Jesus got into a boat, and his disciples followed him.

Matthew 8:24

King James Version: And, behold, there arose a great tempest in the sea, insomuch that the ship was covered with the waves: but he was asleep.

Decoded (Modern Language): Suddenly, a violent storm came up on the lake, so that the waves covered the boat, but Jesus was sleeping.

Matthew 8:25

King James Version: And his disciples came to him, and awoke him, saying, Lord, save us: we perish.

Decoded (Modern Language): The disciples woke him and said, 'Lord, save us! We're going to drown!'

Matthew 8:26

King James Version: And he saith unto them, Why are ye fearful, O ye of little faith? Then he arose, and rebuked the winds and the sea; and there was a great calm.

Decoded (Modern Language): Jesus said, 'Why are you afraid, you people with so little faith?' Then he stood up, commanded the winds and the waves to be quiet, and the storm stopped.

Matthew 8:27

King James Version: But the men marvelled, saying, What manner of man is this, that even the winds and the sea obey him!

Decoded (Modern Language): The men were amazed and said, 'What kind of man is this? Even the winds and the sea obey him!'

Matthew 8:28

King James Version: And when he was come to the other side into the country of the Gergesenes, there met him two possessed with devils, coming out of the tombs, exceeding fierce, so that no man might pass by that way.

Decoded (Modern Language): When Jesus arrived on the other side, in the region of the Gadarenes, two men possessed by demons came out of the tombs. They were so violent that no one could pass that way.

Matthew 8:29

King James Version: And, behold, they cried out, saying, What have we to do with thee, Jesus, thou Son of God? art thou come hither to torment us before the time?

Decoded (Modern Language): They shouted, 'What do you want with us, Jesus, Son of God? Have you come here to torture us before the time?'

Matthew 8:30

King James Version: And there was a good way off from them an herd of many swine feeding.

Decoded (Modern Language): Some distance away, a large herd of pigs was feeding.

Matthew 8:31

King James Version: So the devils besought him, saying, If thou cast us out, suffer us to go away into the herd of swine.

Decoded (Modern Language): The demons begged Jesus, 'If you drive us out, send us into the pigs.'

Matthew 8:32

King James Version: And he said unto them, Go. And when they were come out, they went into the herd of swine: and, behold, the whole herd of swine ran violently down a steep place into the sea, and perished in the waters.

Decoded (Modern Language): He said, 'Go.' So the demons came out and entered the pigs, and the whole herd rushed down the steep bank into the lake and drowned.

Matthew 8:33

King James Version: And they that kept them fled, and went their ways into the city, and told every thing, and what was befallen to the possessed of the devils.

Decoded (Modern Language): The people who were watching the pigs ran away and went into the city, telling everything that had happened to the men possessed by demons.

Matthew 8:34

King James Version: And, behold, the whole city came out to meet Jesus: and when they saw him, they besought him that he would depart out of their coasts.

Decoded (Modern Language): Then the whole city came out to meet Jesus. When they saw him, they begged him to leave their area.

MATTHEW — CHAPTER 9

Matthew 9:1

King James Version: And he entered into a ship, and passed over, and came into his own city.

Decoded (Modern Language): Jesus got into a boat, crossed over, and came to his own town.

Matthew 9:2

King James Version: And, behold, they brought to him a man sick of the palsy, lying on a bed: and Jesus seeing their faith said unto the sick of the palsy; Son, be of good cheer; thy sins be forgiven thee.

Decoded (Modern Language): Some people brought to him a paralyzed man lying on a bed. Jesus saw their faith and said to the paralyzed man, 'Son, be encouraged; your sins are forgiven.'

Matthew 9:3

King James Version: And, behold, certain of the scribes said within themselves, This man blasphemeth.

Decoded (Modern Language): Some of the teachers of the law said to themselves, 'This man is blaspheming.'

Matthew 9:4

King James Version: And Jesus knowing their thoughts said, Wherefore think ye evil in your hearts?

Decoded (Modern Language): Jesus knew what they were thinking and said, 'Why do you think evil things in your hearts?'

Matthew 9:5

King James Version: For whether is easier, to say, Thy sins be forgiven thee; or to say, Arise, and walk?

Decoded (Modern Language): Which is easier: to say, 'Your sins are forgiven,' or to say, 'Get up and walk'?

Matthew 9:6

King James Version: But that ye may know that the Son of man hath power on earth to forgive sins, (then saith he to the sick of the palsy,) Arise, take up thy bed, and go unto thine house.

Decoded (Modern Language): But so you may know that the Son of Man has authority on earth to forgive sins, he said to the paralyzed man, 'Get up, take your bed, and go home.'

Matthew 9:7

King James Version: And he arose, and departed to his house.

Decoded (Modern Language): The man got up and went home.

Matthew 9:8

King James Version: But when the multitudes saw it, they marvelled, and glorified God, which had given such power unto men.

Decoded (Modern Language): When the crowds saw this, they were amazed and praised God, who had given such power to people.

Matthew 9:9

King James Version: And as Jesus passed forth from thence, he saw a man, named Matthew, sitting at the receipt of custom: and he saith unto him, Follow me. And he arose, and followed him.

Decoded (Modern Language): As Jesus went on from there, he saw a man named Matthew sitting at the tax collector's booth. Jesus said to him, 'Follow me.' Matthew got up and followed him.

Matthew 9:10

King James Version: And it came to pass, as Jesus sat at meat in the house, behold, many publicans and sinners came and sat down with him and his disciples.

Decoded (Modern Language): Later, Jesus was eating at a house, and many tax collectors and sinners came and sat with him and his followers.

Matthew 9:11

King James Version: And when the Pharisees saw it, they said unto his disciples, Why eateth your Master with publicans and sinners?

Decoded (Modern Language): When the Pharisees saw this, they asked Jesus' followers, 'Why does your teacher eat with tax collectors and sinners?'

Matthew 9:12

King James Version: But when Jesus heard that, he said unto them, They that be whole need not a physician, but they that are sick.

Decoded (Modern Language): Jesus heard this and said, 'Healthy people don't need a doctor, but sick people do.'

Matthew 9:13

King James Version: But go ye and learn what that meaneth, I will have mercy, and not sacrifice: for I am not come to call the righteous, but sinners to repentance.

Decoded (Modern Language): Then he said, 'Go and learn what this means: I want mercy, not sacrifice. I have not come to call good people, but sinners to change their hearts.'

Matthew 9:14

King James Version: Then came to him the disciples of John, saying, Why do we and the Pharisees fast oft, but thy disciples fast not?

Decoded (Modern Language): Then the followers of John came to Jesus and asked, 'Why do we and the Pharisees fast often, but your followers don't fast?'

Matthew 9:15

King James Version: And Jesus said unto them, Can the children of the bridechamber mourn, as long as the bridegroom is with them? but the days will come, when the bridegroom shall be taken from them, and then shall they fast.

Decoded (Modern Language): Jesus answered, 'Can the friends of the bridegroom be sad while he is with them? But the time will come when the bridegroom is taken away, and then they will fast.'

Matthew 9:16

King James Version: No man putteth a piece of new cloth unto an old garment, for that which is put in to fill it up taketh from the garment, and the rent is made worse.

Decoded (Modern Language): No one patches old clothes with new cloth, because the new patch will shrink and make the tear worse.

Matthew 9:17

King James Version: Neither do men put new wine into old bottles: else the bottles break, and the wine runneth out, and the bottles perish: but they put new wine into new bottles, and both are preserved.

Decoded (Modern Language): And no one puts new wine into old wineskins, because the skins will burst. New wine must be put into new wineskins, so both are kept safe.

Matthew 9:18

King James Version: While he spake these things unto them, behold, there came a certain ruler, and worshipped him, saying, My daughter is even now dead: but come and lay thy hand upon her, and she shall live.

Decoded (Modern Language): While Jesus was speaking, a leader came and bowed before him, saying, 'My daughter has just died, but come and put your hand on her, and she will live.'

Matthew 9:19

King James Version: And Jesus arose, and followed him, and so did his disciples.

Decoded (Modern Language): Jesus got up and went with him, and his followers went too.

Matthew 9:20

King James Version: And, behold, a woman, which was diseased with an issue of blood twelve years, came behind him, and touched the hem of his garment:

Decoded (Modern Language): A woman who had been bleeding for twelve years came behind Jesus and touched the edge of his clothes.

Matthew 9:21

King James Version: For she said within herself, If I may but touch his garment, I shall be whole.

Decoded (Modern Language): She thought, 'If I can just touch his clothes, I will be healed.'

Matthew 9:22

King James Version: But Jesus turned him about, and when he saw her, he said, Daughter, be of good comfort; thy faith hath made thee whole. And the woman was made whole from that hour.

Decoded (Modern Language): Jesus turned around, saw her, and said, 'Daughter, be encouraged; your faith has healed you.' From that moment, the woman was healed.

Matthew 9:23

King James Version: And when Jesus came into the ruler's house, and saw the minstrels and the people making a noise,

Decoded (Modern Language): When Jesus arrived at the leader's house, he saw people playing music and making a lot of noise.

Matthew 9:24

King James Version: He said unto them, Give place: for the maid is not dead, but sleepeth. And they laughed him to scorn.

Decoded (Modern Language): He said, 'Go away; the girl is not dead but sleeping.' But they laughed at him.

Matthew 9:25

King James Version: But when the people were put forth, he went in, and took her by the hand, and the maid arose.

Decoded (Modern Language): After sending the crowd away, Jesus went in, took the girl's hand, and she got up.

Matthew 9:26

King James Version: And the fame hereof went abroad into all that land.

Decoded (Modern Language): News about this spread throughout the whole area.

Matthew 9:27

King James Version: And when Jesus departed thence, two blind men followed him, crying, and saying, Thou Son of David, have mercy on us.

Decoded (Modern Language): As Jesus left, two blind men followed him, shouting, 'Son of David, have mercy on us!'

Matthew 9:28

King James Version: And when he was come into the house, the blind men came to him: and Jesus saith unto them, Believe ye that I am able to do this? They said unto him, Yea, Lord.

Decoded (Modern Language): When Jesus entered the house, the blind men came to him. Jesus asked, 'Do you believe I can heal you?' They answered, 'Yes, Lord.'

Matthew 9:29

King James Version: Then touched he their eyes, saying, According to your faith be it unto you.

Decoded (Modern Language): Then he touched their eyes and said, 'Let it happen as you believe.'

Matthew 9:30

King James Version: And their eyes were opened; and Jesus straitly charged them, saying, See that no man know it.

Decoded (Modern Language): Their eyes were opened, and Jesus warned them strictly, 'Don't let anyone know about this.'

Matthew 9:31

King James Version: But they, when they were departed, spread abroad his fame in all that country.

Decoded (Modern Language): But after they left, they spread the news about him all over that country.

Matthew 9:32

King James Version: As they went out, behold, they brought to him a dumb man possessed with a devil.

Decoded (Modern Language): As they went out, some people brought to Jesus a man who could not speak because he was possessed by a demon.

Matthew 9:33

King James Version: And when the devil was cast out, the dumb spake: and the multitudes marvelled, saying, It was never so seen in Israel.

Decoded (Modern Language): When the demon was driven out, the man who could not speak began to talk, and the crowd was amazed, saying, 'Nothing like this has ever been seen in Israel.'

Matthew 9:34

King James Version: But the Pharisees said, He casteth out devils through the prince of the devils.

Decoded (Modern Language): But the Pharisees said, 'He drives out demons by the power of the prince of demons.'

Matthew 9:35

King James Version: And Jesus went about all the cities and villages, teaching in their synagogues, and preaching the gospel of the kingdom, and healing every sickness and every disease among the people.

Decoded (Modern Language): Jesus went through all the towns and villages, teaching in their synagogues, preaching the good news about the kingdom, and healing every sickness and disease among the people.

Matthew 9:36

King James Version: But when he saw the multitudes, he was moved with compassion on them, because they fainted, and were scattered abroad, as sheep having no shepherd.

Decoded (Modern Language): When he saw the crowds, he felt deep compassion for them because they were tired and helpless, like sheep without a shepherd.

Matthew 9:37

King James Version: Then saith he unto his disciples, The harvest truly is plenteous, but the labourers are few;

Decoded (Modern Language): Then he said to his disciples, 'There are many people ready to be gathered, but few workers to gather them.'

Matthew 9:38

King James Version: Pray ye therefore the Lord of the harvest, that he will send forth labourers into his harvest.

Decoded (Modern Language): So ask the Lord who is in charge of the harvest to send more workers to gather his harvest.

MATTHEW — CHAPTER 10**Matthew 10:1**

King James Version: And when he had called unto him his twelve disciples, he gave them power against unclean spirits, to cast them out, and to heal all manner of sickness and all manner of disease.

Decoded (Modern Language): When Jesus called his twelve disciples to him, he gave them power to drive out evil spirits and to heal every kind of sickness and disease.

Matthew 10:2

King James Version: Now the names of the twelve apostles are these; The first, Simon, who is called Peter, and Andrew his brother; James the son of Zebedee, and John his brother;

Decoded (Modern Language): Here are the names of the twelve apostles: first, Simon, called Peter, and his brother Andrew; James, son of Zebedee, and his brother John;

Matthew 10:3

King James Version: Philip, and Bartholomew; Thomas, and Matthew the publican; James the son of Alphaeus, and Lebbaeus, whose surname was Thaddaeus;

Decoded (Modern Language): Philip and Bartholomew; Thomas and Matthew the tax collector; James, son of Alphaeus, and Lebbaeus, also called Thaddaeus;

Matthew 10:4

King James Version: Simon the Canaanite, and Judas Iscariot, who also betrayed him.

Decoded (Modern Language): Simon the Zealot, and Judas Iscariot, who later betrayed him.

Matthew 10:5

King James Version: These twelve Jesus sent forth, and commanded them, saying, Go not into the way of the Gentiles, and into any city of the Samaritans enter ye not:

Decoded (Modern Language): Jesus sent these twelve out and told them, 'Do not go to the Gentiles or enter any Samaritan town.'

Matthew 10:6

King James Version: But go rather to the lost sheep of the house of Israel.

Decoded (Modern Language): Instead, go to the lost sheep of Israel.

Matthew 10:7

King James Version: And as ye go, preach, saying, The kingdom of heaven is at hand.

Decoded (Modern Language): As you go, preach this message: 'The kingdom of heaven is near.'

Matthew 10:8

King James Version: Heal the sick, cleanse the lepers, raise the dead, cast out devils: freely ye have received, freely give.

Decoded (Modern Language): Heal the sick, raise the dead, cleanse those with leprosy, and drive out demons. You received freely, so give freely.

Matthew 10:9

King James Version: Provide neither gold, nor silver, nor brass in your purses,

Decoded (Modern Language): Do not take gold, silver, or copper in your money belts.

Matthew 10:10

King James Version: Nor scrip for your journey, neither two coats, neither shoes, nor yet staves: for the workman is worthy of his meat.

Decoded (Modern Language): Do not take a bag for your journey, or extra clothes, or sandals, or a walking stick. A worker deserves to be paid.

Matthew 10:11

King James Version: And into whatsoever city or town ye shall enter, enquire who in it is worthy; and there abide till ye go thence.

Decoded (Modern Language): When you enter a town or village, find out who is worthy and stay there until you leave.

Matthew 10:12

King James Version: And when ye come into an house, salute it.

Decoded (Modern Language): When you enter a house, greet the people there.

Matthew 10:13

King James Version: And if the house be worthy, let your peace come upon it: but if it be not worthy, let your peace return to you.

Decoded (Modern Language): If the house is worthy, let your peace rest on it. If it is not, let your peace return to you.

Matthew 10:14

King James Version: And whosoever shall not receive you, nor hear your words, when ye depart out of that house or city, shake off the dust of your feet.

Decoded (Modern Language): If anyone will not welcome you or listen to your message, leave that house or town and shake the dust off your feet.

Matthew 10:15

King James Version: Verily I say unto you, It shall be more tolerable for the land of Sodom and Gomorrha in the day of judgment, than for that city.

Decoded (Modern Language): I tell you the truth, it will be more bearable for Sodom and Gomorrah on the day of judgment than for that town.

Matthew 10:16

King James Version: Behold, I send you forth as sheep in the midst of wolves: be ye therefore wise as serpents, and harmless as doves.

Decoded (Modern Language): I am sending you out like sheep among wolves. So be as wise as snakes and as harmless as doves.

Matthew 10:17

King James Version: But beware of men: for they will deliver you up to the councils, and they will scourge you in their synagogues;

Decoded (Modern Language): Be careful, because people will hand you over to courts and will whip you in their synagogues.

Matthew 10:18

King James Version: And ye shall be brought before governors and kings for my sake, for a testimony against them and the Gentiles.

Decoded (Modern Language): You will be brought before governors and kings because of me, to testify to them and to the Gentiles.

Matthew 10:19

King James Version: But when they deliver you up, take no thought how or what ye shall speak: for it shall be given you in that same hour what ye shall speak.

Decoded (Modern Language): When you are arrested, do not worry about what to say or how to say it. At that time, you will be given what to say.

Matthew 10:20

King James Version: For it is not ye that speak, but the Spirit of your Father which speaketh in you.

Decoded (Modern Language): It will not be you speaking, but the Spirit of your Father speaking through you.

Matthew 10:21

King James Version: And the brother shall deliver up the brother to death, and the father the child: and the children shall rise up against their parents, and cause them to be put to death.

Decoded (Modern Language): Brother will betray brother to death, and a father will betray his child. Children will rebel against their parents and have them put to death.

Matthew 10:22

King James Version: And ye shall be hated of all men for my name's sake: but he that endureth to the end shall be saved.

Decoded (Modern Language): You will be hated by everyone because of me. But the one who endures to the end will be saved.

Matthew 10:23

King James Version: But when they persecute you in this city, flee ye into another: for verily I say unto you, Ye shall not have gone over the cities of Israel, till the Son of man be come.

Decoded (Modern Language): When you are persecuted in one town, flee to another. I tell you the truth, you will not finish going through the towns of Israel before the Son of Man comes.

Matthew 10:24

King James Version: The disciple is not above his master, nor the servant above his lord.

Decoded (Modern Language): A student is not above the teacher, and a servant is not above the master.

Matthew 10:25

King James Version: It is enough for the disciple that he be as his master, and the servant as his lord. If they have called the master of the house Beelzebub, how much more shall they call them of his household?

Decoded (Modern Language): It is enough for the student to be like the teacher, and the servant like the master. If they have called the master Beelzebub, how much more will they insult those of his household!

Matthew 10:26

King James Version: Fear them not therefore: for there is nothing covered, that shall not be revealed; and hid, that shall not be known.

Decoded (Modern Language): So do not be afraid of them, because there is nothing hidden that will not be revealed, and nothing secret that will not be made known.

Matthew 10:27

King James Version: What I tell you in darkness, that speak ye in light: and what ye hear in the ear, that preach ye upon the housetops.

Decoded (Modern Language): What I tell you in the dark, speak in the daylight; what you hear whispered, proclaim from the roofs.

Matthew 10:28

King James Version: And fear not them which kill the body, but are not able to kill the soul: but rather fear him which is able to destroy both soul and body in hell.

Decoded (Modern Language): Do not be afraid of those who kill the body but cannot kill the soul. Instead, fear the one who can destroy both soul and body in hell.

Matthew 10:29

King James Version: Are not two sparrows sold for a farthing? and one of them shall not fall on the ground without your Father.

Decoded (Modern Language): Are not two sparrows sold for a penny? Yet not one of them will fall to the ground without your Father knowing it.

Matthew 10:30

King James Version: But the very hairs of your head are all numbered.

Decoded (Modern Language): Even the hairs on your head are all counted.

Matthew 10:31

King James Version: Fear ye not therefore, ye are of more value than many sparrows.

Decoded (Modern Language): So do not be afraid; you are worth more than many sparrows.

Matthew 10:32

King James Version: Whosoever therefore shall confess me before men, him will I confess also before my Father which is in heaven.

Decoded (Modern Language): Whoever acknowledges me before others, I will also acknowledge before my Father in heaven.

Matthew 10:33

King James Version: But whosoever shall deny me before men, him will I also deny before my Father which is in heaven.

Decoded (Modern Language): But anyone who denies me before people, I will also deny before my Father in heaven.

Matthew 10:34

King James Version: Think not that I am come to send peace on earth: I came not to send peace, but a sword.

Decoded (Modern Language): Don't think that I came to bring peace on earth. I did not come to bring peace, but a sword.

Matthew 10:35

King James Version: For I am come to set a man at variance against his father, and the daughter against her mother, and the daughter in law against her mother in law.

Decoded (Modern Language): I came to cause a man to be against his father, a daughter against her mother, and a daughter-in-law against her mother-in-law.

Matthew 10:36

King James Version: And a man's foes shall be they of his own household.

Decoded (Modern Language): A person's enemies will be those in their own household.

Matthew 10:37

King James Version: He that loveth father or mother more than me is not worthy of me: and he that loveth son or daughter more than me is not worthy of me.

Decoded (Modern Language): Anyone who loves their father or mother more than me is not worthy of me. Anyone who loves their son or daughter more than me is not worthy of me.

Matthew 10:38

King James Version: And he that taketh not his cross, and followeth after me, is not worthy of me.

Decoded (Modern Language): Anyone who does not take up their cross and follow me is not worthy of me.

Matthew 10:39

King James Version: He that findeth his life shall lose it: and he that loseth his life for my sake shall find it.

Decoded (Modern Language): Anyone who finds their life will lose it, but anyone who loses their life for my sake will find it.

Matthew 10:40

King James Version: He that receiveth you receiveth me, and he that receiveth me receiveth him that sent me.

Decoded (Modern Language): Anyone who welcomes you welcomes me, and anyone who welcomes me welcomes the one who sent me.

Matthew 10:41

King James Version: He that receiveth a prophet in the name of a prophet shall receive a prophet's reward; and he that receiveth a righteous man in the name of a righteous man shall receive a righteous man's reward.

Decoded (Modern Language): Anyone who welcomes a prophet because they are a prophet will receive a prophet's reward. Anyone who welcomes a righteous person because they are righteous will receive a righteous person's reward.

Matthew 10:42

King James Version: And whosoever shall give to drink unto one of these little ones a cup of cold water only in the name of a disciple, verily I say unto you, he shall in no wise lose his reward.

Decoded (Modern Language): And anyone who gives even a cup of cold water to one of these little ones because they are my disciple will certainly not lose their reward.

MATTHEW — CHAPTER 11**Matthew 11:1**

King James Version: And it came to pass, when Jesus had made an end of commanding his twelve disciples, he departed thence to teach and to preach in their cities.

Decoded (Modern Language): After Jesus finished giving instructions to his twelve disciples, he left there to teach and preach in their towns.

Matthew 11:2

King James Version: Now when John had heard in the prison the works of Christ, he sent two of his disciples,

Decoded (Modern Language): When John was in prison and heard about what Christ was doing, he sent two of his disciples to him,

Matthew 11:3

King James Version: And said unto him, Art thou he that should come, or do we look for another?

Decoded (Modern Language): and asked, 'Are you the one we are waiting for, or should we expect someone else?'

Matthew 11:4

King James Version: Jesus answered and said unto them, Go and shew John again those things which ye do hear and see:

Decoded (Modern Language): Jesus answered, 'Go back and tell John what you hear and see:

Matthew 11:5

King James Version: The blind receive their sight, and the lame walk, the lepers are cleansed, and the deaf hear, the dead are raised up, and the poor have the gospel preached to them.

Decoded (Modern Language): The blind can see, the lame walk, those with leprosy are healed, the deaf hear, the dead are raised, and the good news is preached to the poor.

Matthew 11:6

King James Version: And blessed is he, whosoever shall not be offended in me.

Decoded (Modern Language): Happy is anyone who is not offended by me.'

Matthew 11:7

King James Version: And as they departed, Jesus began to say unto the multitudes concerning John, What went ye out into the wilderness to see? A reed shaken with the wind?

Decoded (Modern Language): As they left, Jesus began to speak to the crowd about John: 'What did you go out into the wilderness to see? A reed blown by the wind?

Matthew 11:8

King James Version: But what went ye out for to see? A man clothed in soft raiment? behold, they that wear soft clothing are in kings' houses.

Decoded (Modern Language): Or what did you go out to see? A man dressed in fine clothes? People who wear fine clothes live in kings' palaces.

Matthew 11:9

King James Version: But what went ye out for to see? A prophet? yea, I say unto you, and more than a prophet.

Decoded (Modern Language): Then what did you go out to see? A prophet? Yes, I tell you, and even more than a prophet.

Matthew 11:10

King James Version: For this is he, of whom it is written, Behold, I send my messenger before thy face, which shall prepare thy way before thee.

Decoded (Modern Language): This is the one spoken about in the Scriptures: "I am sending my messenger ahead of you, who will prepare your way before you."

Matthew 11:11

King James Version: Verily I say unto you, Among them that are born of women there hath not risen a greater than John the Baptist: notwithstanding he that is least in the kingdom of heaven is greater than he.

Decoded (Modern Language): I tell you the truth, among those born of women there has not risen anyone greater than John the Baptist; yet the least in the kingdom of heaven is greater than he.

Matthew 11:12

King James Version: And from the days of John the Baptist until now the kingdom of heaven suffereth violence, and the violent take it by force.

Decoded (Modern Language): From the time of John the Baptist until now, the kingdom of heaven has been forcefully advancing, and forceful people are taking it by force.

Matthew 11:13

King James Version: For all the prophets and the law prophesied until John.

Decoded (Modern Language): All the prophets and the law prophesied until John.

Matthew 11:14

King James Version: And if ye will receive it, this is Elias, which was for to come.

Decoded (Modern Language): And if you are willing to accept it, he is the Elijah who was to come.

Matthew 11:15

King James Version: He that hath ears to hear, let him hear.

Decoded (Modern Language): Anyone who has ears to hear should listen.

Matthew 11:16

King James Version: But whereunto shall I liken this generation? It is like unto children sitting in the markets, and calling unto their fellows,

Decoded (Modern Language): What can I compare this generation to? It is like children sitting in the marketplace, calling to others,

Matthew 11:17

King James Version: And saying, We have piped unto you, and ye have not danced; we have mourned unto you, and ye have not lamented.

Decoded (Modern Language): and saying, 'We played the pipe for you, but you did not dance; we sang sad songs, but you did not cry.'

Matthew 11:18

King James Version: For John came neither eating nor drinking, and they say, He hath a devil.

Decoded (Modern Language): John came neither eating nor drinking, and they said, 'He has a demon.'

Matthew 11:19

King James Version: The Son of man came eating and drinking, and they say, Behold a man gluttonous, and a winebibber, a friend of publicans and sinners. But wisdom is justified of her children.

Decoded (Modern Language): The Son of Man came eating and drinking, and they say, 'Look, a glutton and a drunkard, a friend of tax collectors and sinners!' But wisdom is proved right by her actions.

Matthew 11:20

King James Version: Then began he to upbraid the cities wherein most of his mighty works were done, because they repented not:

Decoded (Modern Language): Then Jesus began to criticize the towns where he had done most of his miracles because they did not repent.

Matthew 11:21

King James Version: Woe unto thee, Chorazin! woe unto thee, Bethsaida! for if the mighty works, which were done in you, had been done in Tyre and Sidon, they would have repented long ago in sackcloth and ashes.

Decoded (Modern Language): Woe to you, Chorazin! Woe to you, Bethsaida! If the miracles done in you had been done in Tyre and Sidon, they would have repented long ago in sackcloth and ashes.

Matthew 11:22

King James Version: But I say unto you, It shall be more tolerable for Tyre and Sidon at the day of judgment, than for you.

Decoded (Modern Language): But I tell you, it will be more bearable for Tyre and Sidon on the day of judgment than for you.

Matthew 11:23

King James Version: And thou, Capernaum, which art exalted unto heaven, shalt be brought down to hell: for if the mighty works, which have been done in thee, had been done in Sodom, it would have remained until this day.

Decoded (Modern Language): And you, Capernaum, will be brought down to hell. If the miracles done in you had been done in Sodom, it would have survived until today.

Matthew 11:24

King James Version: But I say unto you, That it shall be more tolerable for the land of Sodom in the day of judgment, than for thee.

Decoded (Modern Language): But I tell you, it will be more bearable for Sodom on the day of judgment than for you.

Matthew 11:25

King James Version: At that time Jesus answered and said, I thank thee, O Father, Lord of heaven and earth, because thou hast hid these things from the wise and prudent, and hast revealed them unto babes.

Decoded (Modern Language): At that time Jesus said, 'I thank you, Father, Lord of heaven and earth, because you have hidden these things from the wise and learned, and revealed them to little children.

Matthew 11:26

King James Version: Even so, Father: for so it seemed good in thy sight.

Decoded (Modern Language): Yes, Father, for this is what you were pleased to do.

Matthew 11:27

King James Version: All things are delivered unto me of my Father: and no man knoweth the Son, but the Father; neither knoweth any man the Father, save the Son, and he to whomsoever the Son will reveal him.

Decoded (Modern Language): All things have been given to me by my Father. No one knows the Son except the Father, and no one knows the Father except the Son and those to whom the Son chooses to reveal him.

Matthew 11:28

King James Version: Come unto me, all ye that labour and are heavy laden, and I will give you rest.

Decoded (Modern Language): Come to me, all of you who are tired and carry heavy burdens, and I will give you rest.

Matthew 11:29

King James Version: Take my yoke upon you, and learn of me; for I am meek and lowly in heart: and ye shall find rest unto your souls.

Decoded (Modern Language): Take my yoke upon you and learn from me, because I am gentle and humble in heart, and you will find rest for your souls.

Matthew 11:30

King James Version: For my yoke is easy, and my burden is light.

Decoded (Modern Language): My yoke is easy, and my burden is light.

MATTHEW — CHAPTER 12

Matthew 12:1

King James Version: At that time Jesus went on the sabbath day through the corn; and his disciples were an hungred, and began to pluck the ears of corn, and to eat.

Decoded (Modern Language): At that time Jesus went through the grain fields on the Sabbath day, and his disciples were hungry. They began to pick some heads of grain and eat them.

Matthew 12:2

King James Version: But when the Pharisees saw it, they said unto him, Behold, thy disciples do that which is not lawful to do upon the sabbath day.

Decoded (Modern Language): When the Pharisees saw this, they said to him, 'Look, your disciples are doing what is not allowed on the Sabbath.'

Matthew 12:3

King James Version: But he said unto them, Have ye not read what David did, when he was an hungred, and they that were with him;

Decoded (Modern Language): Jesus answered them, 'Haven't you read what David did when he and his companions were hungry?

Matthew 12:4

King James Version: How he entered into the house of God, and did eat the shewbread, which was not lawful for him to eat, neither for them which were with him, but only for the priests?

Decoded (Modern Language): How he entered the house of God and ate the consecrated bread, which only the priests are allowed to eat?'

Matthew 12:5

King James Version: Or have ye not read in the law, how that on the sabbath days the priests in the temple profane the sabbath, and are blameless?

Decoded (Modern Language): Or haven't you read in the law that the priests in the temple break the Sabbath and yet are innocent?

Matthew 12:6

King James Version: But I say unto you, That in this place is one greater than the temple.

Decoded (Modern Language): But I tell you, there is someone here who is greater than the temple.

Matthew 12:7

King James Version: But if ye had known what this meaneth, I will have mercy, and not sacrifice, ye would not have condemned the guiltless.

Decoded (Modern Language): If you had understood what this means: I want mercy, not sacrifice, you would not have condemned the innocent.

Matthew 12:8

King James Version: For the Son of man is Lord even of the sabbath day.

Decoded (Modern Language): For the Son of Man is Lord of the Sabbath.

Matthew 12:9

King James Version: And when he was departed thence, he went into their synagogue:

Decoded (Modern Language): After Jesus left there, he went into their synagogue.

Matthew 12:10

King James Version: And, behold, there was a man which had his hand withered. And they asked him, saying, Is it lawful to heal on the sabbath days? that they might accuse him.

Decoded (Modern Language): There was a man there with a withered hand. They asked Jesus, 'Is it lawful to heal on the Sabbath?' so they could accuse him.

Matthew 12:11

King James Version: And he said unto them, What man shall there be among you, that shall have one sheep, and if it fall into a pit on the sabbath day, will he not lay hold on it, and lift it out?

Decoded (Modern Language): He said to them, 'If one of you has a sheep that falls into a pit on the Sabbath, won't you take hold of it and lift it out?'

Matthew 12:12

King James Version: How much then is a man better than a sheep? Wherefore it is lawful to do well on the sabbath days.

Decoded (Modern Language): How much more valuable is a person than a sheep! So it is lawful to do good on the Sabbath.

Matthew 12:13

King James Version: Then saith he to the man, Stretch forth thine hand. And he stretched it forth; and it was restored whole, like as the other.

Decoded (Modern Language): Then Jesus said to the man, 'Stretch out your hand.' He stretched it out, and it was completely restored, just like the other hand.

Matthew 12:14

King James Version: Then the Pharisees went out, and held a council against him, how they might destroy him.

Decoded (Modern Language): The Pharisees went out and began to plot how they might kill Jesus.

Matthew 12:15

King James Version: But when Jesus knew it, he withdrew himself from thence: and great multitudes followed him, and he healed them all;

Decoded (Modern Language): But Jesus, knowing this, withdrew from that place. Large crowds followed him, and he healed all of them.

Matthew 12:16

King James Version: And charged them that they should not make him known:

Decoded (Modern Language): He warned them not to tell others about him.

Matthew 12:17

King James Version: That it might be fulfilled which was spoken by Esaias the prophet, saying,

Decoded (Modern Language): This was to fulfill what was spoken through the prophet Isaiah:

Matthew 12:18

King James Version: Behold my servant, whom I have chosen; my beloved, in whom my soul is well pleased: I will put my spirit upon him, and he shall shew judgment to the Gentiles.

Decoded (Modern Language): 'Here is my servant whom I have chosen, my beloved, in whom I am pleased. I will put my Spirit on him, and he will bring justice to the nations.'

Matthew 12:19

King James Version: He shall not strive, nor cry; neither shall any man hear his voice in the streets.

Decoded (Modern Language): He will not argue or shout, nor will anyone hear his voice in the streets.

Matthew 12:20

King James Version: A bruised reed shall he not break, and smoking flax shall he not quench, till he send forth judgment unto victory.

Decoded (Modern Language): He will not break a bruised reed or put out a smoldering wick until he brings justice to victory.

Matthew 12:21

King James Version: And in his name shall the Gentiles trust.

Decoded (Modern Language): In his name the nations will put their hope.

Matthew 12:22

King James Version: Then was brought unto him one possessed with a devil, blind, and dumb: and he healed him, insomuch that the blind and dumb both spake and saw.

Decoded (Modern Language): Then a demon-possessed man who was blind and mute was brought to Jesus. Jesus healed him so that he could both speak and see.

Matthew 12:23

King James Version: And all the people were amazed, and said, Is not this the son of David?

Decoded (Modern Language): The crowd was amazed and said, 'Could this be the Son of David?'

Matthew 12:24

King James Version: But when the Pharisees heard it, they said, This fellow doth not cast out devils, but by Beelzebub the prince of the devils.

Decoded (Modern Language): But when the Pharisees heard this, they said, 'This man does not drive out demons except by Beelzebub, the prince of demons.'

Matthew 12:25

King James Version: And Jesus knew their thoughts, and said unto them, Every kingdom divided against itself is brought to desolation; and every city or house divided against itself shall not stand:

Decoded (Modern Language): Jesus knew their thoughts and said to them, 'Every kingdom divided against itself will be ruined, and every city or household divided against itself will not stand.'

Matthew 12:26

King James Version: And if Satan cast out Satan, he is divided against himself; how shall then his kingdom stand?

Decoded (Modern Language): If Satan drives out Satan, he is divided against himself. How then can his kingdom stand?'

Matthew 12:27

King James Version: And if I by Beelzebub cast out devils, by whom do your children cast them out? therefore they shall be your judges.

Decoded (Modern Language): If I drive out demons by Beelzebub, by whom do your followers drive them out? So then, they will be your judges.

Matthew 12:28

King James Version: But if I cast out devils by the Spirit of God, then the kingdom of God is come unto you.

Decoded (Modern Language): But if I drive out demons by the Spirit of God, then the kingdom of God has come to you.

Matthew 12:29

King James Version: Or else how can one enter into a strong man's house, and spoil his goods, except he first bind the strong man? and then he will spoil his house.

Decoded (Modern Language): Or again, how can anyone enter a strong man's house and steal his possessions unless he first ties up the strong man? Then he can rob his house.

Matthew 12:30

King James Version: He that is not with me is against me; and he that gathereth not with me scattereth abroad.

Decoded (Modern Language): Whoever is not with me is against me, and whoever does not gather with me scatters.

Matthew 12:31

King James Version: Wherefore I say unto you, All manner of sin and blasphemy shall be forgiven unto men: but the blasphemy against the Holy Ghost shall not be forgiven unto men.

Decoded (Modern Language): So I tell you, every kind of sin and blasphemy can be forgiven, but blasphemy against the Holy Spirit will not be forgiven.

Matthew 12:32

King James Version: And whosoever speaketh a word against the Son of man, it shall be forgiven him: but whosoever speaketh against the Holy Ghost, it shall not be forgiven him, neither in this world, neither in the world to come.

Decoded (Modern Language): Anyone who speaks against the Son of Man will be forgiven, but anyone who speaks against the Holy Spirit will not be forgiven, neither in this life nor in the life to come.

Matthew 12:33

King James Version: Either make the tree good, and his fruit good; or else make the tree corrupt, and his fruit corrupt: for the tree is known by his fruit.

Decoded (Modern Language): Make the tree good and its fruit good, or make the tree bad and its fruit bad, because a tree is known by its fruit.

Matthew 12:34

King James Version: O generation of vipers, how can ye, being evil, speak good things? for out of the abundance of the heart the mouth speaketh.

Decoded (Modern Language): You evil people, how can you say good things? What comes out of the mouth shows what is in the heart.

Matthew 12:35

King James Version: A good man out of the good treasure of the heart bringeth forth good things: and an evil man out of the evil treasure bringeth forth evil things.

Decoded (Modern Language): A good person produces good things from the good stored in their heart, and an evil person produces evil things from the evil stored in their heart.

Matthew 12:36

King James Version: But I say unto you, That every idle word that men shall speak, they shall give account thereof in the day of judgment.

Decoded (Modern Language): But I tell you that on the day of judgment people will have to explain every careless word they have spoken.

Matthew 12:37

King James Version: For by thy words thou shalt be justified, and by thy words thou shalt be condemned.

Decoded (Modern Language): Your words will either declare you innocent or guilty.

Matthew 12:38

King James Version: Then certain of the scribes and of the Pharisees answered, saying, Master, we would see a sign from thee.

Decoded (Modern Language): Then some of the teachers of the law and Pharisees said to him, 'Teacher, we want to see a sign from you.'

Matthew 12:39

King James Version: But he answered and said unto them, An evil and adulterous generation seeketh after a sign; and there shall no sign be given to it, but the sign of the prophet Jonas:

Decoded (Modern Language): Jesus answered, 'A wicked and unfaithful generation asks for a sign, but none will be given except the sign of the prophet Jonah.'

Matthew 12:40

King James Version: For as Jonas was three days and three nights in the whale's belly; so shall the Son of man be three days and three nights in the heart of the earth.

Decoded (Modern Language): Just as Jonah was in the belly of the fish for three days and three nights, so the Son of Man will be in the heart of the earth for three days and three nights.

Matthew 12:41

King James Version: The men of Nineveh shall rise in judgment with this generation, and shall condemn it: because they repented at the preaching of Jonas; and, behold, a greater than Jonas is here.

Decoded (Modern Language): The people of Nineveh will stand up against this generation at the judgment and condemn it, because they repented at Jonah's preaching; and now someone greater than Jonah is here.

Matthew 12:42

King James Version: The queen of the south shall rise up in the judgment with this generation, and shall condemn it: for she came from the uttermost parts of the earth to hear the wisdom of Solomon; and, behold, a greater than Solomon is here.

Decoded (Modern Language): The queen of the South will also stand against this generation at the judgment and condemn it, because she came from the ends of the earth to listen to Solomon's wisdom; and now someone greater than Solomon is here.

Matthew 12:43

King James Version: When the unclean spirit is gone out of a man, he walketh through dry places, seeking rest, and findeth none.

Decoded (Modern Language): When an evil spirit leaves a person, it goes through dry places looking for rest but finds none.

Matthew 12:44

King James Version: Then he saith, I will return into my house from whence I came out; and when he is come, he findeth it empty, swept, and garnished.

Decoded (Modern Language): Then it says, 'I will return to the house I left.' When it comes back, it finds the house empty, clean, and put in order.

Matthew 12:45

King James Version: Then goeth he, and taketh with himself seven other spirits more wicked than himself, and they enter in and dwell there: and the last state of that man is worse than the first. Even so shall it be also unto this wicked generation.

Decoded (Modern Language): Then it goes and brings seven other spirits more evil than itself, and they all enter and live there. The final condition of that person is worse than the first. This will happen to this evil generation too.

Matthew 12:46

King James Version: While he yet talked to the people, behold, his mother and his brethren stood without, desiring to speak with him.

Decoded (Modern Language): While Jesus was still talking to the crowd, his mother and brothers stood outside, wanting to speak to him.

Matthew 12:47

King James Version: Then one said unto him, Behold, thy mother and thy brethren stand without, desiring to speak with thee.

Decoded (Modern Language): Someone told him, 'Your mother and brothers are standing outside, wanting to speak to you.'

Matthew 12:48

King James Version: But he answered and said unto him that told him, Who is my mother? and who are my brethren?

Decoded (Modern Language): Jesus replied to the one who told him, 'Who is my mother? Who are my brothers?'

Matthew 12:49

King James Version: And he stretched forth his hand toward his disciples, and said, Behold my mother and my brethren!

Decoded (Modern Language): He stretched out his hand toward his disciples and said, 'Here are my mother and my brothers!'

Matthew 12:50

King James Version: For whosoever shall do the will of my Father which is in heaven, the same is my brother, and sister, and mother.

Decoded (Modern Language): Anyone who does the will of my Father in heaven is my brother, sister, and mother.

MATTHEW — CHAPTER 13**Matthew 13:1**

King James Version: The same day went Jesus out of the house, and sat by the sea side.

Decoded (Modern Language): That same day Jesus left the house and sat by the sea.

Matthew 13:2

King James Version: And great multitudes were gathered together unto him, so that he went into a ship, and sat; and the whole multitude stood on the shore.

Decoded (Modern Language): Large crowds gathered around him, so he got into a boat and sat down, while the whole crowd stood on the shore.

Matthew 13:3

King James Version: And he spake many things unto them in parables, saying, Behold, a sower went forth to sow;

Decoded (Modern Language): He told them many things using stories, saying, 'Look, a farmer went out to plant seeds.'

Matthew 13:4

King James Version: And when he sowed, some seeds fell by the way side, and the fowls came and devoured them up:

Decoded (Modern Language): As he planted, some seeds fell along the path, and birds came and ate them.

Matthew 13:5

King James Version: Some fell upon stony places, where they had not much earth: and forthwith they sprung up, because they had no deepness of earth:

Decoded (Modern Language): Some seeds fell on rocky ground where there was little soil, and they quickly sprouted because the soil was shallow.

Matthew 13:6

King James Version: And when the sun was up, they were scorched; and because they had no root, they withered away.

Decoded (Modern Language): But when the sun came up, the plants were scorched, and because they had no roots, they dried up.

Matthew 13:7

King James Version: And some fell among thorns; and the thorns sprung up, and choked them:

Decoded (Modern Language): Other seeds fell among thorns, and the thorns grew up and choked them.

Matthew 13:8

King James Version: But other fell into good ground, and brought forth fruit, some an hundredfold, some sixtyfold, some thirtyfold.

Decoded (Modern Language): But some seeds fell on good soil and produced crops, some a hundred times more, some sixty, some thirty.

Matthew 13:9

King James Version: Who hath ears to hear, let him hear.

Decoded (Modern Language): Anyone with ears to hear should listen carefully.

Matthew 13:10

King James Version: And the disciples came, and said unto him, Why speakest thou unto them in parables?

Decoded (Modern Language): The disciples came to him and asked, 'Why do you speak to them in stories?'

Matthew 13:11

King James Version: He answered and said unto them, Because it is given unto you to know the mysteries of the kingdom of heaven, but to them it is not given.

Decoded (Modern Language): He answered, 'You have been given the right to understand the secrets of the kingdom of heaven, but they have not.'

Matthew 13:12

King James Version: For whosoever hath, to him shall be given, and he shall have more abundance: but whosoever hath not, from him shall be taken away even that he hath.

Decoded (Modern Language): Whoever has will be given more and will have plenty; whoever does not have, even what they have will be taken away.

Matthew 13:13

King James Version: Therefore speak I to them in parables: because they seeing see not; and hearing they hear not, neither do they understand.

Decoded (Modern Language): That is why I speak to them in stories: because though they see, they do not see; though they hear, they do not understand.

Matthew 13:14

King James Version: And in them is fulfilled the prophecy of Esaias, which saith, By hearing ye shall hear, and shall not understand; and seeing ye shall see, and shall not perceive:

Decoded (Modern Language): This fulfills the prophecy of Isaiah that says, 'You will hear but never understand; you will see but never perceive.'

Matthew 13:15

King James Version: For this people's heart is waxed gross, and their ears are dull of hearing, and their eyes they have closed; lest at any time they should see with their eyes, and hear with their ears, and should understand with their heart, and should be converted, and I should heal them.

Decoded (Modern Language): For the hearts of these people have become dull; their ears are hard of hearing, and they have closed their eyes so they will not see with their eyes, hear with their ears, understand with their hearts, and turn to me to be healed.

Matthew 13:16

King James Version: But blessed are your eyes, for they see: and your ears, for they hear.

Decoded (Modern Language): But blessed are your eyes because they see, and your ears because they hear.

Matthew 13:17

King James Version: For verily I say unto you, That many prophets and righteous men have desired to see those things which ye see, and have not seen them; and to hear those things which ye hear, and have not heard them.

Decoded (Modern Language): I tell you the truth, many prophets and righteous people wanted to see what you see but did not see it, and to hear what you hear but did not hear it.

Matthew 13:18

King James Version: Hear ye therefore the parable of the sower.

Decoded (Modern Language): So listen carefully to the story of the farmer.

Matthew 13:19

King James Version: When any one heareth the word of the kingdom, and understandeth it not, then cometh the wicked one, and catcheth away that which was sown in his heart. This is he which received seed by the way side.

Decoded (Modern Language): When anyone hears the message about the kingdom but does not understand it, the evil one comes and takes away what was planted in their heart. This is like the seed that fell along the path.

Matthew 13:20

King James Version: But he that received the seed into stony places, the same is he that heareth the word, and anon with joy receiveth it;

Decoded (Modern Language): The seed that fell on rocky ground represents someone who hears the message and immediately welcomes it with joy.

Matthew 13:21

King James Version: Yet hath he not root in himself, but dureth for a while: for when tribulation or persecution ariseth because of the word, by and by he is offended.

Decoded (Modern Language): But they have no root and last only a short time. When trouble or persecution comes because of the message, they quickly give up.

Matthew 13:22

King James Version: He also that received seed among the thorns is he that heareth the word; and the care of this world, and the deceitfulness of riches, choke the word, and he becometh unfruitful.

Decoded (Modern Language): The seed that fell among thorns represents someone who hears the message, but worries about life and the lure of wealth choke it, and it produces nothing.

Matthew 13:23

King James Version: But he that received seed into the good ground is he that heareth the word, and understandeth it; which also beareth fruit, and bringeth forth, some an hundredfold, some sixty, some thirty.

Decoded (Modern Language): But the seed that fell on good soil represents someone who hears and understands the message and produces a crop, some a hundred times more, some sixty, some thirty.

Matthew 13:24

King James Version: Another parable put he forth unto them, saying, The kingdom of heaven is likened unto a man which sowed good seed in his field:

Decoded (Modern Language): He told them another story: 'The kingdom of heaven is like a man who planted good seed in his field.'

Matthew 13:25

King James Version: But while men slept, his enemy came and sowed tares among the wheat, and went his way.

Decoded (Modern Language): But while everyone was sleeping, his enemy came and planted weeds among the wheat and went away.

Matthew 13:26

King James Version: But when the blade was sprung up, and brought forth fruit, then appeared the tares also.

Decoded (Modern Language): When the wheat sprouted and formed heads, the weeds also appeared.

Matthew 13:27

King James Version: So the servants of the householder came and said unto him, Sir, didst not thou sow good seed in thy field? from whence then hath it tares?

Decoded (Modern Language): The owner's servants came to him and said, 'Sir, didn't you plant good seed in your field? Where did the weeds come from?'

Matthew 13:28

King James Version: He said unto them, An enemy hath done this. The servants said unto him, Wilt thou then that we go and gather them up?

Decoded (Modern Language): He replied, 'An enemy did this.' The servants asked, 'Do you want us to go and pull them up?'

Matthew 13:29

King James Version: But he said, Nay; lest while ye gather up the tares, ye root up also the wheat with them.

Decoded (Modern Language): But he said, 'No, because while you pull up the weeds, you might also pull up the wheat with them.'

Matthew 13:30

King James Version: Let both grow together until the harvest: and in the time of harvest I will say to the reapers, Gather ye together first the tares, and bind them in bundles to burn them: but gather the wheat into my barn.

Decoded (Modern Language): Let both grow together until the harvest. At that time I will tell the harvesters, Gather the weeds first and tie them in bundles to burn, but gather the wheat into my barn.'

Matthew 13:31

King James Version: Another parable put he forth unto them, saying, The kingdom of heaven is like to a grain of mustard seed, which a man took, and sowed in his field:

Decoded (Modern Language): He told them another story: The kingdom of heaven is like a mustard seed, which a man planted in his field.

Matthew 13:32

King James Version: Which indeed is the least of all seeds: but when it is grown, it is the greatest among herbs, and becometh a tree, so that the birds of the air come and lodge in the branches thereof.

Decoded (Modern Language): This seed is the smallest of all seeds, but when it grows, it becomes the largest of garden plants and turns into a tree, so that birds come and rest in its branches.

Matthew 13:33

King James Version: Another parable spake he unto them; The kingdom of heaven is like unto leaven, which a woman took, and hid in three measures of meal, till the whole was leavened.

Decoded (Modern Language): He told them another story: The kingdom of heaven is like yeast that a woman mixed into three measures of flour until the whole batch was leavened.

Matthew 13:34

King James Version: All these things spake Jesus unto the multitude in parables; and without a parable spake he not unto them:

Decoded (Modern Language): Jesus spoke all these things to the crowd in stories, and he did not speak to them without using a story.

Matthew 13:35

King James Version: That it might be fulfilled which was spoken by the prophet, saying, I will open my mouth in parables; I will utter things which have been kept secret from the foundation of the world.

Decoded (Modern Language): This fulfilled what the prophet had said: 'I will speak in stories; I will tell things that have been hidden since the world began.'

Matthew 13:36

King James Version: Then Jesus sent the multitude away, and went into the house: and his disciples came unto him, saying, Declare unto us the parable of the tares of the field.

Decoded (Modern Language): Then Jesus sent the crowd away and went into the house. His disciples came to him and said, 'Explain to us the story about the weeds in the field.'

Matthew 13:37

King James Version: He answered and said unto them, He that soweth the good seed is the Son of man;

Decoded (Modern Language): He answered, 'The one who plants the good seed is the Son of Man.'

Matthew 13:38

King James Version: The field is the world; the good seed are the children of the kingdom; but the tares are the children of the wicked one;

Decoded (Modern Language): The field is the world; the good seeds are the children of the kingdom; the weeds are the children of the evil one.

Matthew 13:39

King James Version: The enemy that sowed them is the devil; the harvest is the end of the world; and the reapers are the angels.

Decoded (Modern Language): The enemy who planted the weeds is the devil; the harvest is the end of the world; and the harvesters are the angels.

Matthew 13:40

King James Version: As therefore the tares are gathered and burned in the fire; so shall it be in the end of this world.

Decoded (Modern Language): Just as the weeds are gathered and burned in the fire, so it will be at the end of the world.

Matthew 13:41

King James Version: The Son of man shall send forth his angels, and they shall gather out of his kingdom all things that offend, and them which do iniquity;

Decoded (Modern Language): The Son of Man will send his angels, and they will gather out of his kingdom all things that cause sin and all who do evil.

Matthew 13:42

King James Version: And shall cast them into a furnace of fire: there shall be wailing and gnashing of teeth.

Decoded (Modern Language): They will throw them into a fiery furnace, where there will be crying and grinding of teeth.

Matthew 13:43

King James Version: Then shall the righteous shine forth as the sun in the kingdom of their Father. Who hath ears to hear, let him hear.

Decoded (Modern Language): Then the righteous will shine like the sun in their Father's kingdom. Anyone with ears should listen carefully.

Matthew 13:44

King James Version: Again, the kingdom of heaven is like unto treasure hid in a field; the which when a man hath found, he hideth, and for joy thereof goeth and selleth all that he hath, and buyeth that field.

Decoded (Modern Language): Again, the kingdom of heaven is like treasure hidden in a field. When a man finds it, he hides it again, and then joyfully sells everything he has to buy that field.

Matthew 13:45

King James Version: Again, the kingdom of heaven is like unto a merchant man, seeking goodly pearls:

Decoded (Modern Language): Again, the kingdom of heaven is like a merchant looking for fine pearls.

Matthew 13:46

King James Version: Who, when he had found one pearl of great price, went and sold all that he had, and bought it.

Decoded (Modern Language): When he found one pearl of great value, he sold everything he had and bought it.

Matthew 13:47

King James Version: Again, the kingdom of heaven is like unto a net, that was cast into the sea, and gathered of every kind:

Decoded (Modern Language): Again, the kingdom of heaven is like a net thrown into the sea that catches fish of every kind.

Matthew 13:48

King James Version: Which, when it was full, they drew to shore, and sat down, and gathered the good into vessels, but cast the bad away.

Decoded (Modern Language): When the net is full, the fishermen pull it to shore, sit down, and collect the good fish in containers but throw away the bad ones.

Matthew 13:49

King James Version: So shall it be at the end of the world: the angels shall come forth, and sever the wicked from among the just,

Decoded (Modern Language): This is how it will be at the end of the world: the angels will come and separate the wicked from the righteous.

Matthew 13:50

King James Version: And shall cast them into the furnace of fire: there shall be wailing and gnashing of teeth.

Decoded (Modern Language): They will throw the wicked into the fiery furnace, where there will be crying and grinding of teeth.

Matthew 13:51

King James Version: Jesus saith unto them, Have ye understood all these things? They say unto him, Yea, Lord.

Decoded (Modern Language): Jesus asked them, 'Do you understand all these things?' They answered, 'Yes, Lord.'

Matthew 13:52

King James Version: Then said he unto them, Therefore every scribe which is instructed unto the kingdom of heaven is like unto a man that is an householder, which bringeth forth out of his treasure things new and old.

Decoded (Modern Language): He said, 'So every teacher who has been trained for the kingdom of heaven is like a homeowner who brings out of his storage new and old things.'

Matthew 13:53

King James Version: And it came to pass, that when Jesus had finished these parables, he departed thence.

Decoded (Modern Language): After Jesus finished telling these stories, he left that place.

Matthew 13:54

King James Version: And when he was come into his own country, he taught them in their synagogue, insomuch that they were astonished, and said, Whence hath this man this wisdom, and these mighty works?

Decoded (Modern Language): When he came to his hometown, he taught in their synagogue, and the people were amazed. They asked, 'Where did this man get this wisdom and these miracles?'

Matthew 13:55

King James Version: Is not this the carpenter's son? is not his mother called Mary? and his brethren, James, and Joses, and Simon, and Judas?

Decoded (Modern Language): Isn't this the carpenter's son? Isn't his mother named Mary? Aren't his brothers James, Joseph, Simon, and Judas?

Matthew 13:56

King James Version: And his sisters, are they not all with us? Whence then hath this man all these things?

Decoded (Modern Language): Aren't all his sisters here with us? So where did this man get all these things?

Matthew 13:57

King James Version: And they were offended in him. But Jesus said unto them, A prophet is not without honour, save in his own country, and in his own house.

Decoded (Modern Language): They were offended by him. But Jesus said, 'A prophet is not honored except in his own town and in his own home.'

Matthew 13:58

King James Version: And he did not many mighty works there because of their unbelief.

Decoded (Modern Language): Because of their unbelief, Jesus did not do many miracles there.

MATTHEW — CHAPTER 14

Matthew 14:1

King James Version: At that time Herod the tetrarch heard of the fame of Jesus,

Decoded (Modern Language): At that time, Herod the ruler heard about Jesus' growing reputation,

Matthew 14:2

King James Version: And said unto his servants, This is John the Baptist; he is risen from the dead; and therefore mighty works do shew forth themselves in him.

Decoded (Modern Language): and he said to his servants, 'This is John the Baptist; he has come back to life, so that is why he can do such powerful miracles.'

Matthew 14:3

King James Version: For Herod had laid hold on John, and bound him, and put him in prison for Herodias' sake, his brother Philip's wife.

Decoded (Modern Language): Herod had arrested John, tied him up, and put him in prison because of Herodias, his brother Philip's wife.

Matthew 14:4

King James Version: For John said unto him, It is not lawful for thee to have her.

Decoded (Modern Language): John told him, 'It is not right for you to have her as your wife.'

Matthew 14:5

King James Version: And when he would have put him to death, he feared the multitude, because they counted him as a prophet.

Decoded (Modern Language): Herod wanted to kill John, but he was afraid of the crowd because they considered John a prophet.

Matthew 14:6

King James Version: But when Herod's birthday was kept, the daughter of Herodias danced before them, and pleased Herod.

Decoded (Modern Language): On Herod's birthday, Herodias' daughter danced for the guests and pleased Herod.

Matthew 14:7

King James Version: Whereupon he promised with an oath to give her whatsoever she would ask.

Decoded (Modern Language): So he promised her with an oath to give her whatever she asked for.

Matthew 14:8

King James Version: And she, being before instructed of her mother, said, Give me here John Baptist's head in a charger.

Decoded (Modern Language): Prompted by her mother, she said, 'Give me John the Baptist's head on a platter.'

Matthew 14:9

King James Version: And the king was sorry: nevertheless for the oath's sake, and them which sat with him at meat, he commanded it to be given her.

Decoded (Modern Language): The king was sorry, but because of his oath and the guests, he ordered that it be done.

Matthew 14:10

King James Version: And he sent, and beheaded John in the prison.

Decoded (Modern Language): He sent soldiers to the prison to behead John.

Matthew 14:11

King James Version: And his head was brought in a charger, and given to the damsel: and she brought it to her mother.

Decoded (Modern Language): John's head was brought on a platter and given to the girl, who took it to her mother.

Matthew 14:12

King James Version: And his disciples came, and took up the body, and buried it, and went and told Jesus.

Decoded (Modern Language): John's disciples came, took his body, buried it, and told Jesus.

Matthew 14:13

King James Version: When Jesus heard of it, he departed thence by ship into a desert place apart: and when the people had heard thereof, they followed him on foot out of the cities.

Decoded (Modern Language): When Jesus heard this, he left by boat to a quiet place. But the people heard and followed him on foot from the towns.

Matthew 14:14

King James Version: And Jesus went forth, and saw a great multitude, and was moved with compassion toward them, and he healed their sick.

Decoded (Modern Language): Jesus saw the large crowd, felt compassion for them, and healed their sick.

Matthew 14:15

King James Version: And when it was evening, his disciples came to him, saying, This is a desert place, and the time is now past; send the multitude away, that they may go into the villages, and buy themselves victuals.

Decoded (Modern Language): When evening came, his disciples said, 'This is a remote place, and it's late; send the people away so they can buy food in the villages.'

Matthew 14:16

King James Version: But Jesus said unto them, They need not depart; give ye them to eat.

Decoded (Modern Language): Jesus replied, 'They don't need to leave; you give them something to eat.'

Matthew 14:17

King James Version: And they say unto him, We have here but five loaves, and two fishes.

Decoded (Modern Language): They answered, 'We only have five loaves and two fish here.'

Matthew 14:18

King James Version: He said, Bring them hither to me.

Decoded (Modern Language): Jesus said, 'Bring them to me.'

Matthew 14:19

King James Version: And he commanded the multitude to sit down on the grass, and took the five loaves, and the two fishes, and looking up to heaven, he blessed, and brake, and gave the loaves to his disciples, and the disciples to the multitude.

Decoded (Modern Language): He told the crowd to sit on the grass, took the five loaves and two fish, looked up to heaven, blessed them, broke the loaves, and gave them to his disciples to distribute to the people.

Matthew 14:20

King James Version: And they did all eat, and were filled: and they took up of the fragments that remained twelve baskets full.

Decoded (Modern Language): Everyone ate and was satisfied, and they collected twelve baskets of leftovers.

Matthew 14:21

King James Version: And they that had eaten were about five thousand men, beside women and children.

Decoded (Modern Language): About five thousand men had eaten, not counting women and children.

Matthew 14:22

King James Version: And straightway Jesus constrained his disciples to get into a ship, and to go before him unto the other side, while he sent the multitudes away.

Decoded (Modern Language): Immediately Jesus made his disciples get into a boat and go ahead of him to the other side, while he sent the crowd away.

Matthew 14:23

King James Version: And when he had sent the multitudes away, he went up into a mountain apart to pray: and when the evening was come, he was there alone.

Decoded (Modern Language): After sending the crowd away, he went up a mountain alone to pray. When evening came, he was there by himself.

Matthew 14:24

King James Version: But the ship was now in the midst of the sea, tossed with waves: for the wind was contrary.

Decoded (Modern Language): Meanwhile, the boat was in the middle of the sea, tossed by waves because the wind was against it.

Matthew 14:25

King James Version: And in the fourth watch of the night Jesus went unto them, walking on the sea.

Decoded (Modern Language): During the fourth watch of the night, Jesus went to them, walking on the water.

Matthew 14:26

King James Version: And when the disciples saw him walking on the sea, they were troubled, saying, It is a spirit; and they cried out for fear.

Decoded (Modern Language): When the disciples saw him walking on the water, they were terrified and said, 'It's a ghost!' and cried out in fear.

Matthew 14:27

King James Version: But straightway Jesus spake unto them, saying, Be of good cheer; it is I; be not afraid.

Decoded (Modern Language): But Jesus immediately spoke to them: 'Take courage! It is I. Don't be afraid.'

Matthew 14:28

King James Version: And Peter answered him and said, Lord, if it be thou, bid me come unto thee on the water.

Decoded (Modern Language): Peter answered, 'Lord, if it is really you, tell me to come to you on the water.'

Matthew 14:29

King James Version: And he said, Come. And when Peter was come down out of the ship, he walked on the water, to go to Jesus.

Decoded (Modern Language): Jesus said, 'Come.' Peter got out of the boat and walked on the water toward Jesus.

Matthew 14:30

King James Version: But when he saw the wind boisterous, he was afraid; and beginning to sink, he cried, saying, Lord, save me.

Decoded (Modern Language): But when he saw the strong wind, he became afraid and started to sink. He cried out, 'Lord, save me!'

Matthew 14:31

King James Version: And immediately Jesus stretched forth his hand, and caught him, and said unto him, O thou of little faith, wherefore didst thou doubt?

Decoded (Modern Language): Jesus immediately reached out his hand, caught him, and said, 'You have so little faith. Why did you doubt?'

Matthew 14:32

King James Version: And when they were come into the ship, the wind ceased.

Decoded (Modern Language): When they got into the boat, the wind stopped.

Matthew 14:33

King James Version: Then they that were in the ship came and worshipped him, saying, Of a truth thou art the Son of God.

Decoded (Modern Language): Those in the boat worshiped him and said, 'Truly, you are the Son of God.'

Matthew 14:34

King James Version: And when they were gone over, they came into the land of Gennesaret.

Decoded (Modern Language): After they crossed, they arrived at the land of Gennesaret.

Matthew 14:35

King James Version: And when the men of that place had knowledge of him, they sent out into all that country round about, and brought unto him all that were diseased;

Decoded (Modern Language): When the people there recognized him, they sent word all around the area and brought to him everyone who was sick.

Matthew 14:36

King James Version: And besought him that they might only touch the hem of his garment: and as many as touched were made perfectly whole.

Decoded (Modern Language): They begged him to let them just touch the edge of his clothes, and all who touched him were completely healed.

MATTHEW — CHAPTER 15

Matthew 15:1

King James Version: Then came to Jesus scribes and Pharisees, which were of Jerusalem, saying,

Decoded (Modern Language): Then some teachers of the law and Pharisees came to Jesus from Jerusalem and said,

Matthew 15:2

King James Version: Why do thy disciples transgress the tradition of the elders? for they wash not their hands when they eat bread.

Decoded (Modern Language): Why do your followers break the tradition of the elders? They don't wash their hands before they eat bread.

Matthew 15:3

King James Version: But he answered and said unto them, Why do ye also transgress the commandment of God by your tradition?

Decoded (Modern Language): Jesus answered them, 'Why do you also break God's command because of your tradition?'

Matthew 15:4

King James Version: For God commanded, saying, Honour thy father and mother: and, He that curseth father or mother, let him die the death.

Decoded (Modern Language): God said, 'Honor your father and mother,' and 'Anyone who curses father or mother must be put to death.'

Matthew 15:5

King James Version: But ye say, Whosoever shall say to his father or his mother, It is a gift, by whatsoever thou mightest be profited by me;

Decoded (Modern Language): But you say, 'If anyone says to their father or mother, "Whatever help you might have received from me is a gift,"

Matthew 15:6

King James Version: And honour not his father or his mother, he shall be free. Thus have ye made the commandment of God of none effect by your tradition.

Decoded (Modern Language): then they don't have to honor their father or mother.' So you cancel God's command by your tradition.

Matthew 15:7

King James Version: Ye hypocrites, well did Esaias prophesy of you, saying,

Decoded (Modern Language): You hypocrites! Isaiah was right when he prophesied about you:

Matthew 15:8

King James Version: This people draweth nigh unto me with their mouth, and honoureth me with their lips; but their heart is far from me.

Decoded (Modern Language): 'These people honor me with their words, but their hearts are far from me.'

Matthew 15:9

King James Version: But in vain they do worship me, teaching for doctrines the commandments of men.

Decoded (Modern Language): Their worship is useless because they teach human rules as if they were God's commands.

Matthew 15:10

King James Version: And he called the multitude, and said unto them, Hear, and understand:

Decoded (Modern Language): Jesus called the crowd to him and said, 'Listen and understand this:'

Matthew 15:11

King James Version: Not that which goeth into the mouth defileth a man; but that which cometh out of the mouth, this defileth a man.

Decoded (Modern Language): It's not what goes into your mouth that makes you unclean, but what comes out of your mouth.

Matthew 15:12

King James Version: Then came his disciples, and said unto him, Knowest thou that the Pharisees were offended, after they heard this saying?

Decoded (Modern Language): Then his disciples came to him and said, 'Do you know the Pharisees were offended when they heard this?'

Matthew 15:13

King James Version: But he answered and said, Every plant, which my heavenly Father hath not planted, shall be rooted up.

Decoded (Modern Language): Jesus answered, 'Every plant that my Father in heaven has not planted will be pulled up by the roots.'

Matthew 15:14

King James Version: Let them alone: they be blind leaders of the blind. And if the blind lead the blind, both shall fall into the ditch.

Decoded (Modern Language): Leave them alone. They are blind leaders of the blind. If a blind person leads another blind person, both will fall into a pit.'

Matthew 15:15

King James Version: Then answered Peter and said unto him, Declare unto us this parable.

Decoded (Modern Language): Then Peter said to him, 'Explain this parable to us.'

Matthew 15:16

King James Version: And Jesus said, Are ye also yet without understanding?

Decoded (Modern Language): Jesus said, 'Are you still so dull?'

Matthew 15:17

King James Version: Do not ye yet understand, that whatsoever entereth in at the mouth goeth into the belly, and is cast out into the draught?

Decoded (Modern Language): Don't you understand that whatever goes into the mouth goes into the stomach and then is eliminated?

Matthew 15:18

King James Version: But those things which proceed out of the mouth come forth from the heart; and they defile the man.

Decoded (Modern Language): But the things that come out of the mouth come from the heart, and these make a person unclean.

Matthew 15:19

King James Version: For out of the heart proceed evil thoughts, murders, adulteries, fornications, thefts, false witness, blasphemies:

Decoded (Modern Language): What comes from the heart includes evil thoughts, murder, adultery, sexual immorality, theft, lying, and insults.

Matthew 15:20

King James Version: These are the things which defile a man: but to eat with unwashen hands defileth not a man.

Decoded (Modern Language): These are the things that make a person unclean; but eating without washing your hands does not make you unclean.'

Matthew 15:21

King James Version: Then Jesus went thence, and departed into the coasts of Tyre and Sidon.

Decoded (Modern Language): Jesus left there and went to the region of Tyre and Sidon.

Matthew 15:22

King James Version: And, behold, a woman of Canaan came out of the same coasts, and cried unto him, saying, Have mercy on me, O Lord, thou Son of David; my daughter is grievously vexed with a devil.

Decoded (Modern Language): A Canaanite woman from that area came to him and cried out, 'Lord, Son of David, have mercy on me! My daughter is suffering terribly from a demon.'

Matthew 15:23

King James Version: But he answered her not a word. And his disciples came and besought him, saying, Send her away; for she crieth after us.

Decoded (Modern Language): But Jesus did not answer her at all. His disciples came to him and urged him, 'Send her away, because she keeps shouting after us.'

Matthew 15:24

King James Version: But he answered and said, I am not sent but unto the lost sheep of the house of Israel.

Decoded (Modern Language): Jesus said, 'I was sent only to help the lost sheep of Israel.'

Matthew 15:25

King James Version: Then came she and worshipped him, saying, Lord, help me.

Decoded (Modern Language): The woman came and knelt before him. 'Lord, help me!' she said.

Matthew 15:26

King James Version: But he answered and said, It is not meet to take the children's bread, and to cast it to dogs.

Decoded (Modern Language): He replied, 'It is not right to take the children's bread and throw it to the dogs.'

Matthew 15:27

King James Version: And she said, Truth, Lord: yet the dogs eat of the crumbs which fall from their masters' table.

Decoded (Modern Language): 'Yes, Lord,' she said, 'but even the dogs eat the crumbs that fall from their masters' table.'

Matthew 15:28

King James Version: Then Jesus answered and said unto her, O woman, great is thy faith: be it unto thee even as thou wilt. And her daughter was made whole from that very hour.

Decoded (Modern Language): Then Jesus said to her, 'Woman, you have great faith! Let your request be granted.' And her daughter was healed at that moment.

Matthew 15:29

King James Version: And Jesus departed from thence, and came nigh unto the sea of Galilee; and went up into a mountain, and sat down there.

Decoded (Modern Language): Jesus left there and went along the shore of the Sea of Galilee. Then he went up a mountain and sat down.

Matthew 15:30

King James Version: And great multitudes came unto him, having with them those that were lame, blind, dumb, maimed, and many others, and cast them down at Jesus' feet; and he healed them:

Decoded (Modern Language): Large crowds came to him, bringing the lame, the blind, the crippled, the mute, and many others. They laid them at Jesus' feet, and he healed them.

Matthew 15:31

King James Version: Insomuch that the multitude wondered, when they saw the dumb to speak, the maimed to be whole, the lame to walk, and the blind to see: and they glorified the God of Israel.

Decoded (Modern Language): The crowd was amazed when they saw the mute speaking, the crippled made well, the lame walking, and the blind seeing. They praised the God of Israel.

Matthew 15:32

King James Version: Then Jesus called his disciples unto him, and said, I have compassion on the multitude, because they continue with me now three days, and have nothing to eat: and I will not send them away fasting, lest they faint in the way.

Decoded (Modern Language): Jesus called his disciples to him and said, 'I feel sorry for these people because they have been with me for three days and have nothing to eat. I don't want to send them away hungry, or they will faint on the way.'

Matthew 15:33

King James Version: And his disciples say unto him, Whence should we have so much bread in the wilderness, as to fill so great a multitude?

Decoded (Modern Language): His disciples said to him, 'Where can we get enough bread in this desert to feed such a large crowd?'

Matthew 15:34

King James Version: And Jesus saith unto them, How many loaves have ye? And they said, Seven, and a few little fishes.

Decoded (Modern Language): Jesus asked them, 'How many loaves do you have?' They answered, 'Seven, and a few small fish.'

Matthew 15:35

King James Version: And he commanded the multitude to sit down on the ground.

Decoded (Modern Language): He told the crowd to sit down on the ground.

Matthew 15:36

King James Version: And he took the seven loaves and the fishes, and gave thanks, and brake them, and gave to his disciples, and the disciples to the multitude.

Decoded (Modern Language): He took the seven loaves and the fish, gave thanks, broke them, and gave them to his disciples, who then gave them to the crowd.

Matthew 15:37

King James Version: And they did all eat, and were filled: and they took up of the broken meat that was left seven baskets full.

Decoded (Modern Language): Everyone ate and was satisfied. They collected seven baskets full of leftover pieces.

Matthew 15:38

King James Version: And they that did eat were four thousand men, beside women and children.

Decoded (Modern Language): About four thousand men ate, not counting women and children.

Matthew 15:39

King James Version: And he sent away the multitude, and took ship, and came into the coasts of Magdala.

Decoded (Modern Language): After sending the crowd away, he got into a boat and went to the region of Magdala.

MATTHEW — CHAPTER 16

Matthew 16:1

King James Version: The Pharisees also with the Sadducees came, and tempting desired him that he would shew them a sign from heaven.

Decoded (Modern Language): The Pharisees and Sadducees came to Jesus and tried to test him by asking for a sign from heaven.

Matthew 16:2

King James Version: He answered and said unto them, When it is evening, ye say, It will be fair weather: for the sky is red.

Decoded (Modern Language): Jesus answered them, 'When evening comes, you say the weather will be good because the sky is red.'

Matthew 16:3

King James Version: And in the morning, It will be foul weather to day: for the sky is red and lowring. O ye hypocrites, ye can discern the face of the sky; but can ye not discern the signs of the times?

Decoded (Modern Language): And in the morning, you say the weather will be bad because the sky is red and cloudy. You hypocrites! You can understand the sky's appearance, but can't you understand the signs of the times?

Matthew 16:4

King James Version: A wicked and adulterous generation seeketh after a sign; and there shall no sign be given unto it, but the sign of the prophet Jonas. And he left them, and departed.

Decoded (Modern Language): A wicked and unfaithful generation asks for a sign, but no sign will be given except the sign of the prophet Jonah.' Then Jesus left them and went away.

Matthew 16:5

King James Version: And when his disciples were come to the other side, they had forgotten to take bread.

Decoded (Modern Language): When his disciples reached the other side, they forgot to bring any bread.

Matthew 16:6

King James Version: Then Jesus said unto them, Take heed and beware of the leaven of the Pharisees and of the Sadducees.

Decoded (Modern Language): Jesus said to them, 'Watch out and be careful of the teaching of the Pharisees and Sadducees.'

Matthew 16:7

King James Version: And they reasoned among themselves, saying, It is because we have taken no bread.

Decoded (Modern Language): They talked among themselves, saying, 'It is because we didn't bring any bread.'

Matthew 16:8

King James Version: Which when Jesus perceived, he said unto them, O ye of little faith, why reason ye among yourselves, because ye have brought no bread?

Decoded (Modern Language): Jesus noticed this and said, 'You have so little faith! Why are you talking among yourselves about not having bread?'

Matthew 16:9

King James Version: Do ye not yet understand, neither remember the five loaves of the five thousand, and how many baskets ye took up?

Decoded (Modern Language): Don't you understand or remember the five loaves that fed five thousand people and how many baskets you collected?

Matthew 16:10

King James Version: Neither the seven loaves of the four thousand, and how many baskets ye took up?

Decoded (Modern Language): Or the seven loaves that fed four thousand people and how many baskets you collected?

Matthew 16:11

King James Version: How is it that ye do not understand that I spake it not to you concerning bread, that ye should beware of the leaven of the Pharisees and of the Sadducees?

Decoded (Modern Language): Why don't you understand that I wasn't warning you about bread, but about the teaching of the Pharisees and Sadducees?

Matthew 16:12

King James Version: Then understood they how that he bade them not beware of the leaven of bread, but of the doctrine of the Pharisees and of the Sadducees.

Decoded (Modern Language): Then they understood that Jesus was warning them not about bread, but about the teaching of the Pharisees and Sadducees.

Matthew 16:13

King James Version: When Jesus came into the coasts of Caesarea Philippi, he asked his disciples, saying, Whom do men say that I the Son of man am?

Decoded (Modern Language): When Jesus came to the area of Caesarea Philippi, he asked his disciples, 'Who do people say the Son of Man is?'

Matthew 16:14

King James Version: And they said, Some say that thou art John the Baptist: some, Elias; and others, Jeremias, or one of the prophets.

Decoded (Modern Language): They answered, 'Some say John the Baptist; others say Elijah; and others say Jeremiah or one of the prophets.'

Matthew 16:15

King James Version: He saith unto them, But whom say ye that I am?

Decoded (Modern Language): Jesus asked them, 'But who do you say I am?'

Matthew 16:16

King James Version: And Simon Peter answered and said, Thou art the Christ, the Son of the living God.

Decoded (Modern Language): Simon Peter answered, 'You are the Messiah, the Son of the living God.'

Matthew 16:17

King James Version: And Jesus answered and said unto him, Blessed art thou, Simon Bar-jona: for flesh and blood hath not revealed it unto thee, but my Father which is in heaven.

Decoded (Modern Language): Jesus replied, 'Blessed are you, Simon son of Jonah, because no human revealed this to you, but my Father in heaven.'

Matthew 16:18

King James Version: And I say also unto thee, That thou art Peter, and upon this rock I will build my church; and the gates of hell shall not prevail against it.

Decoded (Modern Language): And I tell you, you are Peter, and on this rock I will build my church, and the gates of hell will not overcome it.

Matthew 16:19

King James Version: And I will give unto thee the keys of the kingdom of heaven: and whatsoever thou shalt bind on earth shall be bound in heaven: and whatsoever thou shalt loose on earth shall be loosed in heaven.

Decoded (Modern Language): I will give you the keys of the kingdom of heaven; whatever you bind on earth will be bound in heaven, and whatever you loose on earth will be loosed in heaven.'

Matthew 16:20

King James Version: Then charged he his disciples that they should tell no man that he was Jesus the Christ.

Decoded (Modern Language): Then Jesus warned his disciples not to tell anyone that he was the Messiah.

Matthew 16:21

King James Version: From that time forth began Jesus to shew unto his disciples, how that he must go unto Jerusalem, and suffer many things of the elders and chief priests and scribes, and be killed, and be raised again the third day.

Decoded (Modern Language): From then on, Jesus began to explain to his disciples that he must go to Jerusalem, suffer many things from the elders, chief priests, and teachers, be killed, and be raised on the third day.

Matthew 16:22

King James Version: Then Peter took him, and began to rebuke him, saying, Be it far from thee, Lord: this shall not be unto thee.

Decoded (Modern Language): Peter took him aside and began to rebuke him, saying, 'Never, Lord! This will never happen to you!'

Matthew 16:23

King James Version: But he turned, and said unto Peter, Get thee behind me, Satan: thou art an offence unto me: for thou savourest not the things that be of God, but those that be of men.

Decoded (Modern Language): Jesus turned and said to Peter, 'Get behind me, Satan! You are a danger to me because you are thinking like humans, not like God.'

Matthew 16:24

King James Version: Then said Jesus unto his disciples, If any man will come after me, let him deny himself, and take up his cross, and follow me.

Decoded (Modern Language): Then Jesus said to his disciples, 'If anyone wants to follow me, they must deny themselves, take up their cross, and follow me.'

Matthew 16:25

King James Version: For whosoever will save his life shall lose it: and whosoever will lose his life for my sake shall find it.

Decoded (Modern Language): Whoever wants to save their life will lose it, but whoever loses their life for my sake will find it.

Matthew 16:26

King James Version: For what is a man profited, if he shall gain the whole world, and lose his own soul? or what shall a man give in exchange for his soul?

Decoded (Modern Language): What good is it for someone to gain the whole world but lose their soul? Or what can someone give in exchange for their soul?

Matthew 16:27

King James Version: For the Son of man shall come in the glory of his Father with his angels; and then he shall reward every man according to his works.

Decoded (Modern Language): The Son of Man will come in the glory of his Father with his angels, and then he will reward each person according to what they have done.

Matthew 16:28

King James Version: Verily I say unto you, There be some standing here, which shall not taste of death, till they see the Son of man coming in his kingdom.

Decoded (Modern Language): I tell you the truth, some standing here will not die before they see the Son of Man coming in his kingdom.

MATTHEW — CHAPTER 17

Matthew 17:1

King James Version: And after six days Jesus taketh Peter, James, and John his brother, and bringeth them up into an high mountain apart,

Decoded (Modern Language): After six days, Jesus took Peter, James, and John, his brother, and led them up to a high mountain by themselves.

Matthew 17:2

King James Version: And was transfigured before them: and his face did shine as the sun, and his raiment was white as the light.

Decoded (Modern Language): There, he was changed in front of them. His face shone like the sun, and his clothes became as bright as light.

Matthew 17:3

King James Version: And, behold, there appeared unto them Moses and Elias talking with him.

Decoded (Modern Language): Suddenly, Moses and Elijah appeared and were talking with Jesus.

Matthew 17:4

King James Version: Then answered Peter, and said unto Jesus, Lord, it is good for us to be here: if thou wilt, let us make here three tabernacles; one for thee, and one for Moses, and one for Elias.

Decoded (Modern Language): Peter spoke up and said to Jesus, 'Lord, it is good that we are here. If you want, let us make three shelters—one for you, one for Moses, and one for Elijah.'

Matthew 17:5

King James Version: While he yet spake, behold, a bright cloud overshadowed them: and behold a voice out of the cloud, which said, This is my beloved Son, in whom I am well pleased; hear ye him.

Decoded (Modern Language): While he was still speaking, a bright cloud covered them, and a voice came from the cloud saying, 'This is my beloved Son, and I am very pleased with him. Listen to him.'

Matthew 17:6

King James Version: And when the disciples heard it, they fell on their face, and were sore afraid.

Decoded (Modern Language): When the disciples heard this, they fell face down and were very afraid.

Matthew 17:7

King James Version: And Jesus came and touched them, and said, Arise, and be not afraid.

Decoded (Modern Language): But Jesus came to them, touched them, and said, 'Get up and don't be afraid.'

Matthew 17:8

King James Version: And when they had lifted up their eyes, they saw no man, save Jesus only.

Decoded (Modern Language): When they looked up, they saw no one except Jesus alone.

Matthew 17:9

King James Version: And as they came down from the mountain, Jesus charged them, saying, Tell the vision to no man, until the Son of man be risen again from the dead.

Decoded (Modern Language): As they came down the mountain, Jesus told them, 'Don't tell anyone about this vision until the Son of Man has risen from the dead.'

Matthew 17:10

King James Version: And his disciples asked him, saying, Why then say the scribes that Elias must first come?

Decoded (Modern Language): The disciples asked him, 'Why do the teachers of the law say that Elijah must come first?'

Matthew 17:11

King James Version: And Jesus answered and said unto them, Elias truly shall first come, and restore all things.

Decoded (Modern Language): Jesus answered, 'Elijah will come first and restore everything.'

Matthew 17:12

King James Version: But I say unto you, That Elias is come already, and they knew him not, but have done unto him whatsoever they listed. Likewise shall also the Son of man suffer of them.

Decoded (Modern Language): But I tell you, Elijah has already come, and they did not recognize him. Instead, they treated him however they wanted. In the same way, the Son of Man will suffer because of them.'

Matthew 17:13

King James Version: Then the disciples understood that he spake unto them of John the Baptist.

Decoded (Modern Language): Then the disciples understood that Jesus was talking about John the Baptist.

Matthew 17:14

King James Version: And when they were come to the multitude, there came to him a certain man, kneeling down to him, and saying,

Decoded (Modern Language): When they came to the crowd, a man knelt before Jesus and said,

Matthew 17:15

King James Version: Lord, have mercy on my son: for he is lunatick, and sore vexed: for oftentimes he falleth into the fire, and oft into the water.

Decoded (Modern Language): 'Lord, have mercy on my son. He has seizures and is very troubled. Often he falls into the fire or into the water.'

Matthew 17:16

King James Version: And I brought him to thy disciples, and they could not cure him.

Decoded (Modern Language): 'I brought him to your disciples, but they could not heal him.'

Matthew 17:17

King James Version: Then Jesus answered and said, O faithless and perverse generation, how long shall I be with you? how long shall I suffer you? bring him hither to me.

Decoded (Modern Language): Jesus said, 'You people have no faith and are so stubborn. How long must I be with you? How long must I put up with you? Bring the boy here to me.'

Matthew 17:18

King James Version: And Jesus rebuked the devil; and he departed out of him: and the child was cured from that very hour.

Decoded (Modern Language): Jesus rebuked the demon, and it left the boy. From that moment, the boy was healed.

Matthew 17:19

King James Version: Then came the disciples to Jesus apart, and said, Why could not we cast him out?

Decoded (Modern Language): Later, the disciples came to Jesus privately and asked, 'Why couldn't we drive it out?'

Matthew 17:20

King James Version: And Jesus said unto them, Because of your unbelief: for verily I say unto you, If ye have faith as a grain of mustard seed, ye shall say unto this mountain, Remove hence to yonder place; and it shall remove; and nothing shall be impossible unto you.

Decoded (Modern Language): Jesus said, 'It is because you don't have enough faith. I tell you the truth, if you have faith as small as a mustard seed, you can say to this mountain, "Move from here to there," and it will move. Nothing will be impossible for you.'

Matthew 17:21

King James Version: Howbeit this kind goeth not out but by prayer and fasting.

Decoded (Modern Language): But this kind of demon can only be driven out by prayer and fasting.

Matthew 17:22

King James Version: And while they abode in Galilee, Jesus said unto them, The Son of man shall be betrayed into the hands of men:

Decoded (Modern Language): While they were staying in Galilee, Jesus said to them, 'The Son of Man will be handed over to people.'

Matthew 17:23

King James Version: And they shall kill him, and the third day he shall be raised again. And they were exceeding sorry.

Decoded (Modern Language): They will kill him, but on the third day he will be raised to life again. The disciples were very sad.

Matthew 17:24

King James Version: And when they were come to Capernaum, they that received tribute money came to Peter, and said, Doth not your master pay tribute?

Decoded (Modern Language): When they arrived in Capernaum, the tax collectors came to Peter and asked, 'Doesn't your teacher pay the temple tax?'

Matthew 17:25

King James Version: He saith, Yes. And when he was come into the house, Jesus prevented him, saying, What thinkest thou, Simon? of whom do the kings of the earth take custom or tribute? of their own children, or of strangers?

Decoded (Modern Language): Peter said, 'Yes, he does.' When Peter came into the house, Jesus spoke to him first: 'What do you think, Simon? Do kings collect taxes from their own children or from others?'

Matthew 17:26

King James Version: Peter saith unto him, Of strangers. Jesus saith unto him, Then are the children free.

Decoded (Modern Language): Peter answered, 'From others.' Jesus said, 'Then the children are free.'

Matthew 17:27

King James Version: Notwithstanding, lest we should offend them, go thou to the sea, and cast an hook, and take up the fish that first cometh up; and when thou hast opened his mouth, thou shalt find a piece of money: that take, and give unto them for me and thee.

Decoded (Modern Language): But so we don't offend them, go to the lake, throw out your line, and take the first fish you catch. When you open its mouth, you will find a coin. Take that and pay the tax for both of us.'

MATTHEW — CHAPTER 18

Matthew 18:1

King James Version: At the same time came the disciples unto Jesus, saying, Who is the greatest in the kingdom of heaven?

Decoded (Modern Language): At that time the disciples came to Jesus and asked, 'Who is the greatest in the kingdom of heaven?'

Matthew 18:2

King James Version: And Jesus called a little child unto him, and set him in the midst of them,

Decoded (Modern Language): Jesus called a little child to him and placed the child among them.

Matthew 18:3

King James Version: And said, Verily I say unto you, Except ye be converted, and become as little children, ye shall not enter into the kingdom of heaven.

Decoded (Modern Language): He said, 'I tell you the truth, unless you change and become like little children, you will never enter the kingdom of heaven.'

Matthew 18:4

King James Version: Whosoever therefore shall humble himself as this little child, the same is greatest in the kingdom of heaven.

Decoded (Modern Language): So whoever humbles themselves like this little child is the greatest in the kingdom of heaven.

Matthew 18:5

King James Version: And whoso shall receive one such little child in my name receiveth me.

Decoded (Modern Language): And whoever welcomes a little child like this in my name welcomes me.

Matthew 18:6

King James Version: But whoso shall offend one of these little ones which believe in me, it were better for him that a millstone were hanged about his neck, and that he were drowned in the depth of the sea.

Decoded (Modern Language): But if anyone causes one of these little ones who believe in me to sin, it would be better for them to have a large millstone hung around their neck and be drowned in the sea.

Matthew 18:7

King James Version: Woe unto the world because of offences! for it must needs be that offences come; but woe to that man by whom the offence cometh!

Decoded (Modern Language): Trouble will come to the world because of sin, but woe to the person who causes others to sin!

Matthew 18:8

King James Version: Wherefore if thy hand or thy foot offend thee, cut them off, and cast them from thee: it is better for thee to enter into life halt or maimed, rather than having two hands or two feet to be cast into everlasting fire.

Decoded (Modern Language): If your hand or foot causes you to sin, cut it off and throw it away. It is better to enter life crippled or lame than to have two hands or feet and be thrown into eternal fire.

Matthew 18:9

King James Version: And if thine eye offend thee, pluck it out, and cast it from thee: it is better for thee to enter into life with one eye, rather than having two eyes to be cast into hell fire.

Decoded (Modern Language): And if your eye causes you to sin, take it out and throw it away. It is better to enter life with one eye than to have two eyes and be thrown into hell fire.

Matthew 18:10

King James Version: Take heed that ye despise not one of these little ones; for I say unto you, That in heaven their angels do always behold the face of my Father which is in heaven.

Decoded (Modern Language): Be careful not to look down on any of these little ones, because I tell you that their angels in heaven always see the face of my Father in heaven.

Matthew 18:11

King James Version: For the Son of man is come to save that which was lost.

Decoded (Modern Language): The Son of Man came to save those who are lost.

Matthew 18:12

King James Version: How think ye? if a man have an hundred sheep, and one of them be gone astray, doth he not leave the ninety and nine, and goeth into the mountains, and seeketh that which is gone astray?

Decoded (Modern Language): What do you think? If a man has a hundred sheep and one wanders away, will he not leave the ninety-nine in the hills and go to look for the one that wandered off?

Matthew 18:13

King James Version: And if so be that he find it, verily I say unto you, he rejoiceth more of that sheep, than of the ninety and nine which went not astray.

Decoded (Modern Language): And if he finds it, I tell you the truth, he is happier about that one sheep than about the ninety-nine that did not wander off.

Matthew 18:14

King James Version: Even so it is not the will of your Father which is in heaven, that one of these little ones should perish.

Decoded (Modern Language): In the same way, your Father in heaven does not want any of these little ones to be lost.

Matthew 18:15

King James Version: Moreover if thy brother shall trespass against thee, go and tell him his fault between thee and him alone: if he shall hear thee, thou hast gained thy brother.

Decoded (Modern Language): If your brother sins against you, go and show him his fault, just between the two of you. If he listens to you, you have won your brother back.

Matthew 18:16

King James Version: But if he will not hear thee, then take with thee one or two more, that in the mouth of two or three witnesses every word may be established.

Decoded (Modern Language): But if he will not listen, take one or two others along, so that every matter may be established by the testimony of two or three witnesses.

Matthew 18:17

King James Version: And if he shall neglect to hear them, tell it unto the church: but if he neglect to hear the church, let him be unto thee as an heathen man and a publican.

Decoded (Modern Language): If he refuses to listen to them, tell it to the church. And if he refuses to listen even to the church, treat him as you would a pagan or a tax collector.

Matthew 18:18

King James Version: Verily I say unto you, Whatsoever ye shall bind on earth shall be bound in heaven: and whatsoever ye shall loose on earth shall be loosed in heaven.

Decoded (Modern Language): I tell you the truth, whatever you bind on earth will be bound in heaven, and whatever you loose on earth will be loosed in heaven.

Matthew 18:19

King James Version: Again I say unto you, That if two of you shall agree on earth as touching any thing that they shall ask, it shall be done for them of my Father which is in heaven.

Decoded (Modern Language): Again, I tell you that if two of you agree on earth about anything you ask, it will be done for you by my Father in heaven.

Matthew 18:20

King James Version: For where two or three are gathered together in my name, there am I in the midst of them.

Decoded (Modern Language): For where two or three gather in my name, there I am with them.

Matthew 18:21

King James Version: Then came Peter to him, and said, Lord, how oft shall my brother sin against me, and I forgive him? till seven times?

Decoded (Modern Language): Then Peter came to Jesus and asked, 'Lord, how many times should I forgive my brother when he sins against me? Up to seven times?'

Matthew 18:22

King James Version: Jesus saith unto him, I say not unto thee, Until seven times: but, Until seventy times seven.

Decoded (Modern Language): Jesus answered, 'I tell you, not seven times, but seventy-seven times.'

Matthew 18:23

King James Version: Therefore is the kingdom of heaven likened unto a certain king, which would take account of his servants.

Decoded (Modern Language): Therefore, the kingdom of heaven is like a king who wanted to settle accounts with his servants.

Matthew 18:24

King James Version: And when he had begun to reckon, one was brought unto him, which owed him ten thousand talents.

Decoded (Modern Language): When he began to settle accounts, a man who owed him ten thousand talents was brought to him.

Matthew 18:25

King James Version: But forasmuch as he had not to pay, his lord commanded him to be sold, and his wife, and children, and all that he had, and payment to be made.

Decoded (Modern Language): Since he was not able to pay, the master ordered that he, his wife, his children, and everything he had be sold to repay the debt.

Matthew 18:26

King James Version: The servant therefore fell down, and worshipped him, saying, Lord, have patience with me, and I will pay thee all.

Decoded (Modern Language): The servant fell on his knees before him, saying, 'Be patient with me, and I will pay everything.'

Matthew 18:27

King James Version: Then the lord of that servant was moved with compassion, and loosed him, and forgave him the debt.

Decoded (Modern Language): The master felt compassion, canceled the debt, and let him go.

Matthew 18:28

King James Version: But the same servant went out, and found one of his fellowservants, which owed him an hundred pence: and he laid hands on him, and took him by the throat, saying, Pay me that thou owest.

Decoded (Modern Language): But when that servant went out, he found one of his fellow servants who owed him a hundred silver coins. He grabbed him and began to choke him, demanding, 'Pay what you owe me!'

Matthew 18:29

King James Version: And his fellowservant fell down at his feet, and besought him, saying, Have patience with me, and I will pay thee all.

Decoded (Modern Language): His fellow servant fell to his knees and begged, 'Be patient with me, and I will pay you back.'

Matthew 18:30

King James Version: And he would not: but went and cast him into prison, till he should pay the debt.

Decoded (Modern Language): But he refused. Instead, he went and threw him into prison until he could pay the debt.

Matthew 18:31

King James Version: So when his fellowservants saw what was done, they were very sorry, and came and told unto their lord all that was done.

Decoded (Modern Language): When the other servants saw what had happened, they were very upset and went to tell their master everything.

Matthew 18:32

King James Version: Then his lord, after that he had called him, said unto him, O thou wicked servant, I forgave thee all that debt, because thou desiredst me:

Decoded (Modern Language): Then his master called him and said, 'You wicked servant, I forgave you all that debt because you begged me to.'

Matthew 18:33

King James Version: Shouldest not thou also have had compassion on thy fellowservant, even as I had pity on thee?

Decoded (Modern Language): Shouldn't you have shown mercy to your fellow servant just as I showed mercy to you?

Matthew 18:34

King James Version: And his lord was wroth, and delivered him to the tormentors, till he should pay all that was due unto him.

Decoded (Modern Language): The master was angry and handed him over to the jailers until he could pay back everything he owed.

Matthew 18:35

King James Version: So likewise shall my heavenly Father do also unto you, if ye from your hearts forgive not every one his brother their trespasses.

Decoded (Modern Language): In the same way, my heavenly Father will treat you if you do not forgive your brother from your heart.

MATTHEW — CHAPTER 19

Matthew 19:1

King James Version: And it came to pass, that when Jesus had finished these sayings, he departed from Galilee, and came into the coasts of Judaea beyond Jordan;

Decoded (Modern Language): After Jesus finished saying these things, he left Galilee and went to the area of Judea across the Jordan River.

Matthew 19:2

King James Version: And great multitudes followed him; and he healed them there.

Decoded (Modern Language): Large crowds followed him, and he healed them there.

Matthew 19:3

King James Version: The Pharisees also came unto him, tempting him, and saying unto him, Is it lawful for a man to put away his wife for every cause?

Decoded (Modern Language): Some Pharisees came to test him by asking, 'Is it lawful for a man to divorce his wife for any reason?'

Matthew 19:4

King James Version: And he answered and said unto them, Have ye not read, that he which made them at the beginning made them male and female,

Decoded (Modern Language): Jesus answered, 'Have you not read that the one who created them from the beginning made them male and female?'

Matthew 19:5

King James Version: And said, For this cause shall a man leave father and mother, and shall cleave to his wife: and they twain shall be one flesh?

Decoded (Modern Language): He said, 'For this reason a man will leave his father and mother and be united with his wife, and the two will become one flesh.'

Matthew 19:6

King James Version: Wherefore they are no more twain, but one flesh. What therefore God hath joined together, let not man put asunder.

Decoded (Modern Language): So they are no longer two, but one flesh. Therefore, what God has joined together, let no one separate.

Matthew 19:7

King James Version: They say unto him, Why did Moses then command to give a writing of divorcement, and to put her away?

Decoded (Modern Language): They asked him, 'Then why did Moses command giving a certificate of divorce and sending her away?'

Matthew 19:8

King James Version: He saith unto them, Moses because of the hardness of your hearts suffered you to put away your wives: but from the beginning it was not so.

Decoded (Modern Language): Jesus said, 'Moses allowed you to divorce your wives because your hearts were hard, but it was not that way from the beginning.'

Matthew 19:9

King James Version: And I say unto you, Whosoever shall put away his wife, except it be for fornication, and shall marry another, committeth adultery: and whoso marrieth her which is put away doth commit adultery.

Decoded (Modern Language): I tell you that anyone who divorces his wife, except for sexual immorality, and marries another woman commits adultery. Anyone who marries a divorced woman also commits adultery.

Matthew 19:10

King James Version: His disciples say unto him, If the case of the man be so with his wife, it is not good to marry.

Decoded (Modern Language): The disciples said to him, 'If this is the case between a man and his wife, it is better not to marry.'

Matthew 19:11

King James Version: But he said unto them, All men cannot receive this saying, save they to whom it is given.

Decoded (Modern Language): Jesus replied, 'Not everyone can accept this teaching, but only those to whom it is given.'

Matthew 19:12

King James Version: For there are some eunuchs, which were so born from their mother's womb: and there are some eunuchs, which were made eunuchs of men: and there be eunuchs, which have made themselves eunuchs for the kingdom of heaven's sake. He that is able to receive it, let him receive it.

Decoded (Modern Language): There are some who were born unable to have children; some were made that way by others; and some choose to live like that for the kingdom of heaven. Whoever can accept this should accept it.

Matthew 19:13

King James Version: Then were there brought unto him little children, that he should put his hands on them, and pray: and the disciples rebuked them.

Decoded (Modern Language): Then people brought little children to Jesus so he could place his hands on them and pray, but the disciples told them to stop.

Matthew 19:14

King James Version: But Jesus said, Suffer little children, and forbid them not, to come unto me: for of such is the kingdom of heaven.

Decoded (Modern Language): Jesus said, 'Let the little children come to me and do not stop them, because the kingdom of heaven belongs to people like these.'

Matthew 19:15

King James Version: And he laid his hands on them, and departed thence.

Decoded (Modern Language): He placed his hands on them and then left that place.

Matthew 19:16

King James Version: And, behold, one came and said unto him, Good Master, what good thing shall I do, that I may have eternal life?

Decoded (Modern Language): A man came to Jesus and said, 'Teacher, what good thing must I do to have eternal life?'

Matthew 19:17

King James Version: And he said unto him, Why callest thou me good? there is none good but one, that is, God: but if thou wilt enter into life, keep the commandments.

Decoded (Modern Language): Jesus said, 'Why do you call me good? Only God is truly good. But if you want to enter life, obey the commandments.'

Matthew 19:18

King James Version: He saith unto him, Which? Jesus said, Thou shalt do no murder, Thou shalt not commit adultery, Thou shalt not steal, Thou shalt not bear false witness,

Decoded (Modern Language): The man asked, 'Which ones?' Jesus said, 'Do not murder, do not commit adultery, do not steal, do not lie,'

Matthew 19:19

King James Version: Honour thy father and thy mother: and, Thou shalt love thy neighbour as thyself.

Decoded (Modern Language): 'Honor your father and mother, and love your neighbor as yourself.'

Matthew 19:20

King James Version: The young man saith unto him, All these things have I kept from my youth up: what lack I yet?

Decoded (Modern Language): The young man said, 'I have obeyed all these since I was young. What do I still need?'

Matthew 19:21

King James Version: Jesus said unto him, If thou wilt be perfect, go and sell that thou hast, and give to the poor, and thou shalt have treasure in heaven: and come and follow me.

Decoded (Modern Language): Jesus told him, 'If you want to be perfect, go sell your possessions, give the money to the poor, and you will have treasure in heaven. Then come and follow me.'

Matthew 19:22

King James Version: But when the young man heard that saying, he went away sorrowful: for he had great possessions.

Decoded (Modern Language): When the young man heard this, he went away sad because he had many possessions.

Matthew 19:23

King James Version: Then said Jesus unto his disciples, Verily I say unto you, That a rich man shall hardly enter into the kingdom of heaven.

Decoded (Modern Language): Jesus said to his disciples, 'I tell you the truth, it is very hard for a rich person to enter the kingdom of heaven.'

Matthew 19:24

King James Version: And again I say unto you, It is easier for a camel to go through the eye of a needle, than for a rich man to enter into the kingdom of God.

Decoded (Modern Language): Again I tell you, it is easier for a camel to go through the eye of a needle than for a rich person to enter God's kingdom.'

Matthew 19:25

King James Version: When his disciples heard it, they were exceedingly amazed, saying, Who then can be saved?

Decoded (Modern Language): When the disciples heard this, they were very surprised and asked, 'Then who can be saved?'

Matthew 19:26

King James Version: But Jesus beheld them, and said unto them, With men this is impossible; but with God all things are possible.

Decoded (Modern Language): Jesus looked at them and said, 'With people this is impossible, but with God all things are possible.'

Matthew 19:27

King James Version: Then answered Peter and said unto him, Behold, we have forsaken all, and followed thee; what shall we have therefore?

Decoded (Modern Language): Peter answered, 'We have left everything and followed you. What will we get for that?'

Matthew 19:28

King James Version: And Jesus said unto them, Verily I say unto you, That ye which have followed me, in the regeneration when the Son of man shall sit in the throne of his glory, ye also shall sit upon twelve thrones, judging the twelve tribes of Israel.

Decoded (Modern Language): Jesus said, 'I tell you the truth, when the Son of Man sits on his glorious throne during the renewal, you who have followed me will also sit on twelve thrones, judging the twelve tribes of Israel.'

Matthew 19:29

King James Version: And every one that hath forsaken houses, or brethren, or sisters, or father, or mother, or wife, or children, or lands, for my name's sake, shall receive an hundredfold, and shall inherit everlasting life.

Decoded (Modern Language): And everyone who has left houses, brothers, sisters, father, mother, wife, children, or land for my name's sake will receive a hundred times as much and will inherit eternal life.

Matthew 19:30

King James Version: But many that are first shall be last; and the last shall be first.

Decoded (Modern Language): But many who are first will be last, and many who are last will be first.

MATTHEW — CHAPTER 20

Matthew 20:1

King James Version: For the kingdom of heaven is like unto a man that is an householder, which went out early in the morning to hire labourers into his vineyard.

Decoded (Modern Language): The kingdom of heaven is like a landowner who went out early in the morning to hire workers for his vineyard.

Matthew 20:2

King James Version: And when he had agreed with the labourers for a penny a day, he sent them into his vineyard.

Decoded (Modern Language): He agreed to pay the workers a penny for the day and sent them to work in his vineyard.

Matthew 20:3

King James Version: And he went out about the third hour, and saw others standing idle in the marketplace,

Decoded (Modern Language): About the third hour, he went out again and saw others standing around in the marketplace doing nothing.

Matthew 20:4

King James Version: And said unto them; Go ye also into the vineyard, and whatsoever is right I will give you. And they went their way.

Decoded (Modern Language): He said to them, 'You also go to work in the vineyard, and I will pay you whatever is right.' So they went.

Matthew 20:5

King James Version: Again he went out about the sixth and ninth hour, and did likewise.

Decoded (Modern Language): He went out again about the sixth and ninth hours and did the same thing.

Matthew 20:6

King James Version: And about the eleventh hour he went out, and found others standing idle, and saith unto them, Why stand ye here all the day idle?

Decoded (Modern Language): About the eleventh hour, he went out and found others standing idle and asked, 'Why have you been standing here all day doing nothing?'

Matthew 20:7

King James Version: They say unto him, Because no man hath hired us. He saith unto them, Go ye also into the vineyard; and whatsoever is right, that shall ye receive.

Decoded (Modern Language): They answered, 'Because no one has hired us.' He said, 'You also go to work in the vineyard, and you will be paid what is right.'

Matthew 20:8

King James Version: So when even was come, the lord of the vineyard saith unto his steward, Call the labourers, and give them their hire, beginning from the last unto the first.

Decoded (Modern Language): When evening came, the owner told his manager, 'Call the workers and pay them, starting with the last ones hired and ending with the first.'

Matthew 20:9

King James Version: And when they came that were hired about the eleventh hour, they received every man a penny.

Decoded (Modern Language): The workers hired at the eleventh hour each received a penny.

Matthew 20:10

King James Version: But when the first came, they supposed that they should have received more; and they likewise received every man a penny.

Decoded (Modern Language): When the first workers came, they expected to get more, but they also received a penny each.

Matthew 20:11

King James Version: And when they had received it, they murmured against the goodman of the house,
Decoded (Modern Language): After getting their pay, they complained against the landowner,

Matthew 20:12

King James Version: Saying, These last have wrought but one hour, and thou hast made them equal unto us, which have borne the burden and heat of the day.

Decoded (Modern Language): saying, 'These last workers only worked one hour, but you made them equal to us who worked all day in the heat.'

Matthew 20:13

King James Version: But he answered one of them, and said, Friend, I do thee no wrong: didst not thou agree with me for a penny?

Decoded (Modern Language): The landowner replied to one of them, 'Friend, I am not treating you unfairly. Didn't you agree to work for a penny?'

Matthew 20:14

King James Version: Take that thine is, and go thy way: I will give unto this last, even as unto thee.

Decoded (Modern Language): Take your pay and go. I want to give the last workers the same as you.

Matthew 20:15

King James Version: Is it not lawful for me to do what I will with mine own? Is thine eye evil, because I am good?

Decoded (Modern Language): Is it not right for me to do what I want with my own money? Are you jealous because I am generous?'

Matthew 20:16

King James Version: So the last shall be first, and the first last: for many be called, but few chosen.

Decoded (Modern Language): So the last will be first, and the first will be last. Many are invited, but few are chosen.

Matthew 20:17

King James Version: And Jesus going up to Jerusalem took the twelve disciples apart in the way, and said unto them,

Decoded (Modern Language): As Jesus was going up to Jerusalem, he took the twelve disciples aside and said to them,

Matthew 20:18

King James Version: Behold, we go up to Jerusalem; and the Son of man shall be betrayed unto the chief priests and unto the scribes, and they shall condemn him to death,

Decoded (Modern Language): 'Look, we are going up to Jerusalem, and the Son of Man will be handed over to the chief priests and teachers of the law. They will condemn him to death,

Matthew 20:19

King James Version: And shall deliver him to the Gentiles to mock, and to scourge, and to crucify him: and the third day he shall rise again.

Decoded (Modern Language): and they will hand him over to the Gentiles to be mocked, whipped, and crucified. But on the third day, he will rise again.'

Matthew 20:20

King James Version: Then came to him the mother of Zebedee's children with her sons, worshipping him, and desiring a certain thing of him.

Decoded (Modern Language): Then the mother of Zebedee's sons came to Jesus with her sons, worshipping him and asking for a favor.

Matthew 20:21

King James Version: And he said unto her, What wilt thou? She saith unto him, Grant that these my two sons may sit, the one on thy right hand, and the other on the left, in thy kingdom.

Decoded (Modern Language): Jesus asked her, 'What do you want?' She said, 'Let these two sons of mine sit, one at your right and the other at your left, in your kingdom.'

Matthew 20:22

King James Version: But Jesus answered and said, Ye know not what ye ask. Are ye able to drink of the cup that I shall drink of, and to be baptized with the baptism that I am baptized with? They say unto him, We are able.

Decoded (Modern Language): Jesus answered, 'You don't know what you are asking. Can you drink the cup I am going to drink and be baptized with the baptism I will be baptized with?' They said, 'Yes, we can.'

Matthew 20:23

King James Version: And he saith unto them, Ye shall drink indeed of my cup, and be baptized with the baptism that I am baptized with: but to sit on my right hand, and on my left, is not mine to give, but it shall be given to them for whom it is prepared of my Father.

Decoded (Modern Language): He said, 'You will drink my cup and be baptized with my baptism, but to sit at my right or left is not for me to give. Those places are for those the Father has prepared.'

Matthew 20:24

King James Version: And when the ten heard it, they were moved with indignation against the two brethren.

Decoded (Modern Language): When the other ten heard this, they were angry with the two brothers.

Matthew 20:25

King James Version: But Jesus called them unto him, and said, Ye know that the princes of the Gentiles exercise dominion over them, and they that are great exercise authority upon them.

Decoded (Modern Language): Jesus called them together and said, 'You know that the rulers of the Gentiles lord it over them, and their high officials exercise authority over them.'

Matthew 20:26

King James Version: But it shall not be so among you: but whosoever will be great among you, let him be your minister;

Decoded (Modern Language): But it will not be like that among you. Whoever wants to be great among you must be your servant,

Matthew 20:27

King James Version: And whosoever will be chief among you, let him be your servant:

Decoded (Modern Language): and whoever wants to be first must be your slave.

Matthew 20:28

King James Version: Even as the Son of man came not to be ministered unto, but to minister, and to give his life a ransom for many.

Decoded (Modern Language): Just as the Son of Man did not come to be served, but to serve, and to give his life to save many.

Matthew 20:29

King James Version: And as they departed from Jericho, a great multitude followed him.

Decoded (Modern Language): As Jesus and his followers left Jericho, a large crowd followed him.

Matthew 20:30

King James Version: And, behold, two blind men sitting by the way side, when they heard that Jesus passed by, cried out, saying, Have mercy on us, O Lord, thou Son of David.

Decoded (Modern Language): Two blind men sitting by the roadside heard that Jesus was passing by and shouted, 'Lord, Son of David, have mercy on us!'

Matthew 20:31

King James Version: And the multitude rebuked them, because they should hold their peace: but they cried the more, saying, Have mercy on us, O Lord, thou Son of David.

Decoded (Modern Language): The crowd told them to be quiet, but they shouted even louder, 'Lord, Son of David, have mercy on us!'

Matthew 20:32

King James Version: And Jesus stood still, and called them, and said, What will ye that I shall do unto you?

Decoded (Modern Language): Jesus stopped and called them over. He asked, 'What do you want me to do for you?'

Matthew 20:33

King James Version: They say unto him, Lord, that our eyes may be opened.

Decoded (Modern Language): They answered, 'Lord, please let us see again.'

Matthew 20:34

King James Version: So Jesus had compassion on them, and touched their eyes: and immediately their eyes received sight, and they followed him.

Decoded (Modern Language): Jesus felt sorry for them and touched their eyes. Right away, they could see, and they followed him.

MATTHEW — CHAPTER 21

Matthew 21:1

King James Version: And when they drew nigh unto Jerusalem, and were come to Bethphage, unto the mount of Olives, then sent Jesus two disciples,

Decoded (Modern Language): When they came near Jerusalem and reached Bethphage on the Mount of Olives, Jesus sent two disciples,

Matthew 21:2

King James Version: Saying unto them, Go into the village over against you, and straightway ye shall find an ass tied, and a colt with her: loose them, and bring them unto me.

Decoded (Modern Language): telling them, 'Go into the village ahead of you, and you will immediately find a donkey tied there, with a colt beside her. Untie them and bring them to me.'

Matthew 21:3

King James Version: And if any man say ought unto you, ye shall say, The Lord hath need of them; and straightway he will send them.

Decoded (Modern Language): If anyone says anything to you, say, 'The Lord needs them,' and he will send them right away.

Matthew 21:4

King James Version: All this was done, that it might be fulfilled which was spoken by the prophet, saying,
Decoded (Modern Language): This happened to fulfill what was spoken by the prophet, saying,

Matthew 21:5

King James Version: Tell ye the daughter of Sion, Behold, thy King cometh unto thee, meek, and sitting upon an ass, and a colt the foal of an ass.

Decoded (Modern Language): Tell the daughter of Zion, 'Look, your King is coming to you, humble and riding on a donkey, on a colt, the foal of a donkey.'

Matthew 21:6

King James Version: And the disciples went, and did as Jesus commanded them,

Decoded (Modern Language): The disciples went and did exactly as Jesus had told them.

Matthew 21:7

King James Version: And brought the ass, and the colt, and put on them their clothes, and they set him thereon.

Decoded (Modern Language): They brought the donkey and the colt, put their clothes on them, and Jesus sat on them.

Matthew 21:8

King James Version: And a very great multitude spread their garments in the way; others cut down branches from the trees, and strawed them in the way.

Decoded (Modern Language): A large crowd spread their clothes on the road, while others cut branches from the trees and laid them on the road.

Matthew 21:9

King James Version: And the multitudes that went before, and that followed, cried, saying, Hosanna to the Son of David: Blessed is he that cometh in the name of the Lord; Hosanna in the highest.

Decoded (Modern Language): The crowds in front and behind shouted, 'Hosanna to the Son of David! Blessed is the one who comes in the name of the Lord! Hosanna in the highest!'

Matthew 21:10

King James Version: And when he was come into Jerusalem, all the city was moved, saying, Who is this?

Decoded (Modern Language): When Jesus entered Jerusalem, the whole city was stirred, asking, 'Who is this?'

Matthew 21:11

King James Version: And the multitude said, This is Jesus the prophet of Nazareth of Galilee.

Decoded (Modern Language): The crowd answered, 'This is Jesus, the prophet from Nazareth in Galilee.'

Matthew 21:12

King James Version: And Jesus went into the temple of God, and cast out all them that sold and bought in the temple, and overthrew the tables of the moneychangers, and the seats of them that sold doves,

Decoded (Modern Language): Jesus entered the temple and drove out all who were buying and selling there. He overturned the tables of the money changers and the benches of those selling doves.

Matthew 21:13

King James Version: And said unto them, It is written, My house shall be called the house of prayer; but ye have made it a den of thieves.

Decoded (Modern Language): He said to them, 'It is written, My house will be called a house of prayer, but you have made it a den of thieves.'

Matthew 21:14

King James Version: And the blind and the lame came to him in the temple; and he healed them.

Decoded (Modern Language): The blind and the lame came to him in the temple, and he healed them.

Matthew 21:15

King James Version: And when the chief priests and scribes saw the wonderful things that he did, and the children crying in the temple, and saying, Hosanna to the Son of David; they were sore displeased,

Decoded (Modern Language): When the chief priests and teachers of the law saw the wonderful things he did and the children shouting in the temple, 'Hosanna to the Son of David,' they were very angry.

Matthew 21:16

King James Version: And said unto him, Hearest thou what these say? And Jesus saith unto them, Yea; have ye never read, Out of the mouth of babes and sucklings thou hast perfected praise?

Decoded (Modern Language): They asked Jesus, 'Do you hear what these children are saying?' Jesus replied, 'Yes. Haven't you read, From the lips of children and infants you have prepared praise?'

Matthew 21:17

King James Version: And he left them, and went out of the city into Bethany; and he lodged there.

Decoded (Modern Language): Then he left them and went out of the city to Bethany, where he stayed.

Matthew 21:18

King James Version: Now in the morning as he returned into the city, he hungered.

Decoded (Modern Language): Early in the morning as Jesus was returning to the city, he was hungry.

Matthew 21:19

King James Version: And when he saw a fig tree in the way, he came to it, and found nothing thereon, but leaves only, and said unto it, Let no fruit grow on thee henceforward for ever. And presently the fig tree withered away.

Decoded (Modern Language): He saw a fig tree by the road, but when he reached it, he found only leaves. Then he said to it, 'May no fruit ever come from you again.' Immediately the tree withered.

Matthew 21:20

King James Version: And when the disciples saw it, they marvelled, saying, How soon is the fig tree withered away!

Decoded (Modern Language): When the disciples saw this, they were amazed and asked, 'How did the fig tree wither so quickly?'

Matthew 21:21

King James Version: Jesus answered and said unto them, Verily I say unto you, If ye have faith, and doubt not, ye shall not only do this which is done to the fig tree, but also if ye shall say unto this mountain, Be thou removed, and be thou cast into the sea; it shall be done.

Decoded (Modern Language): Jesus answered, 'I tell you the truth, if you have faith and don't doubt, you can do what was done to the fig tree. You can say to this mountain, 'Go, throw yourself into the sea,' and it will happen.

Matthew 21:22

King James Version: And all things, whatsoever ye shall ask in prayer, believing, ye shall receive.

Decoded (Modern Language): You can pray for anything, and if you believe, you will receive it.'

Matthew 21:23

King James Version: And when he was come into the temple, the chief priests and the elders of the people came unto him as he was teaching, and said, By what authority doest thou these things? and who gave thee this authority?

Decoded (Modern Language): Jesus entered the temple, and the chief priests and elders came to him while he was teaching. They asked, 'By what authority are you doing these things? Who gave you this authority?'

Matthew 21:24

King James Version: And Jesus answered and said unto them, I also will ask you one thing, which if ye tell me, I in like wise will tell you by what authority I do these things.

Decoded (Modern Language): Jesus answered, 'I will ask you one question. If you answer it, I will tell you by what authority I do these things.'

Matthew 21:25

King James Version: The baptism of John, whence was it? from heaven, or of men? And they reasoned with themselves, saying, If we shall say, From heaven; he will say unto us, Why did ye not then believe him?

Decoded (Modern Language): 'Where did John's baptism come from? Was it from heaven, or from people?' They discussed it among themselves, saying, 'If we say from heaven, he will ask, 'Then why didn't you believe him?'

Matthew 21:26

King James Version: But if we shall say, Of men; we fear the people; for all hold John as a prophet.

Decoded (Modern Language): But if we say from people, we are afraid of the crowd, because everyone believes John was a prophet.'

Matthew 21:27

King James Version: And they answered Jesus, and said, We cannot tell. And he said unto them, Neither tell I you by what authority I do these things.

Decoded (Modern Language): So they answered Jesus, 'We don't know.' Then Jesus said, 'Neither will I tell you by what authority I do these things.'

Matthew 21:28

King James Version: But what think ye? A certain man had two sons; and he came to the first, and said, Son, go work to day in my vineyard.

Decoded (Modern Language): Jesus said, 'What do you think? A man had two sons. He went to the first and said, 'Son, go work in the vineyard today.'

Matthew 21:29

King James Version: He answered and said, I will not: but afterward he repented, and went.

Decoded (Modern Language): He answered, 'I won't,' but later he changed his mind and went.

Matthew 21:30

King James Version: And he came to the second, and said likewise. And he answered and said, I go, sir: and went not.

Decoded (Modern Language): The man went to the second son and said the same thing. He answered, 'I will, sir,' but he did not go.

Matthew 21:31

King James Version: Whether of them twain did the will of his father? They say unto him, The first. Jesus saith unto them, Verily I say unto you, That the publicans and the harlots go into the kingdom of God before you.

Decoded (Modern Language): Which son did what his father wanted?' They said, 'The first.' Jesus said, 'I tell you the truth, tax collectors and prostitutes will enter the kingdom of God before you.'

Matthew 21:32

King James Version: For John came unto you in the way of righteousness, and ye believed him not: but the publicans and the harlots believed him: and ye, when ye had seen it, repented not afterward, that ye might believe him.

Decoded (Modern Language): John came to you, showing the right way to live, but you did not believe him. Yet the tax collectors and prostitutes believed him. After seeing this, you did not change your minds and believe him.

Matthew 21:33

King James Version: Hear another parable: There was a certain householder, which planted a vineyard, and hedged it round about, and digged a winepress in it, and built a tower, and let it out to husbandmen, and went into a far country:

Decoded (Modern Language): Listen to another story: A landowner planted a vineyard, surrounded it with a fence, dug a winepress, built a watchtower, rented it to farmers, and then went away.

Matthew 21:34

King James Version: And when the time of the fruit drew near, he sent his servants to the husbandmen, that they might receive the fruits of it.

Decoded (Modern Language): When the time came to collect the fruit, he sent his servants to the farmers to get his share of the fruit.

Matthew 21:35

King James Version: And the husbandmen took his servants, and beat one, and killed another, and stoned another.

Decoded (Modern Language): But the farmers grabbed his servants, beat one, killed another, and stoned a third.

Matthew 21:36

King James Version: Again, he sent other servants more than the first: and they did unto them likewise.

Decoded (Modern Language): Then he sent more servants than before, but the farmers treated them the same way.

Matthew 21:37

King James Version: But last of all he sent unto them his son, saying, They will reverence my son.

Decoded (Modern Language): Finally, he sent his son, thinking, 'They will respect my son.'

Matthew 21:38

King James Version: But when the husbandmen saw the son, they said among themselves, This is the heir; come, let us kill him, and let us seize on his inheritance.

Decoded (Modern Language): But when the farmers saw the son, they said to each other, 'This is the heir. Let's kill him and take his inheritance.'

Matthew 21:39

King James Version: And they caught him, and cast him out of the vineyard, and slew him.

Decoded (Modern Language): So they grabbed him, threw him out of the vineyard, and killed him.

Matthew 21:40

King James Version: When the lord therefore of the vineyard cometh, what will he do unto those husbandmen?

Decoded (Modern Language): So, what will the owner of the vineyard do when he comes?

Matthew 21:41

King James Version: They say unto him, He will miserably destroy those wicked men, and will let out his vineyard unto other husbandmen, which shall render him the fruits in their seasons.

Decoded (Modern Language): They answered, 'He will destroy those wicked farmers and rent the vineyard to others who will give him the fruit at the right time.'

Matthew 21:42

King James Version: Jesus saith unto them, Did ye never read in the scriptures, The stone which the builders rejected, the same is become the head of the corner: this is the Lord's doing, and it is marvellous in our eyes?

Decoded (Modern Language): Jesus said to them, 'Have you never read in the Scriptures: The stone the builders rejected has become the cornerstone. This is the Lord's doing, and it is amazing to us?'

Matthew 21:43

King James Version: Therefore say I unto you, The kingdom of God shall be taken from you, and given to a nation bringing forth the fruits thereof.

Decoded (Modern Language): So I tell you, the kingdom of God will be taken away from you and given to a people who will produce its fruit.

Matthew 21:44

King James Version: And whosoever shall fall on this stone shall be broken: but on whomsoever it shall fall, it will grind him to powder.

Decoded (Modern Language): Anyone who falls on this stone will be broken, but anyone it falls on will be crushed.

Matthew 21:45

King James Version: And when the chief priests and Pharisees had heard his parables, they perceived that he spake of them.

Decoded (Modern Language): When the chief priests and Pharisees heard his stories, they realized he was talking about them.

Matthew 21:46

King James Version: But when they sought to lay hands on him, they feared the multitude, because they took him for a prophet.

Decoded (Modern Language): They wanted to arrest him, but they were afraid of the crowd because the people thought he was a prophet.

MATTHEW — CHAPTER 22

Matthew 22:1

King James Version: And Jesus answered and spake unto them again by parables, and said,

Decoded (Modern Language): Jesus answered them again with stories and said,

Matthew 22:2

King James Version: The kingdom of heaven is like unto a certain king, which made a marriage for his son,

Decoded (Modern Language): The kingdom of heaven is like a king who gave a wedding for his son,

Matthew 22:3

King James Version: And sent forth his servants to call them that were bidden to the wedding: and they would not come.

Decoded (Modern Language): and sent his servants to invite those who were invited to the wedding, but they refused to come.

Matthew 22:4

King James Version: Again, he sent forth other servants, saying, Tell them which are bidden, Behold, I have prepared my dinner: my oxen and my fatlings are killed, and all things are ready: come unto the marriage.

Decoded (Modern Language): He sent other servants and said, Tell those invited, 'Look, I have prepared my dinner; my cattle and fat animals are killed, and everything is ready. Come to the wedding.'

Matthew 22:5

King James Version: But they made light of it, and went their ways, one to his farm, another to his merchandise:

Decoded (Modern Language): But they ignored it and went away, one to his farm, another to his business.

Matthew 22:6

King James Version: And the remnant took his servants, and entreated them spitefully, and slew them.

Decoded (Modern Language): The rest grabbed his servants, treated them badly, and killed them.

Matthew 22:7

King James Version: But when the king heard thereof, he was wroth: and he sent forth his armies, and destroyed those murderers, and burned up their city.

Decoded (Modern Language): When the king heard about it, he was angry. He sent his armies, destroyed those murderers, and burned their city.

Matthew 22:8

King James Version: Then saith he to his servants, The wedding is ready, but they which were bidden were not worthy.

Decoded (Modern Language): Then he said to his servants, The wedding is ready, but those invited were not worthy.

Matthew 22:9

King James Version: Go ye therefore into the highways, and as many as ye shall find, bid to the marriage.

Decoded (Modern Language): Go to the roads and invite everyone you find to the wedding.

Matthew 22:10

King James Version: So those servants went out into the highways, and gathered together all as many as they found, both bad and good: and the wedding was furnished with guests.

Decoded (Modern Language): The servants went out on the roads and gathered everyone they found, both bad and good, and the wedding was filled with guests.

Matthew 22:11

King James Version: And when the king came in to see the guests, he saw there a man which had not on a wedding garment:

Decoded (Modern Language): When the king came in to see the guests, he noticed a man not wearing wedding clothes.

Matthew 22:12

King James Version: And he saith unto him, Friend, how camest thou in hither not having a wedding garment? And he was speechless.

Decoded (Modern Language): He said to him, Friend, how did you get in here without wedding clothes? But the man was silent.

Matthew 22:13

King James Version: Then said the king to the servants, Bind him hand and foot, and take him away, and cast him into outer darkness; there shall be weeping and gnashing of teeth.

Decoded (Modern Language): Then the king told his servants, Tie him hand and foot and throw him outside into the darkness, where there will be crying and grinding of teeth.

Matthew 22:14

King James Version: For many are called, but few are chosen.

Decoded (Modern Language): Many are invited, but few are chosen.

Matthew 22:15

King James Version: Then went the Pharisees, and took counsel how they might entangle him in his talk.

Decoded (Modern Language): Then the Pharisees went away and planned how to trap Jesus in his words.

Matthew 22:16

King James Version: And they sent out unto him their disciples with the Herodians, saying, Master, we know that thou art true, and teachest the way of God in truth, neither carest thou for any man: for thou regardest not the person of men.

Decoded (Modern Language): They sent their followers with the Herodians to say, Teacher, we know you tell the truth and teach God's way honestly. You don't worry about what people think, because you don't favor anyone.

Matthew 22:17

King James Version: Tell us therefore, What thinkest thou? Is it lawful to give tribute unto Caesar, or not?

Decoded (Modern Language): Tell us, what do you think? Is it right to pay taxes to Caesar or not?

Matthew 22:18

King James Version: But Jesus perceived their wickedness, and said, Why tempt ye me, ye hypocrites?

Decoded (Modern Language): Jesus knew their evil intentions and said, Why are you trying to trick me, you hypocrites?

Matthew 22:19

King James Version: Shew me the tribute money. And they brought unto him a penny.

Decoded (Modern Language): Show me the tax coin. They gave him a penny.

Matthew 22:20

King James Version: And he saith unto them, Whose is this image and superscription?

Decoded (Modern Language): He asked, Whose picture and writing is on this coin?

Matthew 22:21

King James Version: They say unto him, Caesar's. Then saith he unto them, Render therefore unto Caesar the things which are Caesar's; and unto God the things that are God's.

Decoded (Modern Language): They said, Caesar's. Then he said, Give to Caesar what belongs to Caesar, and give to God what belongs to God.

Matthew 22:22

King James Version: When they had heard these words, they marvelled, and left him, and went their way.
Decoded (Modern Language): When they heard this, they were amazed, left him, and went away.

Matthew 22:23

King James Version: The same day came to him the Sadducees, which say that there is no resurrection, and asked him,

Decoded (Modern Language): That same day, the Sadducees, who say there is no resurrection, came to him and asked,

Matthew 22:24

King James Version: Saying, Master, Moses said, If a man die, having no children, his brother shall marry his wife, and raise up seed unto his brother.

Decoded (Modern Language): Teacher, Moses said, If a man dies without children, his brother should marry the widow and have children for his brother.

Matthew 22:25

King James Version: Now there were with us seven brethren: and the first, when he had married a wife, deceased, and, having no issue, left his wife unto his brother:

Decoded (Modern Language): There were seven brothers with us. The first married a woman and died without children, so he left his wife to his brother.

Matthew 22:26

King James Version: Likewise the second also, and the third, unto the seventh.

Decoded (Modern Language): The same happened with the second and the third, up to the seventh.

Matthew 22:27

King James Version: And last of all the woman died also.

Decoded (Modern Language): Finally, the woman died too.

Matthew 22:28

King James Version: Therefore in the resurrection whose wife shall she be of the seven? for they all had her.

Decoded (Modern Language): So, in the resurrection, whose wife will she be? All seven had her as wife.

Matthew 22:29

King James Version: Jesus answered and said unto them, Ye do err, not knowing the scriptures, nor the power of God.

Decoded (Modern Language): Jesus answered, You are wrong because you don't understand the Scriptures or the power of God.

Matthew 22:30

King James Version: For in the resurrection they neither marry, nor are given in marriage, but are as the angels of God in heaven.

Decoded (Modern Language): At the resurrection, people will not marry or be married. They will be like God's angels in heaven.

Matthew 22:31

King James Version: But as touching the resurrection of the dead, have ye not read that which was spoken unto you by God, saying,

Decoded (Modern Language): But about the resurrection of the dead, haven't you read what God said to you,

Matthew 22:32

King James Version: I am the God of Abraham, and the God of Isaac, and the God of Jacob? God is not the God of the dead, but of the living.

Decoded (Modern Language): I am the God of Abraham, the God of Isaac, and the God of Jacob? God is not the God of the dead, but of the living.

Matthew 22:33

King James Version: And when the multitude heard this, they were astonished at his doctrine.

Decoded (Modern Language): When the crowd heard this, they were amazed at his teaching.

Matthew 22:34

King James Version: But when the Pharisees had heard that he had put the Sadducees to silence, they were gathered together.

Decoded (Modern Language): When the Pharisees heard that Jesus had silenced the Sadducees, they gathered together.

Matthew 22:35

King James Version: Then one of them, which was a lawyer, asked him a question, tempting him, and saying,

Decoded (Modern Language): Then one of them, a lawyer, asked him a question to test him, saying,

Matthew 22:36

King James Version: Master, which is the great commandment in the law?

Decoded (Modern Language): Teacher, which is the greatest commandment in the law?

Matthew 22:37

King James Version: Jesus said unto him, Thou shalt love the Lord thy God with all thy heart, and with all thy soul, and with all thy mind.

Decoded (Modern Language): Jesus said to him, You must love the Lord your God with all your heart, with all your soul, and with all your mind.

Matthew 22:38

King James Version: This is the first and great commandment.

Decoded (Modern Language): This is the first and greatest commandment.

Matthew 22:39

King James Version: And the second is like unto it, Thou shalt love thy neighbour as thyself.

Decoded (Modern Language): The second is like it: You must love your neighbor as yourself.

Matthew 22:40

King James Version: On these two commandments hang all the law and the prophets.

Decoded (Modern Language): All the law and the prophets depend on these two commandments.

Matthew 22:41

King James Version: While the Pharisees were gathered together, Jesus asked them,

Decoded (Modern Language): While the Pharisees were gathered, Jesus asked them,

Matthew 22:42

King James Version: Saying, What think ye of Christ? whose son is he? They say unto him, The Son of David.

Decoded (Modern Language): What do you think about the Christ? Whose son is he? They answered, The Son of David.

Matthew 22:43

King James Version: He saith unto them, How then doth David in spirit call him Lord, saying,

Decoded (Modern Language): He said to them, Then how does David, speaking by the Spirit, call him Lord, saying,

Matthew 22:44

King James Version: The LORD said unto my Lord, Sit thou on my right hand, till I make thine enemies thy footstool?

Decoded (Modern Language): The Lord said to my Lord, Sit at my right hand until I put your enemies under your feet?

Matthew 22:45

King James Version: If David then call him Lord, how is he his son?

Decoded (Modern Language): If David calls him Lord, how can he be his son?

Matthew 22:46

King James Version: And no man was able to answer him a word, neither durst any man from that day forth ask him any more questions.

Decoded (Modern Language): No one could answer him a word, and from that day no one dared to ask him any more questions.

MATTHEW — CHAPTER 23

Matthew 23:1

King James Version: Then spake Jesus to the multitude, and to his disciples,

Decoded (Modern Language): Then Jesus spoke to the crowd and to his followers,

Matthew 23:2

King James Version: Saying, The scribes and the Pharisees sit in Moses' seat:

Decoded (Modern Language): saying, The teachers of the law and the Pharisees sit in Moses' place of authority.

Matthew 23:3

King James Version: All therefore whatsoever they bid you observe, that observe and do; but do not ye after their works: for they say, and do not.

Decoded (Modern Language): So do everything they tell you to do, but don't follow their example, because they say one thing and do another.

Matthew 23:4

King James Version: For they bind heavy burdens and grievous to be borne, and lay them on men's shoulders; but they themselves will not move them with one of their fingers.

Decoded (Modern Language): They put heavy burdens on people's shoulders, hard to carry, but they themselves won't lift a finger to help.

Matthew 23:5

King James Version: But all their works they do for to be seen of men: they make broad their phylacteries, and enlarge the borders of their garments,

Decoded (Modern Language): They do everything to be noticed by others: they make their prayer boxes wide and the edges of their robes long,

Matthew 23:6

King James Version: And love the uppermost rooms at feasts, and the chief seats in the synagogues,

Decoded (Modern Language): and they love the best seats at banquets and the front seats in the synagogues,

Matthew 23:7

King James Version: And greetings in the markets, and to be called of men, Rabbi, Rabbi.

Decoded (Modern Language): and they like to be greeted in the marketplaces and to be called 'Rabbi' by others.

Matthew 23:8

King James Version: But be not ye called Rabbi: for one is your Master, even Christ; and all ye are brethren.

Decoded (Modern Language): But don't let anyone call you 'Rabbi,' because you have only one Teacher, and you are all brothers.

Matthew 23:9

King James Version: And call no man your father upon the earth: for one is your Father, which is in heaven.

Decoded (Modern Language): Don't call anyone on earth 'father,' because you have one Father, the one in heaven.

Matthew 23:10

King James Version: Neither be ye called masters: for one is your Master, even Christ.

Decoded (Modern Language): And don't be called 'teacher,' because you have only one Teacher, the Messiah.

Matthew 23:11

King James Version: But he that is greatest among you shall be your servant.

Decoded (Modern Language): The greatest among you must be your servant.

Matthew 23:12

King James Version: And whosoever shall exalt himself shall be abased; and he that shall humble himself shall be exalted.

Decoded (Modern Language): Those who lift themselves up will be humbled, and those who humble themselves will be lifted up.

Matthew 23:13

King James Version: But woe unto you, scribes and Pharisees, hypocrites! for ye shut up the kingdom of heaven against men: for ye neither go in yourselves, neither suffer ye them that are entering to go in.

Decoded (Modern Language): But what sorrow awaits you, teachers of the law and Pharisees, you hypocrites! You close the kingdom of heaven to others. You don't go in yourselves, and you stop those who are trying to enter.

Matthew 23:14

King James Version: Woe unto you, scribes and Pharisees, hypocrites! for ye devour widows' houses, and for a pretence make long prayer: therefore ye shall receive the greater damnation.

Decoded (Modern Language): What sorrow awaits you, teachers of the law and Pharisees, you hypocrites! You cheat widows out of their homes, and you say long prayers just to show off. Because of this, you will be punished more severely.

Matthew 23:15

King James Version: Woe unto you, scribes and Pharisees, hypocrites! for ye compass sea and land to make one proselyte, and when he is made, ye make him twofold more the child of hell than yourselves.

Decoded (Modern Language): What sorrow awaits you, teachers of the law and Pharisees, you hypocrites! You travel all over land and sea to make one new follower, but when you succeed, you make that person twice as much a child of hell as you are.

Matthew 23:16

King James Version: Woe unto you, ye blind guides, which say, Whosoever shall swear by the temple, it is nothing; but whosoever shall swear by the gold of the temple, he is a debtor!

Decoded (Modern Language): What sorrow awaits you, blind guides! You say, 'If someone swears by the temple, it means nothing, but if someone swears by the gold in the temple, that person is bound by the oath.'

Matthew 23:17

King James Version: Ye fools and blind: for whether is greater, the gold, or the temple that sanctifieth the gold?

Decoded (Modern Language): You blind fools! Which is greater, the gold or the temple that makes the gold holy?

Matthew 23:18

King James Version: And, Whosoever shall swear by the altar, it is nothing; but whosoever sweareth by the gift that is upon it, he is guilty.

Decoded (Modern Language): You say, 'If someone swears by the altar, it means nothing, but if someone swears by the gift on the altar, that person is bound by the oath.'

Matthew 23:19

King James Version: Ye fools and blind: for whether is greater, the gift, or the altar that sanctifieth the gift?

Decoded (Modern Language): You blind fools! Which is greater, the gift or the altar that makes the gift holy?

Matthew 23:20

King James Version: Whoso therefore shall swear by the altar, sweareth by it, and by all things thereon.

Decoded (Modern Language): So anyone who swears by the altar swears by it and everything on it.

Matthew 23:21

King James Version: And whoso shall swear by the temple, sweareth by it, and by him that dwelleth therein.

Decoded (Modern Language): Anyone who swears by the temple swears by it and by the one who lives there.

Matthew 23:22

King James Version: And he that shall swear by heaven, sweareth by the throne of God, and by him that sitteth thereon.

Decoded (Modern Language): Anyone who swears by heaven swears by God's throne and by the one who sits on it.

Matthew 23:23

King James Version: Woe unto you, scribes and Pharisees, hypocrites! for ye pay tithe of mint and anise and cummin, and have omitted the weightier matters of the law, judgment, mercy, and faith: these ought ye to have done, and not to leave the other undone.

Decoded (Modern Language): What sorrow awaits you, teachers of the law and Pharisees, you hypocrites! You give a tenth of your spices—mint, dill, and cumin—but you have ignored the more important matters of

the law—justice, mercy, and faithfulness. You should have done these things without leaving the others undone.

Matthew 23:24

King James Version: Ye blind guides, which strain at a gnat, and swallow a camel.

Decoded (Modern Language): You blind guides! You strain out a tiny gnat but swallow a camel.

Matthew 23:25

King James Version: Woe unto you, scribes and Pharisees, hypocrites! for ye make clean the outside of the cup and of the platter, but within they are full of extortion and excess.

Decoded (Modern Language): What sorrow awaits you, teachers of the law and Pharisees, you hypocrites! You clean the outside of the cup and dish, but inside they are full of greed and self-indulgence.

Matthew 23:26

King James Version: Thou blind Pharisee, cleanse first that which is within the cup and platter, that the outside of them may be clean also.

Decoded (Modern Language): You blind Pharisee! First clean the inside of the cup and dish, and then the outside will become clean too.

Matthew 23:27

King James Version: Woe unto you, scribes and Pharisees, hypocrites! for ye are like unto whited sepulchres, which indeed appear beautiful outward, but are within full of dead men's bones, and of all uncleanness.

Decoded (Modern Language): What sorrow awaits you, teachers of the law and Pharisees, you hypocrites! You are like whitewashed tombs—beautiful on the outside but full of dead bones and everything unclean on the inside.

Matthew 23:28

King James Version: Even so ye also outwardly appear righteous unto men, but within ye are full of hypocrisy and iniquity.

Decoded (Modern Language): In the same way, you appear righteous to others, but inside you are full of hypocrisy and wickedness.

Matthew 23:29

King James Version: Woe unto you, scribes and Pharisees, hypocrites! because ye build the tombs of the prophets, and garnish the sepulchres of the righteous,

Decoded (Modern Language): What sorrow awaits you, teachers of the law and Pharisees, you hypocrites! You build tombs for the prophets and decorate the graves of the righteous.

Matthew 23:30

King James Version: And say, If we had been in the days of our fathers, we would not have been partakers with them in the blood of the prophets.

Decoded (Modern Language): And you say, 'If we had lived in the days of our ancestors, we would not have joined them in killing the prophets.'

Matthew 23:31

King James Version: Wherefore ye be witnesses unto yourselves, that ye are the children of them which killed the prophets.

Decoded (Modern Language): So you prove yourselves guilty because you are the children of those who killed the prophets.

Matthew 23:32

King James Version: Fill ye up then the measure of your fathers.

Decoded (Modern Language): Then go ahead and complete the punishment your ancestors started.

Matthew 23:33

King James Version: Ye serpents, ye generation of vipers, how can ye escape the damnation of hell?

Decoded (Modern Language): You snakes, you children of vipers, how can you escape the punishment of hell?

Matthew 23:34

King James Version: Wherefore, behold, I send unto you prophets, and wise men, and scribes: and some of them ye shall kill and crucify; and some of them shall ye scourge in your synagogues, and persecute them from city to city:

Decoded (Modern Language): That is why I am sending you prophets, wise men, and teachers. Some of them you will kill and nail to crosses; others you will whip in your meeting places and chase from town to town.

Matthew 23:35

King James Version: That upon you may come all the righteous blood shed upon the earth, from the blood of righteous Abel unto the blood of Zacharias son of Barachias, whom ye slew between the temple and the altar.

Decoded (Modern Language): Then all the innocent blood that has been spilled on the earth will come back on you—from the blood of righteous Abel to the blood of Zechariah, son of Barachiah, whom you killed between the temple and the altar.

Matthew 23:36

King James Version: Verily I say unto you, All these things shall come upon this generation.

Decoded (Modern Language): I tell you the truth, all these things will happen to this generation.

Matthew 23:37

King James Version: O Jerusalem, Jerusalem, thou that killest the prophets, and stonest them which are sent unto thee, how often would I have gathered thy children together, even as a hen gathereth her chickens under her wings, and ye would not!

Decoded (Modern Language): Jerusalem, Jerusalem, you who kill the prophets and stone those sent to you, how often I wanted to gather your children together like a mother hen gathers her chicks under her wings, but you refused!

Matthew 23:38

King James Version: Behold, your house is left unto you desolate.

Decoded (Modern Language): Look, your house is left empty.

Matthew 23:39

King James Version: For I say unto you, Ye shall not see me henceforth, till ye shall say, Blessed is he that cometh in the name of the Lord.

Decoded (Modern Language): I tell you, you will not see me again until you say, 'Blessed is the one who comes in the name of the Lord.'

MATTHEW — CHAPTER 24**Matthew 24:1**

King James Version: And Jesus went out, and departed from the temple: and his disciples came to him for to shew him the buildings of the temple.

Decoded (Modern Language): Jesus left and went away from the temple, and his followers came to him to show him the temple buildings.

Matthew 24:2

King James Version: And Jesus said unto them, See ye not all these things? verily I say unto you, There shall not be left here one stone upon another, that shall not be thrown down.

Decoded (Modern Language): Jesus said to them, 'Do you not see all these things? I tell you the truth, not one stone here will be left on another; every one will be thrown down.'

Matthew 24:3

King James Version: And as he sat upon the mount of Olives, the disciples came unto him privately, saying, Tell us, when shall these things be? and what shall be the sign of thy coming, and of the end of the world?

Decoded (Modern Language): While Jesus was sitting on the Mount of Olives, the disciples came to him privately and asked, 'Tell us, when will these things happen? What will be the sign of your coming and the end of the world?'

Matthew 24:4

King James Version: And Jesus answered and said unto them, Take heed that no man deceive you.

Decoded (Modern Language): Jesus answered, 'Watch out that no one deceives you.'

Matthew 24:5

King James Version: For many shall come in my name, saying, I am Christ; and shall deceive many.

Decoded (Modern Language): Many will come in my name, saying, 'I am the Messiah,' and they will deceive many.

Matthew 24:6

King James Version: And ye shall hear of wars and rumours of wars: see that ye be not troubled: for all these things must come to pass, but the end is not yet.

Decoded (Modern Language): You will hear about wars and rumors of wars. Don't be alarmed; these things must happen, but the end is not yet.

Matthew 24:7

King James Version: For nation shall rise against nation, and kingdom against kingdom: and there shall be famines, and pestilences, and earthquakes, in divers places.

Decoded (Modern Language): Nation will fight against nation, and kingdom against kingdom. There will be famines, diseases, and earthquakes in many places.

Matthew 24:8

King James Version: All these are the beginning of sorrows.

Decoded (Modern Language): All these things are just the beginning of troubles.

Matthew 24:9

King James Version: Then shall they deliver you up to be afflicted, and shall kill you: and ye shall be hated of all nations for my name's sake.

Decoded (Modern Language): Then people will hand you over to be persecuted and killed, and you will be hated by all nations because of my name.

Matthew 24:10

King James Version: And then shall many be offended, and shall betray one another, and shall hate one another.

Decoded (Modern Language): At that time many will turn away from the faith, betray each other, and hate each other.

Matthew 24:11

King James Version: And many false prophets shall rise, and shall deceive many.

Decoded (Modern Language): Many false prophets will appear and deceive many people.

Matthew 24:12

King James Version: And because iniquity shall abound, the love of many shall wax cold.

Decoded (Modern Language): Because of the increase of evil, the love of most will grow cold.

Matthew 24:13

King James Version: But he that shall endure unto the end, the same shall be saved.

Decoded (Modern Language): But the one who endures to the end will be saved.

Matthew 24:14

King James Version: And this gospel of the kingdom shall be preached in all the world for a witness unto all nations; and then shall the end come.

Decoded (Modern Language): This good news about the kingdom will be preached throughout the whole world as a witness to all nations, and then the end will come.

Matthew 24:15

King James Version: When ye therefore shall see the abomination of desolation, spoken of by Daniel the prophet, stand in the holy place, (whoso readeth, let him understand:)

Decoded (Modern Language): So when you see the terrible thing that causes destruction, spoken of by the prophet Daniel, standing in the holy place—let the reader understand—

Matthew 24:16

King James Version: Then let them which be in Judaea flee into the mountains:

Decoded (Modern Language): then those in Judea must flee to the mountains.

Matthew 24:17

King James Version: Let him which is on the housetop not come down to take any thing out of his house:

Decoded (Modern Language): Anyone on the roof must not go down to get anything from their house.

Matthew 24:18

King James Version: Neither let him which is in the field return back to take his clothes.

Decoded (Modern Language): Anyone in the field must not go back to get their clothes.

Matthew 24:19

King James Version: And woe unto them that are with child, and to them that give suck in those days!

Decoded (Modern Language): How terrible it will be for pregnant women and nursing mothers at that time!

Matthew 24:20

King James Version: But pray ye that your flight be not in the winter, neither on the sabbath day:

Decoded (Modern Language): Pray that your escape will not happen in winter or on the Sabbath.

Matthew 24:21

King James Version: For then shall be great tribulation, such as was not since the beginning of the world to this time, no, nor ever shall be.

Decoded (Modern Language): Because then there will be great suffering, such as has not happened from the beginning of the world until now, and never will again.

Matthew 24:22

King James Version: And except those days should be shortened, there should no flesh be saved: but for the elect's sake those days shall be shortened.

Decoded (Modern Language): If those days were not shortened, no one would survive. But for the sake of God's chosen people, those days will be shortened.

Matthew 24:23

King James Version: Then if any man shall say unto you, Lo, here is Christ, or there; believe it not.

Decoded (Modern Language): If anyone says to you, 'Look, here is the Messiah,' or 'There he is,' do not believe it.

Matthew 24:24

King James Version: For there shall arise false Christs, and false prophets, and shall shew great signs and wonders; insomuch that, if it were possible, they shall deceive the very elect.

Decoded (Modern Language): False messiahs and false prophets will appear and perform great signs and wonders to deceive, if possible, even God's chosen people.

Matthew 24:25

King James Version: Behold, I have told you before.

Decoded (Modern Language): I have warned you about this ahead of time.

Matthew 24:26

King James Version: Wherefore if they shall say unto you, Behold, he is in the desert; go not forth: behold, he is in the secret chambers; believe it not.

Decoded (Modern Language): So if people say to you, 'Look, he is in the desert,' do not go out; or 'Look, he is in the secret rooms,' do not believe it.

Matthew 24:27

King James Version: For as the lightning cometh out of the east, and shineth even unto the west; so shall also the coming of the Son of man be.

Decoded (Modern Language): For as lightning comes from the east and shines as far as the west, so will the coming of the Son of Man be.

Matthew 24:28

King James Version: For wheresoever the carcase is, there will the eagles be gathered together.

Decoded (Modern Language): Wherever there is a dead body, there the vultures will gather.

Matthew 24:29

King James Version: Immediately after the tribulation of those days shall the sun be darkened, and the moon shall not give her light, and the stars shall fall from heaven, and the powers of the heavens shall be shaken:

Decoded (Modern Language): Immediately after the suffering of those days, the sun will be darkened, the moon will not give its light, the stars will fall from the sky, and the powers in the heavens will be shaken.

Matthew 24:30

King James Version: And then shall appear the sign of the Son of man in heaven: and then shall all the tribes of the earth mourn, and they shall see the Son of man coming in the clouds of heaven with power and great glory.

Decoded (Modern Language): Then the sign of the Son of Man will appear in the sky, and all the peoples of the earth will mourn. They will see the Son of Man coming on the clouds of heaven with power and great glory.

Matthew 24:31

King James Version: And he shall send his angels with a great sound of a trumpet, and they shall gather together his elect from the four winds, from one end of heaven to the other.

Decoded (Modern Language): He will send his angels with a loud trumpet blast, and they will gather his chosen ones from all over the earth, from one end of the sky to the other.

Matthew 24:32

King James Version: Now learn a parable of the fig tree; When his branch is yet tender, and putteth forth leaves, ye know that summer is nigh:

Decoded (Modern Language): Now learn a lesson from the fig tree: when its branches are soft and leaves start to grow, you know summer is near.

Matthew 24:33

King James Version: So likewise ye, when ye shall see all these things, know that it is near, even at the doors.

Decoded (Modern Language): In the same way, when you see all these things happening, know that it is near, right at the door.

Matthew 24:34

King James Version: Verily I say unto you, This generation shall not pass, till all these things be fulfilled.

Decoded (Modern Language): I tell you the truth, this generation will not pass away until all these things have happened.

Matthew 24:35

King James Version: Heaven and earth shall pass away, but my words shall not pass away.

Decoded (Modern Language): Heaven and earth will disappear, but my words will never disappear.

Matthew 24:36

King James Version: But of that day and hour knoweth no man, no, not the angels of heaven, but my Father only.

Decoded (Modern Language): But no one knows the day or hour—not even the angels in heaven—only my Father knows.

Matthew 24:37

King James Version: But as the days of Noe were, so shall also the coming of the Son of man be.

Decoded (Modern Language): As it was in the days of Noah, so will be the coming of the Son of Man.

Matthew 24:38

King James Version: For as in the days that were before the flood they were eating and drinking, marrying and giving in marriage, until the day that Noe entered into the ark,

Decoded (Modern Language): In those days before the flood, people were eating and drinking, marrying and giving in marriage, until the day Noah entered the ark.

Matthew 24:39

King James Version: And knew not until the flood came, and took them all away; so shall also the coming of the Son of man be.

Decoded (Modern Language): They didn't realize what was coming until the flood came and took them all away. That is how the coming of the Son of Man will be.

Matthew 24:40

King James Version: Then shall two be in the field; the one shall be taken, and the other left.

Decoded (Modern Language): Two people will be working in the field; one will be taken, and the other left.

Matthew 24:41

King James Version: Two women shall be grinding at the mill; the one shall be taken, and the other left.

Decoded (Modern Language): Two women will be grinding grain at the mill; one will be taken, and the other left.

Matthew 24:42

King James Version: Watch therefore: for ye know not what hour your Lord doth come.

Decoded (Modern Language): So keep watch, because you don't know the hour your Lord will come.

Matthew 24:43

King James Version: But know this, that if the goodman of the house had known in what watch the thief would come, he would have watched, and would not have suffered his house to be broken up.

Decoded (Modern Language): But understand this: if the owner of the house had known when the thief was coming, he would have stayed awake and not let his house be broken into.

Matthew 24:44

King James Version: Therefore be ye also ready: for in such an hour as ye think not the Son of man cometh.

Decoded (Modern Language): So you also must be ready, because the Son of Man will come at an hour you do not expect.

Matthew 24:45

King James Version: Who then is a faithful and wise servant, whom his lord hath made ruler over his household, to give them meat in due season?

Decoded (Modern Language): Who is the faithful and wise servant whom the master puts in charge of his household to give them food at the right time?

Matthew 24:46

King James Version: Blessed is that servant, whom his lord when he cometh shall find so doing.

Decoded (Modern Language): Happy is that servant whom the master finds doing his job when he returns.

Matthew 24:47

King James Version: Verily I say unto you, That he shall make him ruler over all his goods.

Decoded (Modern Language): I tell you the truth, the master will put him in charge of all his possessions.

Matthew 24:48

King James Version: But and if that evil servant shall say in his heart, My lord delayeth his coming;

Decoded (Modern Language): But if that servant says to himself, 'My master is taking a long time to come,'

Matthew 24:49

King James Version: And shall begin to smite his fellowservants, and to eat and drink with the drunken;

Decoded (Modern Language): and begins to beat the other servants and eat and drink with drunkards,

Matthew 24:50

King James Version: The lord of that servant shall come in a day when he looketh not for him, and in an hour that he is not aware of,

Decoded (Modern Language): the master of that servant will come on a day he does not expect and at an hour he does not know.

Matthew 24:51

King James Version: And shall cut him asunder, and appoint him his portion with the hypocrites: there shall be weeping and gnashing of teeth.

Decoded (Modern Language): He will punish him severely and assign him a place with the hypocrites, where there will be weeping and grinding of teeth.

MATTHEW — CHAPTER 25**Matthew 25:1**

King James Version: Then shall the kingdom of heaven be likened unto ten virgins, which took their lamps, and went forth to meet the bridegroom.

Decoded (Modern Language): The kingdom of heaven will be like ten young women who took their lamps and went out to meet the bridegroom.

Matthew 25:2

King James Version: And five of them were wise, and five were foolish.

Decoded (Modern Language): Five of them were wise, and five were foolish.

Matthew 25:3

King James Version: They that were foolish took their lamps, and took no oil with them:

Decoded (Modern Language): The foolish ones took their lamps but did not bring any extra oil with them.

Matthew 25:4

King James Version: But the wise took oil in their vessels with their lamps.

Decoded (Modern Language): But the wise ones took oil in jars along with their lamps.

Matthew 25:5

King James Version: While the bridegroom tarried, they all slumbered and slept.

Decoded (Modern Language): While they waited for the bridegroom, they all became drowsy and fell asleep.

Matthew 25:6

King James Version: And at midnight there was a cry made, Behold, the bridegroom cometh; go ye out to meet him.

Decoded (Modern Language): At midnight, there was a shout: 'Here is the bridegroom! Come out to meet him!'

Matthew 25:7

King James Version: Then all those virgins arose, and trimmed their lamps.

Decoded (Modern Language): Then all the young women woke up and trimmed their lamps.

Matthew 25:8

King James Version: And the foolish said unto the wise, Give us of your oil; for our lamps are gone out.

Decoded (Modern Language): The foolish ones said to the wise, 'Give us some of your oil because our lamps are going out.'

Matthew 25:9

King James Version: But the wise answered, saying, Not so; lest there be not enough for us and you: but go ye rather to them that sell, and buy for yourselves.

Decoded (Modern Language): But the wise answered, 'No, because there may not be enough for both us and you. Instead, go to those who sell oil and buy some for yourselves.'

Matthew 25:10

King James Version: And while they went to buy, the bridegroom came; and they that were ready went in with him to the marriage: and the door was shut.

Decoded (Modern Language): While they went to buy oil, the bridegroom arrived. Those who were ready went in with him to the wedding, and the door was shut.

Matthew 25:11

King James Version: Afterward came also the other virgins, saying, Lord, Lord, open to us.

Decoded (Modern Language): Later, the other young women came and said, 'Lord, Lord, open the door for us!'

Matthew 25:12

King James Version: But he answered and said, Verily I say unto you, I know you not.

Decoded (Modern Language): But he replied, 'Truly, I tell you, I do not know you.'

Matthew 25:13

King James Version: Watch therefore, for ye know neither the day nor the hour wherein the Son of man cometh.

Decoded (Modern Language): So be ready, because you do not know the day or the hour when the Son of Man will come.

Matthew 25:14

King James Version: For the kingdom of heaven is as a man travelling into a far country, who called his own servants, and delivered unto them his goods.

Decoded (Modern Language): The kingdom of heaven is like a man going on a journey who called his servants and gave them his property.

Matthew 25:15

King James Version: And unto one he gave five talents, to another two, and to another one; to every man according to his several ability; and straightway took his journey.

Decoded (Modern Language): He gave one servant five talents, another two, and another one, each according to his ability, then he left on his trip.

Matthew 25:16

King James Version: Then he that had received the five talents went and traded with the same, and made them other five talents.

Decoded (Modern Language): The servant who received five talents went and traded with them and earned five more talents.

Matthew 25:17

King James Version: And likewise he that had received two, he also gained other two.

Decoded (Modern Language): In the same way, the servant who received two talents earned two more.

Matthew 25:18

King James Version: But he that had received one went and digged in the earth, and hid his lord's money.

Decoded (Modern Language): But the servant who received one talent dug a hole in the ground and hid his master's money.

Matthew 25:19

King James Version: After a long time the lord of those servants cometh, and reckoneth with them.

Decoded (Modern Language): After a long time, the master returned and settled accounts with his servants.

Matthew 25:20

King James Version: And so he that had received five talents came and brought other five talents, saying, Lord, thou deliveredst unto me five talents: behold, I have gained beside them five talents more.

Decoded (Modern Language): The servant who had received five talents came and brought five more, saying, 'Master, you gave me five talents; see, I have earned five more.'

Matthew 25:21

King James Version: His lord said unto him, Well done, thou good and faithful servant: thou hast been faithful over a few things, I will make thee ruler over many things: enter thou into the joy of thy lord.

Decoded (Modern Language): His master said, 'Well done, good and faithful servant! You have been faithful with a few things; I will put you in charge of many things. Come and share your master's happiness.'

Matthew 25:22

King James Version: He also that had received two talents came and said, Lord, thou deliveredst unto me two talents: behold, I have gained two other talents beside them.

Decoded (Modern Language): The servant with two talents also came and said, 'Master, you gave me two talents; see, I have earned two more.'

Matthew 25:23

King James Version: His lord said unto him, Well done, good and faithful servant; thou hast been faithful over a few things, I will make thee ruler over many things: enter thou into the joy of thy lord.

Decoded (Modern Language): His master said, 'Well done, good and faithful servant! You have been faithful with a few things; I will put you in charge of many things. Come and share your master's happiness.'

Matthew 25:24

King James Version: Then he which had received the one talent came and said, Lord, I knew thee that thou art an hard man, reaping where thou hast not sown, and gathering where thou hast not strawed:

Decoded (Modern Language): Then the servant who had received one talent came and said, 'Master, I knew you were a hard man, harvesting where you did not plant and gathering where you did not scatter seed.'

Matthew 25:25

King James Version: And I was afraid, and went and hid thy talent in the earth: lo, there thou hast that is thine.

Decoded (Modern Language): I was afraid, so I hid your talent in the ground. Here it is back.'

Matthew 25:26

King James Version: His lord answered and said unto him, Thou wicked and slothful servant, thou knewest that I reap where I sowed not, and gather where I have not strawed:

Decoded (Modern Language): His master answered, 'You wicked and lazy servant! You knew I harvest where I did not plant and gather where I did not scatter seed.'

Matthew 25:27

King James Version: Thou oughtest therefore to have put my money to the exchangers, and then at my coming I should have received mine own with usury.

Decoded (Modern Language): You should have put my money with the bankers, and when I returned, I would have received it back with interest.

Matthew 25:28

King James Version: Take therefore the talent from him, and give it unto him which hath ten talents.

Decoded (Modern Language): Take the talent away from him and give it to the one who has ten talents.

Matthew 25:29

King James Version: For unto every one that hath shall be given, and he shall have abundance: but from him that hath not shall be taken away even that which he hath.

Decoded (Modern Language): To everyone who has, more will be given, and they will have an abundance. But from the one who has nothing, even what they have will be taken away.

Matthew 25:30

King James Version: And cast ye the unprofitable servant into outer darkness: there shall be weeping and gnashing of teeth.

Decoded (Modern Language): Throw that useless servant outside, into the darkness, where there will be weeping and grinding of teeth.'

Matthew 25:31

King James Version: When the Son of man shall come in his glory, and all the holy angels with him, then shall he sit upon the throne of his glory:

Decoded (Modern Language): When the Son of Man comes in his glory, with all the angels, he will sit on his glorious throne.

Matthew 25:32

King James Version: And before him shall be gathered all nations: and he shall separate them one from another, as a shepherd divideth his sheep from the goats:

Decoded (Modern Language): All the nations will be gathered in front of him, and he will separate them like a shepherd separates sheep from goats.

Matthew 25:33

King James Version: And he shall set the sheep on his right hand, but the goats on the left.

Decoded (Modern Language): He will place the sheep on his right side, and the goats on his left.

Matthew 25:34

King James Version: Then shall the King say unto them on his right hand, Come, ye blessed of my Father, inherit the kingdom prepared for you from the foundation of the world:

Decoded (Modern Language): Then the King will say to those on his right, 'Come, you who are blessed by my Father; receive the kingdom prepared for you since the world was created.'

Matthew 25:35

King James Version: For I was an hungred, and ye gave me meat: I was thirsty, and ye gave me drink: I was a stranger, and ye took me in:

Decoded (Modern Language): I was hungry, and you gave me food; I was thirsty, and you gave me something to drink; I was a stranger, and you welcomed me.

Matthew 25:36

King James Version: Naked, and ye clothed me: I was sick, and ye visited me: I was in prison, and ye came unto me.

Decoded (Modern Language): I was without clothes, and you gave me clothing; I was sick, and you cared for me; I was in prison, and you visited me.

Matthew 25:37

King James Version: Then shall the righteous answer him, saying, Lord, when saw we thee an hungred, and fed thee? or thirsty, and gave thee drink?

Decoded (Modern Language): Then the righteous will answer him, 'Lord, when did we see you hungry and feed you? Or thirsty and give you something to drink?'

Matthew 25:38

King James Version: When saw we thee a stranger, and took thee in? or naked, and clothed thee?

Decoded (Modern Language): When did we see you a stranger and welcome you? Or without clothes and clothe you?

Matthew 25:39

King James Version: Or when saw we thee sick, or in prison, and came unto thee?

Decoded (Modern Language): When did we see you sick or in prison and visit you?'

Matthew 25:40

King James Version: And the King shall answer and say unto them, Verily I say unto you, Inasmuch as ye have done it unto one of the least of these my brethren, ye have done it unto me.

Decoded (Modern Language): The King will reply, 'I tell you the truth, whatever you did for one of the least of these brothers and sisters of mine, you did for me.'

Matthew 25:41

King James Version: Then shall he say also unto them on the left hand, Depart from me, ye cursed, into everlasting fire, prepared for the devil and his angels:

Decoded (Modern Language): Then he will say to those on his left, 'Go away from me, you who are cursed, into the eternal fire prepared for the devil and his angels.'

Matthew 25:42

King James Version: For I was an hungred, and ye gave me no meat: I was thirsty, and ye gave me no drink:

Decoded (Modern Language): I was hungry, and you gave me no food; I was thirsty, and you gave me nothing to drink.

Matthew 25:43

King James Version: I was a stranger, and ye took me not in: naked, and ye clothed me not: sick, and in prison, and ye visited me not.

Decoded (Modern Language): I was a stranger, and you did not welcome me; I was without clothes, and you did not clothe me; I was sick and in prison, and you did not visit me.'

Matthew 25:44

King James Version: Then shall they also answer him, saying, Lord, when saw we thee an hungred, or athirst, or a stranger, or naked, or sick, or in prison, and did not minister unto thee?

Decoded (Modern Language): Then they will also answer, 'Lord, when did we see you hungry or thirsty or a stranger or without clothes or sick or in prison, and not help you?'

Matthew 25:45

King James Version: Then shall he answer them, saying, Verily I say unto you, Inasmuch as ye did it not to one of the least of these, ye did it not to me.

Decoded (Modern Language): He will reply, 'I tell you the truth, whatever you did not do for one of the least of these, you did not do for me.'

Matthew 25:46

King James Version: And these shall go away into everlasting punishment: but the righteous into life eternal.

Decoded (Modern Language): And they will go away to eternal punishment, but the righteous will go to eternal life.

MATTHEW — CHAPTER 26

Matthew 26:1

King James Version: And it came to pass, when Jesus had finished all these sayings, he said unto his disciples,

Decoded (Modern Language): After Jesus finished saying all these things, he said to his disciples,

Matthew 26:2

King James Version: Ye know that after two days is the feast of the passover, and the Son of man is betrayed to be crucified.

Decoded (Modern Language): You know that in two days the Passover feast will happen, and the Son of Man will be handed over to be crucified.

Matthew 26:3

King James Version: Then assembled together the chief priests, and the scribes, and the elders of the people, unto the palace of the high priest, who was called Caiaphas,

Decoded (Modern Language): Then the chief priests, the teachers of the law, and the elders met together at the high priest's house, whose name was Caiaphas.

Matthew 26:4

King James Version: And consulted that they might take Jesus by subtilty, and kill him.

Decoded (Modern Language): They planned how to arrest Jesus secretly and kill him.

Matthew 26:5

King James Version: But they said, Not on the feast day, lest there be an uproar among the people.

Decoded (Modern Language): But they said, 'Not during the feast, or the people might start a riot.'

Matthew 26:6

King James Version: Now when Jesus was in Bethany, in the house of Simon the leper,

Decoded (Modern Language): While Jesus was in Bethany at the home of Simon the man who had leprosy,

Matthew 26:7

King James Version: There came unto him a woman having an alabaster box of very precious ointment, and poured it on his head, as he sat at meat.

Decoded (Modern Language): a woman came to him with a jar of very expensive perfume made of pure nard. She poured it on his head as he was eating.

Matthew 26:8

King James Version: But when his disciples saw it, they had indignation, saying, To what purpose is this waste?

Decoded (Modern Language): When the disciples saw this, they were angry and said, 'Why waste this perfume like that?'

Matthew 26:9

King James Version: For this ointment might have been sold for much, and given to the poor.

Decoded (Modern Language): It could have been sold for a lot of money and given to the poor.

Matthew 26:10

King James Version: When Jesus understood it, he said unto them, Why trouble ye the woman? for she hath wrought a good work upon me.

Decoded (Modern Language): Jesus knew what they were thinking and said, 'Why are you bothering this woman? She has done a beautiful thing for me.'

Matthew 26:11

King James Version: For ye have the poor always with you; but me ye have not always.

Decoded (Modern Language): You will always have the poor with you, but you will not always have me.

Matthew 26:12

King James Version: For in that she hath poured this ointment on my body, she did it for my burial.

Decoded (Modern Language): She poured this perfume on my body to prepare me for burial.

Matthew 26:13

King James Version: Verily I say unto you, Wheresoever this gospel shall be preached in the whole world, there shall also this, that this woman hath done, be told for a memorial of her.

Decoded (Modern Language): I tell you the truth, wherever this good news is preached throughout the world, what she has done will also be told in memory of her.'

Matthew 26:14

King James Version: Then one of the twelve, called Judas Iscariot, went unto the chief priests,

Decoded (Modern Language): Then one of the twelve, Judas Iscariot, went to the chief priests

Matthew 26:15

King James Version: And said unto them, What will ye give me, and I will deliver him unto you? And they covenanted with him for thirty pieces of silver.

Decoded (Modern Language): and asked, 'What will you give me if I hand him over to you?' They agreed to pay him thirty pieces of silver.

Matthew 26:16

King James Version: And from that time he sought opportunity to betray him.

Decoded (Modern Language): From then on, Judas looked for a chance to betray Jesus.

Matthew 26:17

King James Version: Now the first day of the feast of unleavened bread the disciples came to Jesus, saying unto him, Where wilt thou that we prepare for thee to eat the passover?

Decoded (Modern Language): On the first day of the Feast of Unleavened Bread, the disciples came to Jesus and asked, 'Where do you want us to prepare the Passover meal for you?'

Matthew 26:18

King James Version: And he said, Go into the city to such a man, and say unto him, The Master saith, My time is at hand; I will keep the passover at thy house with my disciples.

Decoded (Modern Language): He told them, 'Go into the city to a certain man and tell him, The Teacher says, My time is near; I will celebrate the Passover with my disciples at your house.'

Matthew 26:19

King James Version: And the disciples did as Jesus had appointed them; and they made ready the passover.

Decoded (Modern Language): The disciples did as Jesus told them and prepared the Passover meal.

Matthew 26:20

King James Version: Now when the even was come, he sat down with the twelve.

Decoded (Modern Language): When evening came, Jesus sat down with the twelve disciples.

Matthew 26:21

King James Version: And as they did eat, he said, Verily I say unto you, that one of you shall betray me.

Decoded (Modern Language): While they were eating, he said, 'I tell you the truth, one of you will betray me.'

Matthew 26:22

King James Version: And they were exceeding sorrowful, and began every one of them to say unto him, Lord, is it I?

Decoded (Modern Language): They were very sad and each one asked, 'Surely not I, Lord?'

Matthew 26:23

King James Version: And he answered and said, He that dippeth his hand with me in the dish, the same shall betray me.

Decoded (Modern Language): Jesus answered, 'The one who dips his hand with me in the bowl will betray me.'

Matthew 26:24

King James Version: The Son of man goeth as it is written of him: but woe unto that man by whom the Son of man is betrayed! it had been good for that man if he had not been born.

Decoded (Modern Language): The Son of Man will go as it is written about him, but woe to the man who betrays the Son of Man! It would be better for him if he had never been born.'

Matthew 26:25

King James Version: Then Judas, which betrayed him, answered and said, Master, is it I? He said unto him, Thou hast said.

Decoded (Modern Language): Then Judas, the one who would betray him, asked, 'Surely not I, Rabbi?' Jesus answered, 'You have said so.'

Matthew 26:26

King James Version: And as they were eating, Jesus took bread, and blessed it, and brake it, and gave it to the disciples, and said, Take, eat; this is my body.

Decoded (Modern Language): While they were eating, Jesus took bread, gave thanks, broke it, and gave it to the disciples. He said, 'Take and eat; this is my body.'

Matthew 26:27

King James Version: And he took the cup, and gave thanks, and gave it to them, saying, Drink ye all of it;

Decoded (Modern Language): Then he took a cup, gave thanks, and gave it to them, saying, 'Drink from it, all of you.'

Matthew 26:28

King James Version: For this is my blood of the new testament, which is shed for many for the remission of sins.

Decoded (Modern Language): This is my blood of the new agreement, which is poured out for many for the forgiveness of sins.

Matthew 26:29

King James Version: But I say unto you, I will not drink henceforth of this fruit of the vine, until that day when I drink it new with you in my Father's kingdom.

Decoded (Modern Language): But I tell you, I will not drink from this fruit of the vine again until that day when I drink it new with you in my Father's kingdom.'

Matthew 26:30

King James Version: And when they had sung an hymn, they went out into the mount of Olives.

Decoded (Modern Language): After singing a hymn, they went out to the Mount of Olives.

Matthew 26:31

King James Version: Then saith Jesus unto them, All ye shall be offended because of me this night: for it is written, I will smite the shepherd, and the sheep of the flock shall be scattered abroad.

Decoded (Modern Language): Then Jesus said to them, 'All of you will fall away because of me tonight. It is written, I will strike the shepherd, and the sheep of the flock will be scattered.'

Matthew 26:32

King James Version: But after I am risen again, I will go before you into Galilee.

Decoded (Modern Language): But after I rise again, I will go ahead of you to Galilee.

Matthew 26:33

King James Version: Peter answered and said unto him, Though all men shall be offended because of thee, yet will I never be offended.

Decoded (Modern Language): Peter answered him, 'Even if everyone else falls away because of you, I will never fall away.'

Matthew 26:34

King James Version: Jesus said unto him, Verily I say unto thee, That this night, before the cock crow, thou shalt deny me thrice.

Decoded (Modern Language): Jesus said to him, 'I tell you the truth, tonight before the rooster crows, you will deny me three times.'

Matthew 26:35

King James Version: Peter said unto him, Though I should die with thee, yet will I not deny thee. Likewise also said all the disciples.

Decoded (Modern Language): Peter said to him, 'Even if I have to die with you, I will never deny you.' All the disciples said the same.

Matthew 26:36

King James Version: Then cometh Jesus with them unto a place called Gethsemane, and saith unto the disciples, Sit ye here, while I go and pray yonder.

Decoded (Modern Language): Then Jesus went with them to a place called Gethsemane and said to the disciples, 'Sit here while I go over there to pray.'

Matthew 26:37

King James Version: And he took with him Peter and the two sons of Zebedee, and began to be sorrowful and very heavy.

Decoded (Modern Language): He took Peter and the two sons of Zebedee with him and began to feel sad and deeply troubled.

Matthew 26:38

King James Version: Then saith he unto them, My soul is exceeding sorrowful, even unto death: tarry ye here, and watch with me.

Decoded (Modern Language): He said to them, 'My soul is overwhelmed with sorrow, even to death. Stay here and keep watch with me.'

Matthew 26:39

King James Version: And he went a little further, and fell on his face, and prayed, saying, O my Father, if it be possible, let this cup pass from me: nevertheless not as I will, but as thou wilt.

Decoded (Modern Language): He went a little farther, fell face down, and prayed, 'My Father, if it is possible, let this cup pass from me. But not as I want, but as you want.'

Matthew 26:40

King James Version: And he cometh unto the disciples, and findeth them asleep, and saith unto Peter, What, could ye not watch with me one hour?

Decoded (Modern Language): Then he came to the disciples and found them sleeping. He said to Peter, 'Could you not keep watch with me for one hour?'

Matthew 26:41

King James Version: Watch and pray, that ye enter not into temptation: the spirit indeed is willing, but the flesh is weak.

Decoded (Modern Language): Watch and pray so you will not fall into temptation. The spirit is willing, but the body is weak.

Matthew 26:42

King James Version: He went away again the second time, and prayed, saying, O my Father, if this cup may not pass away from me, except I drink it, thy will be done.

Decoded (Modern Language): He went away again and prayed a second time, 'My Father, if this cup cannot pass unless I drink it, your will be done.'

Matthew 26:43

King James Version: And he came and found them asleep again: for their eyes were heavy.

Decoded (Modern Language): Then he came and found them sleeping again because their eyes were heavy.

Matthew 26:44

King James Version: And he left them, and went away again, and prayed the third time, saying the same words.

Decoded (Modern Language): He left them, went away again, and prayed a third time, saying the same words.

Matthew 26:45

King James Version: Then cometh he to his disciples, and saith unto them, Sleep on now, and take your rest: behold, the hour is at hand, and the Son of man is betrayed into the hands of sinners.

Decoded (Modern Language): Then he came to the disciples and said, 'Sleep now and rest. Look, the time has come. The Son of Man will be handed over to sinners.'

Matthew 26:46

King James Version: Rise, let us be going: behold, he is at hand that doth betray me.

Decoded (Modern Language): Get up, let's go. Look, the one who will betray me is here.

Matthew 26:47

King James Version: And while he yet spake, lo, Judas, one of the twelve, came, and with him a great multitude with swords and staves, from the chief priests and elders of the people.

Decoded (Modern Language): While he was still speaking, Judas, one of the twelve, arrived with a large crowd carrying swords and clubs, sent by the chief priests and elders.

Matthew 26:48

King James Version: Now he that betrayed him gave them a sign, saying, Whomsoever I shall kiss, that same is he: hold him fast.

Decoded (Modern Language): The one who betrayed him gave them a sign, saying, 'The one I kiss is the man; arrest him.'

Matthew 26:49

King James Version: And forthwith he came to Jesus, and said, Hail, master; and kissed him.

Decoded (Modern Language): Immediately Judas went to Jesus and said, 'Greetings, Teacher,' and kissed him.

Matthew 26:50

King James Version: And Jesus said unto him, Friend, wherefore art thou come? Then came they, and laid hands on Jesus, and took him.

Decoded (Modern Language): Jesus said to him, 'Friend, why have you come?' Then they stepped forward, grabbed Jesus, and arrested him.

Matthew 26:51

King James Version: And, behold, one of them which were with Jesus stretched out his hand, and drew his sword, and struck a servant of the high priest's, and smote off his ear.

Decoded (Modern Language): Suddenly one of those with Jesus reached for his sword, drew it, and struck the servant of the high priest, cutting off his ear.

Matthew 26:52

King James Version: Then said Jesus unto him, Put up again thy sword into his place: for all they that take the sword shall perish with the sword.

Decoded (Modern Language): Jesus said to him, 'Put your sword away! Those who use the sword will die by the sword.'

Matthew 26:53

King James Version: Thinkest thou that I cannot now pray to my Father, and he shall presently give me more than twelve legions of angels?

Decoded (Modern Language): Do you think I cannot ask my Father to send me more than twelve legions of angels right now?

Matthew 26:54

King James Version: But how then shall the scriptures be fulfilled, that thus it must be?

Decoded (Modern Language): But if I did, how would the Scriptures be fulfilled that say it must happen this way?

Matthew 26:55

King James Version: In that same hour said Jesus to the multitudes, Are ye come out as against a thief with swords and staves for to take me? I sat daily with you teaching in the temple, and ye laid no hold on me.

Decoded (Modern Language): At that moment Jesus said to the crowd, 'Are you coming to arrest me as if I were a thief, with swords and clubs? I have been with you every day teaching in the temple, but you did not arrest me.'

Matthew 26:56

King James Version: But all this was done, that the scriptures of the prophets might be fulfilled. Then all the disciples forsook him, and fled.

Decoded (Modern Language): But all this happened to fulfill the words of the prophets. Then all the disciples left him and ran away.

Matthew 26:57

King James Version: And they that had laid hold on Jesus led him away to Caiaphas the high priest, where the scribes and the elders were assembled.

Decoded (Modern Language): Those who arrested Jesus took him to Caiaphas, the high priest, where the teachers of the law and elders were gathered.

Matthew 26:58

King James Version: But Peter followed him afar off unto the high priest's palace, and went in, and sat with the servants, to see the end.

Decoded (Modern Language): Peter followed him at a distance to the high priest's courtyard. He went inside and sat with the servants to see what would happen.

Matthew 26:59

King James Version: Now the chief priests, and elders, and all the council, sought false witness against Jesus, to put him to death;

Decoded (Modern Language): The chief priests, elders, and the whole council were looking for false evidence against Jesus to put him to death.

Matthew 26:60

King James Version: But found none: yea, though many false witnesses came, yet found they none. At the last came two false witnesses,

Decoded (Modern Language): But they found none, even though many false witnesses came forward. At last, two came forward

Matthew 26:61

King James Version: And said, This fellow said, I am able to destroy the temple of God, and to build it in three days.

Decoded (Modern Language): and said, 'This man said, I can destroy the temple of God and rebuild it in three days.'

Matthew 26:62

King James Version: And the high priest arose, and said unto him, Answerest thou nothing? what is it which these witness against thee?

Decoded (Modern Language): The high priest stood up and asked him, 'Are you not going to answer? What do these people say against you?'

Matthew 26:63

King James Version: But Jesus held his peace. And the high priest answered and said unto him, I adjure thee by the living God, that thou tell us whether thou be the Christ, the Son of God.

Decoded (Modern Language): But Jesus remained silent. Then the high priest said, 'I command you by the living God to tell us if you are the Messiah, the Son of God.'

Matthew 26:64

King James Version: Jesus saith unto him, Thou hast said: nevertheless I say unto you, Hereafter shall ye see the Son of man sitting on the right hand of power, and coming in the clouds of heaven.

Decoded (Modern Language): Jesus said, 'You have said it. But I tell you, from now on you will see the Son of Man sitting at the right hand of power and coming on the clouds of heaven.'

Matthew 26:65

King James Version: Then the high priest rent his clothes, saying, He hath spoken blasphemy; what further need have we of witnesses? behold, now ye have heard his blasphemy.

Decoded (Modern Language): Then the high priest tore his clothes and said, 'He has spoken against God! Why do we need any more witnesses? You have all heard his blasphemy.'

Matthew 26:66

King James Version: What think ye? They answered and said, He is guilty of death.

Decoded (Modern Language): What do you think? They answered, 'He deserves to die.'

Matthew 26:67

King James Version: Then did they spit in his face, and buffeted him; and others smote him with the palms of their hands,

Decoded (Modern Language): Then they spat in his face and hit him. Others slapped him with their hands,

Matthew 26:68

King James Version: Saying, Prophesy unto us, thou Christ, Who is he that smote thee?

Decoded (Modern Language): saying, 'Prove that you are the Messiah! Who hit you?'

Matthew 26:69

King James Version: Now Peter sat without in the palace: and a damsel came unto him, saying, Thou also wast with Jesus of Galilee.

Decoded (Modern Language): Meanwhile, Peter was sitting outside in the courtyard. A servant girl came to him and said, 'You were with Jesus from Galilee.'

Matthew 26:70

King James Version: But he denied before them all, saying, I know not what thou sayest.

Decoded (Modern Language): But he denied it in front of everyone, saying, 'I don't know what you are talking about.'

Matthew 26:71

King James Version: And when he was gone out into the porch, another maid saw him, and said unto them that were there, This fellow was also with Jesus of Nazareth.

Decoded (Modern Language): After he went out to the entrance, another servant girl saw him and said to those nearby, 'This man was with Jesus of Nazareth.'

Matthew 26:72

King James Version: And again he denied with an oath, I do not know the man.

Decoded (Modern Language): Again he denied it, this time with an oath: 'I don't know the man.'

Matthew 26:73

King James Version: And after a while came unto him they that stood by, and said to Peter, Surely thou also art one of them; for thy speech bewrayeth thee.

Decoded (Modern Language): A little later, some bystanders came to Peter and said, 'Surely you are one of them, because your accent gives you away.'

Matthew 26:74

King James Version: Then began he to curse and to swear, saying, I know not the man. And immediately the cock crew.

Decoded (Modern Language): Then he began to curse and swear, 'I don't know the man!' At that moment, a rooster crowed.

Matthew 26:75

King James Version: And Peter remembered the word of Jesus, which said unto him, Before the cock crow, thou shalt deny me thrice. And he went out, and wept bitterly.

Decoded (Modern Language): Peter remembered what Jesus had said: 'Before the rooster crows, you will deny me three times.' Then he went outside and cried bitterly.

MATTHEW — CHAPTER 27

Matthew 27:1

King James Version: When the morning was come, all the chief priests and elders of the people took counsel against Jesus to put him to death:

Decoded (Modern Language): Early in the morning, all the leading priests and elders met to plan how to kill Jesus.

Matthew 27:2

King James Version: And when they had bound him, they led him away, and delivered him to Pontius Pilate the governor.

Decoded (Modern Language): After they tied him up, they took him away and handed him over to Pontius Pilate, the governor.

Matthew 27:3

King James Version: Then Judas, which had betrayed him, when he saw that he was condemned, repented himself, and brought again the thirty pieces of silver to the chief priests and elders,

Decoded (Modern Language): Then Judas, who had betrayed him, felt sorry when he saw Jesus was condemned. He returned the thirty silver coins to the chief priests and elders.

Matthew 27:4

King James Version: Saying, I have sinned in that I have betrayed the innocent blood. And they said, What is that to us? see thou to that.

Decoded (Modern Language): He said, 'I have sinned by betraying innocent blood.' But they replied, 'What do we care? That's your problem.'

Matthew 27:5

King James Version: And he cast down the pieces of silver in the temple, and departed, and went and hanged himself.

Decoded (Modern Language): Judas threw the silver coins into the temple, left, and hanged himself.

Matthew 27:6

King James Version: And the chief priests took the silver pieces, and said, It is not lawful for to put them into the treasury, because it is the price of blood.

Decoded (Modern Language): The chief priests picked up the silver coins and said, 'We can't put this money into the treasury because it is the price of blood.'

Matthew 27:7

King James Version: And they took counsel, and bought with them the potter's field, to bury strangers in.

Decoded (Modern Language): So they decided to use the money to buy the potter's field to bury strangers in.

Matthew 27:8

King James Version: Wherefore that field was called, The field of blood, unto this day.

Decoded (Modern Language): That field has been called the Field of Blood ever since.

Matthew 27:9

King James Version: Then was fulfilled that which was spoken by Jeremy the prophet, saying, And they took the thirty pieces of silver, the price of him that was valued, whom they of the children of Israel did value;

Decoded (Modern Language): This fulfilled what the prophet Jeremiah had said: 'They took the thirty silver coins—the price set for the one valued by the people of Israel.'

Matthew 27:10

King James Version: And gave them for the potter's field, as the Lord appointed me.

Decoded (Modern Language): They used the money to buy the potter's field, as the Lord had commanded me.

Matthew 27:11

King James Version: And Jesus stood before the governor: and the governor asked him, saying, Art thou the King of the Jews? And Jesus said unto him, Thou sayest.

Decoded (Modern Language): Jesus stood before the governor, who asked him, 'Are you the King of the Jews?' Jesus answered, 'You say so.'

Matthew 27:12

King James Version: And when he was accused of the chief priests and elders, he answered nothing.

Decoded (Modern Language): When the chief priests and elders accused him, Jesus said nothing.

Matthew 27:13

King James Version: Then said Pilate unto him, Hearest thou not how many things they witness against thee?

Decoded (Modern Language): Pilate asked him, 'Don't you hear all the charges they are making against you?'

Matthew 27:14

King James Version: And he answered him to never a word; insomuch that the governor marvelled greatly.

Decoded (Modern Language): But Jesus did not answer a word, so the governor was amazed.

Matthew 27:15

King James Version: Now at that feast the governor was wont to release unto the people a prisoner, whom they would.

Decoded (Modern Language): At that festival, it was the governor's custom to release one prisoner to the people, whoever they wanted.

Matthew 27:16

King James Version: And they had then a notable prisoner, called Barabbas.

Decoded (Modern Language): At that time, there was a well-known prisoner named Barabbas.

Matthew 27:17

King James Version: Therefore when they were gathered together, Pilate said unto them, Whom will ye that I release unto you? Barabbas, or Jesus which is called Christ?

Decoded (Modern Language): So when the people gathered, Pilate asked, 'Who do you want me to release to you? Barabbas, or Jesus, called the Messiah?'

Matthew 27:18

King James Version: For he knew that for envy they had delivered him.

Decoded (Modern Language): Pilate knew they had handed Jesus over because they were jealous.

Matthew 27:19

King James Version: When he was set down on the judgment seat, his wife sent unto him, saying, Have thou nothing to do with that just man: for I have suffered many things this day in a dream because of him.

Decoded (Modern Language): While Pilate was sitting on the judge's seat, his wife sent him a message: 'Don't have anything to do with that innocent man, because I have suffered a lot today in a dream because of him.'

Matthew 27:20

King James Version: But the chief priests and elders persuaded the multitude that they should ask Barabbas, and destroy Jesus.

Decoded (Modern Language): But the chief priests and elders convinced the crowd to ask for Barabbas and to have Jesus killed.

Matthew 27:21

King James Version: The governor answered and said unto them, Whether of the twain will ye that I release unto you? They said, Barabbas.

Decoded (Modern Language): The governor asked them, 'Which one do you want me to release to you?' They answered, 'Barabbas.'

Matthew 27:22

King James Version: Pilate saith unto them, What shall I do then with Jesus which is called Christ? They all say unto him, Let him be crucified.

Decoded (Modern Language): Pilate asked, 'What should I do with Jesus, called the Messiah?' They all shouted, 'Crucify him!'

Matthew 27:23

King James Version: And the governor said, Why, what evil hath he done? But they cried out the more, saying, Let him be crucified.

Decoded (Modern Language): Pilate said, 'Why? What wrong has he done?' But they shouted even louder, 'Crucify him!'

Matthew 27:24

King James Version: When Pilate saw that he could prevail nothing, but that rather a tumult was made, he took water, and washed his hands before the multitude, saying, I am innocent of the blood of this just person: see ye to it.

Decoded (Modern Language): When Pilate saw he could not change their minds and that a riot was starting, he washed his hands in front of the crowd and said, 'I am innocent of this man's blood. You are responsible.'

Matthew 27:25

King James Version: Then answered all the people, and said, His blood be on us, and on our children.

Decoded (Modern Language): All the people answered, 'Let his blood be on us and on our children.'

Matthew 27:26

King James Version: Then released he Barabbas unto them: and when he had scourged Jesus, he delivered him to be crucified.

Decoded (Modern Language): Then Pilate released Barabbas to them. After having Jesus whipped, he handed him over to be crucified.

Matthew 27:27

King James Version: Then the soldiers of the governor took Jesus into the common hall, and gathered unto him the whole band of soldiers.

Decoded (Modern Language): Then the governor's soldiers took Jesus into the governor's headquarters and gathered the whole group of soldiers around him.

Matthew 27:28

King James Version: And they stripped him, and put on him a scarlet robe.

Decoded (Modern Language): They took off his clothes and put a scarlet robe on him.

Matthew 27:29

King James Version: And when they had platted a crown of thorns, they put it upon his head, and a reed in his right hand: and they bowed the knee before him, and mocked him, saying, Hail, King of the Jews!

Decoded (Modern Language): They made a crown of thorns and put it on his head, gave him a stick in his right hand, knelt before him, and mocked him, saying, 'Hail, King of the Jews!'

Matthew 27:30

King James Version: And they spit upon him, and took the reed, and smote him on the head.

Decoded (Modern Language): They spit on him, took the stick, and hit him on the head.

Matthew 27:31

King James Version: And after that they had mocked him, they took the robe off from him, and put his own raiment on him, and led him away to crucify him.

Decoded (Modern Language): After mocking him, they took off the robe, put his own clothes back on him, and led him away to be crucified.

Matthew 27:32

King James Version: And as they came out, they found a man of Cyrene, Simon by name: him they compelled to bear his cross.

Decoded (Modern Language): As they were leaving, they found a man from Cyrene named Simon. They forced him to carry Jesus' cross.

Matthew 27:33

King James Version: And when they were come unto a place called Golgotha, that is to say, a place of a skull,

Decoded (Modern Language): They came to a place called Golgotha, which means the place of a skull.

Matthew 27:34

King James Version: They gave him vinegar to drink mingled with gall: and when he had tasted thereof, he would not drink.

Decoded (Modern Language): They gave Jesus vinegar mixed with bitter gall to drink, but after tasting it, he refused to drink it.

Matthew 27:35

King James Version: And they crucified him, and parted his garments, casting lots: that it might be fulfilled which was spoken by the prophet, They parted my garments among them, and upon my vesture did they cast lots.

Decoded (Modern Language): They crucified him and divided his clothes by casting lots, fulfilling what the prophet said: 'They divided my clothes among them and cast lots for my garment.'

Matthew 27:36

King James Version: And sitting down they watched him there;

Decoded (Modern Language): They sat down and watched him there.

Matthew 27:37

King James Version: And set up over his head his accusation written, THIS IS JESUS THE KING OF THE JEWS.

Decoded (Modern Language): Above his head they placed the charge against him, which read: THIS IS JESUS, THE KING OF THE JEWS.

Matthew 27:38

King James Version: Then were there two thieves crucified with him, one on the right hand, and another on the left.

Decoded (Modern Language): Two criminals were crucified with him, one on his right and one on his left.

Matthew 27:39

King James Version: And they that passed by reviled him, wagging their heads,

Decoded (Modern Language): Those who passed by insulted him, shaking their heads.

Matthew 27:40

King James Version: And saying, Thou that destroyest the temple, and buildest it in three days, save thyself. If thou be the Son of God, come down from the cross.

Decoded (Modern Language): They said, 'You who destroy the temple and build it in three days, save yourself! If you are the Son of God, come down from the cross.'

Matthew 27:41

King James Version: Likewise also the chief priests mocking him, with the scribes and elders, said,

Decoded (Modern Language): The chief priests, along with the teachers of the law and elders, also mocked him.

Matthew 27:42

King James Version: He saved others; himself he cannot save. If he be the King of Israel, let him now come down from the cross, and we will believe him.

Decoded (Modern Language): They said, 'He saved others, but he cannot save himself. If he is the King of Israel, let him come down now from the cross, and we will believe him.'

Matthew 27:43

King James Version: He trusted in God; let him deliver him now, if he will have him: for he said, I am the Son of God.

Decoded (Modern Language): They said, 'He trusts in God; let God rescue him now if he wants him, for he said, I am the Son of God.'

Matthew 27:44

King James Version: The thieves also, which were crucified with him, cast the same in his teeth.

Decoded (Modern Language): The criminals who were crucified with him also insulted him in the same way.

Matthew 27:45

King James Version: Now from the sixth hour there was darkness over all the land unto the ninth hour.

Decoded (Modern Language): From noon until three in the afternoon, darkness covered the whole land.

Matthew 27:46

King James Version: And about the ninth hour Jesus cried with a loud voice, saying, Eli, Eli, lama sabachthani? that is to say, My God, my God, why hast thou forsaken me?

Decoded (Modern Language): About three o'clock, Jesus cried out loudly, 'Eli, Eli, lama sabachthani?' which means, 'My God, my God, why have you abandoned me?'

Matthew 27:47

King James Version: Some of them that stood there, when they heard that, said, This man calleth for Elias.

Decoded (Modern Language): Some of those standing there heard this and said, 'He is calling Elijah.'

Matthew 27:48

King James Version: And straightway one of them ran, and took a sponge, and filled it with vinegar, and put it on a reed, and gave him to drink.

Decoded (Modern Language): Immediately one of them ran, took a sponge, filled it with vinegar, put it on a stick, and gave it to him to drink.

Matthew 27:49

King James Version: The rest said, Let be, let us see whether Elias will come to save him.

Decoded (Modern Language): The others said, 'Wait, let's see if Elijah comes to save him.'

Matthew 27:50

King James Version: Jesus, when he had cried again with a loud voice, yielded up the ghost.

Decoded (Modern Language): After Jesus cried out again loudly, he gave up his spirit.

Matthew 27:51

King James Version: And, behold, the veil of the temple was rent in twain from the top to the bottom; and the earth did quake, and the rocks rent;

Decoded (Modern Language): At that moment, the curtain of the temple was torn in two from top to bottom, the earth shook, and the rocks split.

Matthew 27:52

King James Version: And the graves were opened; and many bodies of the saints which slept arose,

Decoded (Modern Language): The tombs opened, and many holy people who had died were raised to life.

Matthew 27:53

King James Version: And came out of the graves after his resurrection, and went into the holy city, and appeared unto many.

Decoded (Modern Language): They came out of the tombs after Jesus' resurrection, went into the holy city, and appeared to many people.

Matthew 27:54

King James Version: Now when the centurion, and they that were with him, watching Jesus, saw the earthquake, and those things that were done, they feared greatly, saying, Truly this was the Son of God.

Decoded (Modern Language): When the Roman officer and those with him who were guarding Jesus saw the earthquake and what had happened, they were terrified and said, 'Surely he was the Son of God.'

Matthew 27:55

King James Version: And many women were there beholding afar off, which followed Jesus from Galilee, ministering unto him:

Decoded (Modern Language): Many women were there watching from a distance. They had followed Jesus from Galilee to care for him.

Matthew 27:56

King James Version: Among which was Mary Magdalene, and Mary the mother of James and Joses, and the mother of Zebedee's children.

Decoded (Modern Language): Among them were Mary Magdalene, Mary the mother of James and Joseph, and the mother of Zebedee's sons.

Matthew 27:57

King James Version: When the even was come, there came a rich man of Arimathea, named Joseph, who also himself was Jesus' disciple:

Decoded (Modern Language): When evening came, a rich man from Arimathea named Joseph, who was also a disciple of Jesus, went to Pilate.

Matthew 27:58

King James Version: He went to Pilate, and begged the body of Jesus. Then Pilate commanded the body to be delivered.

Decoded (Modern Language): He asked Pilate for Jesus' body, and Pilate ordered it to be given to him.

Matthew 27:59

King James Version: And when Joseph had taken the body, he wrapped it in a clean linen cloth,

Decoded (Modern Language): Joseph took the body, wrapped it in a clean linen cloth,

Matthew 27:60

King James Version: And laid it in his own new tomb, which he had hewn out in the rock: and he rolled a great stone to the door of the sepulchre, and departed.

Decoded (Modern Language): and placed it in his own new tomb that he had cut out of the rock. He rolled a large stone in front of the entrance and left.

Matthew 27:61

King James Version: And there was Mary Magdalene, and the other Mary, sitting over against the sepulchre.

Decoded (Modern Language): Mary Magdalene and the other Mary were sitting opposite the tomb.

Matthew 27:62

King James Version: Now the next day, that followed the day of the preparation, the chief priests and Pharisees came together unto Pilate,

Decoded (Modern Language): The next day, after the day of preparation, the chief priests and Pharisees went to Pilate,

Matthew 27:63

King James Version: Saying, Sir, we remember that that deceiver said, while he was yet alive, After three days I will rise again.

Decoded (Modern Language): and said, 'Sir, we remember that deceiver said while he was still alive, "After three days I will rise again."'

Matthew 27:64

King James Version: Command therefore that the sepulchre be made sure until the third day, lest his disciples come by night, and steal him away, and say unto the people, He is risen from the dead: so the last error shall be worse than the first.

Decoded (Modern Language): So order that the tomb be guarded until the third day, to prevent his disciples from coming at night, stealing his body, and telling people, "He has risen from the dead." This would cause a worse deception than the first.

Matthew 27:65

King James Version: Pilate said unto them, Ye have a watch: go your way, make it as sure as ye can.

Decoded (Modern Language): Pilate told them, 'You have guards; go and make the tomb as secure as you can.'

Matthew 27:66

King James Version: So they went, and made the sepulchre sure, sealing the stone, and setting a watch.

Decoded (Modern Language): So they went and secured the tomb by sealing the stone and posting guards.

MATTHEW — CHAPTER 28

Matthew 28:1

King James Version: In the end of the sabbath, as it began to dawn toward the first day of the week, came Mary Magdalene and the other Mary to see the sepulchre.

Decoded (Modern Language): At the end of the Sabbath, just as the first day of the week was beginning to dawn, Mary Magdalene and the other Mary went to look at the tomb.

Matthew 28:2

King James Version: And, behold, there was a great earthquake: for the angel of the Lord descended from heaven, and came and rolled back the stone from the door, and sat upon it.

Decoded (Modern Language): Suddenly, there was a great earthquake because an angel of the Lord came down from heaven, rolled back the stone from the tomb's entrance, and sat on it.

Matthew 28:3

King James Version: His countenance was like lightning, and his raiment white as snow:

Decoded (Modern Language): His face shone like lightning, and his clothes were as white as snow.

Matthew 28:4

King James Version: And for fear of him the keepers did shake, and became as dead men.

Decoded (Modern Language): The guards shook with fear and became like dead men.

Matthew 28:5

King James Version: And the angel answered and said unto the women, Fear not ye: for I know that ye seek Jesus, which was crucified.

Decoded (Modern Language): The angel said to the women, 'Don't be afraid. I know you are looking for Jesus, who was crucified.'

Matthew 28:6

King James Version: He is not here: for he is risen, as he said. Come, see the place where the Lord lay.

Decoded (Modern Language): He is not here; he has risen, just as he said. Come, see the place where he was laid.

Matthew 28:7

King James Version: And go quickly, and tell his disciples that he is risen from the dead; and, behold, he goeth before you into Galilee; there shall ye see him: lo, I have told you.

Decoded (Modern Language): Now go quickly and tell his disciples that he has risen from the dead. He is going ahead of you to Galilee, and there you will see him. I have told you.'

Matthew 28:8

King James Version: And they departed quickly from the sepulchre with fear and great joy; and did run to bring his disciples word.

Decoded (Modern Language): The women left the tomb quickly, filled with fear and great joy, and ran to tell his disciples.

Matthew 28:9

King James Version: And as they went to tell his disciples, behold, Jesus met them, saying, All hail. And they came and held him by the feet, and worshipped him.

Decoded (Modern Language): As they went to tell the disciples, Jesus met them and said, 'Greetings!' They came to him, held his feet, and worshiped him.

Matthew 28:10

King James Version: Then said Jesus unto them, Be not afraid: go tell my brethren that they go into Galilee, and there shall they see me.

Decoded (Modern Language): Jesus said to them, 'Don't be afraid. Go tell my brothers to go to Galilee, and there they will see me.'

Matthew 28:11

King James Version: Now when they were going, behold, some of the watch came into the city, and shewed unto the chief priests all the things that were done.

Decoded (Modern Language): While they were on their way, some of the guards went into the city and reported to the chief priests everything that had happened.

Matthew 28:12

King James Version: And when they were assembled with the elders, and had taken counsel, they gave large money unto the soldiers,

Decoded (Modern Language): The chief priests and elders met, made a plan, and gave the soldiers a large amount of money.

Matthew 28:13

King James Version: Saying, Say ye, His disciples came by night, and stole him away while we slept.

Decoded (Modern Language): They told the soldiers, 'Say that his disciples came during the night and stole his body while you were sleeping.'

Matthew 28:14

King James Version: And if this come to the governor's ears, we will persuade him, and secure you.

Decoded (Modern Language): If the governor hears about this, we will convince him and protect you.

Matthew 28:15

King James Version: So they took the money, and did as they were taught: and this saying is commonly reported among the Jews until this day.

Decoded (Modern Language): So the soldiers took the money and did as they were told. This story is still told among the Jews today.

Matthew 28:16

King James Version: Then the eleven disciples went away into Galilee, into a mountain where Jesus had appointed them.

Decoded (Modern Language): The eleven disciples went to Galilee, to the mountain where Jesus had told them to go.

Matthew 28:17

King James Version: And when they saw him, they worshipped him: but some doubted.

Decoded (Modern Language): When they saw him, they worshiped him, but some still doubted.

Matthew 28:18

King James Version: And Jesus came and spake unto them, saying, All power is given unto me in heaven and in earth.

Decoded (Modern Language): Jesus came to them and said, 'All authority in heaven and on earth has been given to me.'

Matthew 28:19

King James Version: Go ye therefore, and teach all nations, baptizing them in the name of the Father, and of the Son, and of the Holy Ghost:

Decoded (Modern Language): Therefore, go and make disciples of all nations, baptizing them in the name of the Father, the Son, and the Holy Spirit.

Matthew 28:20

King James Version: Teaching them to observe all things whatsoever I have commanded you: and, lo, I am with you alway, even unto the end of the world. Amen.

Decoded (Modern Language): Teach them to obey everything I have commanded you. And remember, I am with you always, to the very end of the age.